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Happening today

● **THE SC** will hear a plea filed by DMK alleging that ministers in the Tamil Nadu government were 'actively influencing' witnesses in the CBI probe into last year's Karur stampede case.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



DONATION 'THEFT' ROW: TRUST ACCEPTS RESIGNATIONS OF CHAMPAT RAI, ANIL MISHRA

Ayodhya temple Trust goes for key changes at the top, to appoint CEO

3-member panel to recommend names for CEO; retired bureaucrat Krishna Mohan made interim General Secretary

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, July 6

IN ITS first meeting since allegations of donation theft at the Ram temple in Ayodhya surfaced, the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra, in its first major shake-up since 2020, announced a sweeping organisational overhaul, including leadership changes and the creation of a new chief executive officer (CEO) post, on Monday. The Trust accepted the res-

ignations of two key members, general secretary Champat Rai and member Anil Mishra, and appointed senior RSS functionary and retired Indian Forest Service (IFoS) officer Krishna Mohan as interim General Secretary. It also announced a three-member committee, comprising retired judge Justice Pramod Kohli, former Lieutenant General Vishnu Kant Chaturvedi and Suresh Haware, to recommend names for a CEO to manage the temple complex.



Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra treasurer Govind Giri and interim general secretary Krishna Mohan in Ayodhya, Monday. ANI

Rai and Mishra had tendered their resignations after an FIR was lodged on June 25 and eight arrests were made in connection with the case.

The Trust will meet again on July 22, by which time it expects the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the case to submit its final report. The

● Other decisions

● Trust gives records of donations received, spent. It received Rs 3,246 cr since its formation; Rs 2,370 cr spent on temple construction, related capital works

● Trust removes Gopal Nagarkatte alias Gopal Rao from list of special invitees; he was in-charge of daily activities such as darshan

meeting will also consider filling three vacancies among trustees, one that arose following the death of Vimlendra Pratap Mishra last year and two following Monday's resignations. In a significant move, it

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BHUPENDER YADAV'S AIDES

Purge in Minister's office: PS, Addl PS shunted out, another Addl PS sacked

July 3 order cites 'administrative' reason behind removal of PS

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

IN A rare move, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has simultaneously removed three key aides of Union Minister Bhupender Yadav.

While the Private Secretary to the Minister has been shunted out on "administrative grounds", an Additional Private Secretary has been "prematurely repatriated", and the appointment of another Additional Private Secretary has been "terminated".

The decisions were announced in separate orders

dated July 3. *The Indian Express* reached out to top officials of the ministry for a comment on the changes, but did not receive any response.

"...Shri Amar Singh, IRS (IT:2010), Private Secretary to the Hon'ble Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is repatriated to his parent cadre, i.e. Department of Revenue, on administrative ground and relieved of his duties with immediate effect," the ministry's order stated.

Amar Singh, an Indian Revenue Service officer, was initially appointed as Private Secretary to Yadav in 2021, when the Minister held the Labour and Employment portfolio. Earlier a Deputy Secretary, he was upgraded to Director in 2024. His appointment was "for the period up to 07.09.2026 (i.e. for the balance period of his tenure of five years as Private

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

Facing backlash, Govt likely to delay higher 25% ethanol blend in petrol

Move comes on back of consumer concerns on mileage and fears of engine damage

Anil Sasi
New Delhi, July 6

AMID A raging backlash over a rapid increase in the use of ethanol in petrol from 10% to 20% in just three years, the government is likely to push back the proposed shift to a higher blend of ethanol fuel E25 comprising 75% petrol and 25% ethanol.

The government had originally planned to dispense petrol blended with 20% ethanol only by 2030. But the E20 fuel — 80% petrol and 20% ethanol

E. EXPLAINED

What is the ethanol advantage?

Ethanol has many positives including low carbon content, and lower dependence on import of fossil fuels. But a rapid increase in ethanol has triggered concerns, which the government plans to address before introducing E25.

— is now the standard petrol variant available nationwide. While no formal date has been announced for dispensing E25 blended petrol, two government decisions over the last six weeks triggered fresh

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Landslide blocks Pune-Mumbai 'Missing Link'

Workers and earthmovers clear the debris after heavy rainfall triggered a landslide near the 'Missing Link' section of the Pune-Mumbai Expressway, in Maharashtra, Monday. Traffic on its Mumbai-bound carriageway resumed Monday night after 18 hours. NARENDRA VASKAR

IT WAS THE FIRST major monsoon disruption to the Rs 6,695-crore Missing Link, which was built to provide relief to the Mumbai-Pune Expressway's traffic bottleneck area, barely nine weeks after its inauguration.

THE MUMBAI-BOUND CARRIAGEWAY was closed after a landslide near the exit of Tunnel 2, the longest tunnel on the Missing Link — that cuts through the Sahyadri mountains.

MEANWHILE, FOUR PEOPLE, including three members of a family, were killed in a landslide and wall collapse, while another was swept away in a separate rain-related incident in Pune district on Monday. [PAGE 9](#)

Trump delivers 'assist' of World Cup, gets red card reprieve for US player



Sandip G
New York, July 6

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump has been a phantom figure at this World Cup.

He skipped the opening ceremony and has not watched a single match, not even of the co-hosts who go by the acro-

nym USMNT (United States Men's National Team).

But he was there when his national team needed him the most — to rescind the red card brandished on USMNT striker Folarin Balogun for a foul on Tarik Muharemovic in the round-of-16 game against Bosnia and Herzegovina.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE EDITORIAL PAGE
FIFA LETS DONALD TRUMP, THE BULLY, WIN [PAGE 10](#)

Convention centre, museum: Nod sought for work at Indira Point

Work to protect Great Nicobar lighthouse; won't execute prohibited activity: Official

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, July 6

FROM A fortified lighthouse to a convention centre and museum, the Directorate of Light-houses and Lightships at Sri Vijaya Puram (Port Blair) has sought clearance from the Andaman and Nicobar Coastal Zone Management Authority and the Environment Ministry to undertake protection and development work at Indira

Point, India's southernmost location, on Great Nicobar Island. Official documents reviewed by *The Indian Express* show the proposed work falls in the ecologically sensitive Island CRZ (ICRZ)-1A and ICRZ-IVA categories.

Under ICRZ-1A, no development activity is permitted except for certain specified purposes such as eco-tourism and the construction of roads and

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● Southernmost point



Delhi HC refuses to recall order to Govt to disburse Rs 21 cr to '20 riot victims

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 6

THE DELHI High Court on Monday refused to recall its January 2025 order in which the court had directed the Delhi government to disburse Rs 21 crore to the victims of the communal violence that took place in North East Delhi in February 2020.

The compensation was recommended by the North East Delhi Riots Claims Commission (NEDRCC), which was notified by the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government in

April 2020.

The government has opposed the HC's directive, relying on a Supreme Court judgment that it says "contemplates that the liability (for loss of life or property and injury) is to be borne by the actual perpetrators and organisers (of the violence)".

However, the government informed the HC on Monday that it had "not yet" put in place a mechanism to recover money from the accused or perpetrators of the violence. At least 53 people, most of them Muslims,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

POLITICS PAGES 6, 9



PM IN INDONESIA, TO HOLD MEET WITH PRESIDENT, SUBIANTO TODAY

TWO ASSAM RIFLES PERSONNEL KILLED IN AMBUSH IN MANIPUR'S UKHRUL

● GROUP SET UP BY HARVARD PROFESSOR AVI LOEB TO ADVISE WHITE HOUSE, PENTAGON, FBI AND AMERICAN INTELLIGENCE COMMUNITY ON UNIDENTIFIED ANOMALOUS PHENOMENA

From Haryana judoka to Harvard scientist on new US council scouting alien life

Sukhbir Siwach
Chandigarh, July 6

FROM A judoka in Haryana's junior team in 2006 to a post-doctoral researcher at Harvard, Dr Devesh Nandal has come a long way. He is now beginning an even longer journey — in search of alien life.

The 37-year-old scientist from Jatal village in Panipat was chosen last month to join the UAP Science Advisory Council, a new advisory group set up by Harvard professor Avi Loeb to advise the White House, Pentagon, FBI and the

American intelligence community on Unidentified Anomalous Phenomena — or, as NASA calls it, observations of events in the sky that cannot be identified as aircraft or known natural phenomena.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* over phone, Nandal said, "I was chosen to be an expert on the council due to my expertise in Astrophysics and Electronic engineering. Whether the UAP are of terrestrial or extraterrestrial origin, my expertise will aid the team in applying numerical and statistical tools to decipher the origin of

such events."

Nandal is a postdoctoral researcher at the Center for Astrophysics at Harvard & Smithsonian, with experience in theoretical modelling, stellar evolution and interpreting complex data. His role on the council will be to help separate real scientific explanations from speculation, and examine "strange" observations using the same rigorous methods applied in modern astrophysics.

"I expect to learn more about the fundamental principles that govern our universe. Clearly, these anomalous events are puzzling various



Dr Devesh Nandal, a researcher at the Center for Astrophysics at Harvard & Smithsonian, at Maunakea observatories in Hawaii

government agencies. I wish to apply scientific principles and

expect to understand the physics that operates such ob-

jects," Nandal said.

The appointment comes against the backdrop of renewed government interest in the US in extraterrestrial life — a pursuit that has also led to raised eyebrows in the scientific community.

In 2022, the US Congress held its first hearings on UFOs in five decades, and the military has since promised greater transparency on the subject. This year, on directions from President Donald Trump, the Pentagon released a tranche of files containing descriptions of reported sightings on Earth and by astronauts, though none of-

fered conclusive proof of extraterrestrial life.

For Nandal, meanwhile, the journey he has already completed matters just as much as the one he is about to begin.

"My first time moving abroad to study engineering at the University of Leeds in the UK was a real eye-opening moment. Engineering and Astrophysics might sound similar to some, but in fact are quite different. I learned how to focus on tasks that have never been solved before... This allowed me to win the VITA-Origins fellowship (University of Virginia) and later the Swiss National

Science Foundation fellowship, which paved my way to the US, first at Virginia, now at Harvard," he said.

Back in Panipat, where his parents are based, Nandal's father Dr Sumer Singh Nandal is a former Deputy Director (Sports) in Haryana's Youth and Welfare Department, and his mother Dr Shakuntla Nandal is a former sociology professor.

Their excitement is palpable. "He is now part of a select group of scientists asked to apply modern science to one of today's most debated topics. His role is not to assume

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Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah during the 5th Foundation Day ceremony of the Ministry of Cooperation, at the Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

Shah: Centre will start cooperative life insurance firm, utility aggregator

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, July 6

UNION HOME and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah announced on Monday that the central government would soon launch a cooperative life insurance company and a utility aggregator cooperative on the lines of Bharat Taxi, India's first cooperative-based taxi service. "We are set to develop a utility aggregator cooperative on the lines of Bharat Taxi in the near future. Building on the success of the IFFCO-Tokio insurance model, we are also going to establish a cooperative life insurance company, which will significantly advance the cooperative sector in the insurance domain," Shah said at an event organised on the occasion of the fifth foundation day ceremony of the Ministry of Cooperation. Shah said that cooperatives contribute about 20 per cent of farm credit, 35 per cent of fertiliser distribution, 21 per cent of sugar production, and 35 per cent of milk production today. Shah also said that Bharat Taxi, launched on February 5 this year, would be available in every state and 500 cities in the next two years. Before the cooperation min-

istry was formed in 2021, a division of the Ministry of Agriculture handled cooperatives. Shah said the biggest controversy five years ago was about whether the new ministry would lead to central interference in the functioning of state cooperatives, because co-operation is a state subject under the Constitution. "I want to reply to them that five years have passed, and not even the Opposition-ruled states have made any complaint of interference in cooperatives by the Centre," Shah said. Cooperation had been part of the agriculture ministry since 1979. When the government established the co-operation ministry on July 6, 2021, it assigned the portfolio to Shah, who is also the Union home minister. Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh, Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying and Panchayati Raj; Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma; Krishan Pal Gurjar, Minister of State for Co-operation; and Murlidhar Mohol, Minister of State for Co-operation and Civil Aviation; and senior central and state officials were also present on the occasion.

'Impossible to monitor billions of posts': Google and Meta assert they are not 'super censors'

The companies were responding to a plea in Delhi HC seeking monitoring of 'unlawful content'

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 6

TECH GIANTS Google LLC and Meta Platforms have opposed a petitioner's plea in the Delhi High Court seeking proactive monitoring of unlawful content on social media platforms by intermediaries. They termed such an exercise to be "impracticable, if not impossible", owing to the "huge volume" of content uploaded on its platforms. Meta also said they "would not be able to comply" with any court order to this effect, unless specific URLs of the said unlawful content are flagged. Both firms have cited provisions of the IT Act as well as the SC's position to emphasise that intermediaries "cannot be called upon to actively monitor content or material" uploaded on its platforms or adjudicate on its purported illegality. In April, advocate Vaibhav Singh filed a petition objecting to the alleged unauthorised and illegal uploading and circulation of audio and video recordings of AAP national convenor and former Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal, arguing his plea seeking the recusal of Justice Swarna Kanta Sharma of Delhi HC in the alleged liquor policy scam. Singh also sought contempt proceedings against Kejriwal, several other politicians, and journalist Ravish Kumar, among others, in his petition. On April 23, a division bench, while hearing the plea, had raised a larger query on the point

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Ram temple Trust

released records of donations received and spent. It said offerings made by devotees visiting the temple until March 31, 2026, totalled Rs 582 crore, of which Rs 319 crore had been spent on temple operations, with the remainder held in bank accounts. Since its formation, the Trust said it received Rs 3,246 crore through the nationwide Nidhi Samarpan Abhiyan and other donations, of which Rs 2,370 crore has been spent on temple construction and related capital works. Addressing the media after the meeting which lasted over three hours, Trust treasurer Govind Giri said it was originally scheduled for July 11 but was advanced because of the "extraordinary situation" following the alleged thefts. "The construction of Shri

Ram Lalla's grand temple was a moment of immense joy after a struggle spanning over 500 years and countless sacrifices. In such a temple, the incident of theft from the donation boxes during counting is deeply painful and shameful for all of us," he said. Without commenting on the scale of the alleged theft, Giri said the Trust's primary concern was the damage caused to the sentiments of devotees and the institution's credibility: "Whether the theft was small or big comes later. The atmosphere that has been created is what has hurt all of us." Giri said Rai, who had been serving as general secretary since the Trust's inception, voluntarily submitted his resignation, saying he felt it would not be appropriate to continue in office until justice was done.

According to Giri, founder trustee K Parasaran, 99, who attended the meeting virtually, informed Trust members that under the Trust's constitution, a resignation takes effect immediately upon being tendered. "... We had no choice but to accept it," he said. Giri said Mohan would be free to choose a team to assist him. "We have full faith that with his knowledge, clean outlook and administrative experience, he will discharge these responsibilities with utmost efficiency." In his first remarks after taking charge, Mohan acknowledged that shortcomings in the Trust's internal systems had allowed the alleged irregularities to occur. "... My first priority will be to identify and close every such loophole so such incidents are never repeated." "The atmosphere that has been created has affected the Trust's image and generated distrust in society. All trustees will

work together to restore that trust and re-establish confidence of devotees," he added. Reiterating that "theft is theft" and demanding strict action against all those involved, Giri accused certain groups of using the controversy to defame the Ram Temple movement and create divisions among devotees. Giri said the Trust maintained records of offerings, including a register containing details of around 2,800 donated valuables, and pledged to make its systems more transparent. "The Trust is committed to ensuring no one gets an opportunity to point fingers at our systems in future," he said. The Trust also decided to remove Gopal Nagarkatte alias Gopal Rao from the list of special invitees. It did not specify the reason. Rao was brought in after controversies related to land deals of the Trust and was in charge of daily activities such as darshan.

Minor's rape-murder

Team (SIT) has been formed to probe the case. Prohibitory orders have been imposed in Baruiapur and nearby areas. The arrested men were identified as Ananda Sardar, Pravash Mondol, and Dibakar Sardar. Police sources said they were looking for a fourth suspect in the case. The minor girl, who had been missing since Saturday afternoon, was found dead in a pond on Sunday morning. An officer said the postmortem report showed that the girl was alive when thrown into the pond, and that she had suffered a head injury. After her body was found, violent protests erupted at Baruiapur. A mob lynched a local man suspected of being involved in the crime after the girl's family alleged she was raped and murdered before her body was dumped in the pond. Angry locals initially refused to hand over the girl's body to the police and blocked key transportation routes. The mob also set

several vehicles on fire. Train services on the Sealdah-Namkhana line were completely disrupted for about an hour due to the protests. Road traffics also remained blocked for nearly five hours as locals sat in protest on the streets with the girl's body. One policeman was admitted to the hospital. Police had initially registered a murder case after the girl was found dead in the pond. Following a postmortem examination, police added charges of gangrape under the POCSO Act. "The preliminary postmortem report confirmed sexual assault. She was alive when she was dumped in the pond. The postmortem report confirmed antemortem drowning with water in her lungs," a senior police officer said. Police arrested Pravash Mondol on Sunday, hours after the local residents protested and ransacked police vehicles. "After interrogating Pravash, we arrested Dibakar Sardar and Ananda Sardar on Monday.

Ananda Sardar is suspected of having played a key role in the crime. They were produced before the court and sent to 14-day police custody," said a senior police officer. "We are looking for a fourth man who is also suspected to be involved in the crime and is currently absconding," the officer added. The police also said they were not ruling out a child-trafficking angle in the case. The political fallout from the incident continued to escalate on Monday. While former CM Mamata Banerjee alleged she was being prevented from meeting the victim's family, a TMC delegation comprising Dola Sen, Pratima Mondal, and Biman Banerjee met them. Addressing the media on Monday, Adhikari described the crime as "horrific" and said an SIT had been constituted. "After the incident, I spoke to the victim's father. Whatever the family expects from the administration, we will deliver. We will extend all help. They will get justice," he said, adding that four separate cases have been registered. "In the first case, we will ensure justice for the family and

seek capital punishment for the culprits. However, there has also been a mob lynching. I am not giving anyone a clean chit, but the lynching had a communal angle. Police vehicles were torched, two CAPF personnel were injured, and there was an attempt to block railway tracks. In the remaining three cases, action will also be taken. Those who were involved will have to pay for it," the CM said. Adhikari said he would visit Baruiapur on Tuesday and review the role of the police. In a statement on social media, Banerjee alleged that she had effectively been prevented from leaving her home. "I don't know why they are not letting me go out. I don't know why I am such a threat. We are the original TMC, but those aligned with the BJP are being allowed to hold political programmes," she said, adding that she had spoken to the victim's family over the phone. On Monday, she held a candlelight march. She was briefly stopped by police after she left her Kalighat residence, but was later allowed to continue her protest till Hazra Crossing.

Indira Point

roads on stilts — and, in exceptional cases, for defence, strategic purposes and public utilities, subject to detailed impact assessment. Under ICRZ-IV, several activities, including land reclamation, bunding and control of erosion, are permitted and regulated. The development comes against the backdrop of the proposed Great Nicobar Island mega infrastructure project, which involves construction of a transshipment port at Galathea Bay, a greenfield airport, a power plant and an integrated township. Indira Point is located to the south of Galathea Bay. According to the Indira Point project's ICRZ map report, prepared by Anna University, the lighthouse falls in ICRZ-

IVA, while the project site boundary and other proposed facilities, including a temporary approach bund, fall in ICRZ-IA. The development work has been proposed mainly on the grounds that the lighthouse structure needs to be safeguarded and safe access to it restored, in light of continuous erosion, wave action and shoreline changes. An Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) report by PSU WAPCOS Ltd, and a Detailed Project Report by the Department of Ocean Engineering, IIT-Madras, have been submitted as part of the official proposal. The EIA report includes a coral reef survey conducted in shallow intertidal and subtidal zones. It does not specify the

impact of the proposed project on corals, if any, or the extent of corals found near the lighthouse. The report notes that during the construction phase, activities such as transportation of materials, piling work and shoreline protection work may affect air quality, coastal water quality and marine sediments. According to a letter dated June 18, sent by the Directorate of Lighthouses and Lightships, Sri Vijaya Puram, under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, to the Andaman and Nicobar Coastal Zone Management Authority under the Union Territory administration, the proposed work will be carried out in phases. The first phase, records show, involves the construction of a peripheral piled platform around the lighthouse, a piled approach structure, a rock bund, an asphalt road, and a temporary jetty.

The second phase will include reclamation work, construction of onshore facilities, slope protection, and eco-tourism facilities such as a convention centre, cafeteria, viewing tower, cycling track, museum building and a memorial or monument structure. Directorate officials said the proposal is yet to be appraised by the Andaman and Nicobar Coastal Zone Management Authority, which has to examine it in accordance with the approved plan and forward it, with its recommendations, to the Environment Ministry. When contacted, Jayanta Chakraborty, Deputy Director, Directorate of Lighthouses and Lightships, Sri Vijaya Puram, said, "We are not going to execute any prohibited activities. Any activity proposed will be carried out after obtaining the relevant and prior clearance from the competent agency."

Scientist

answers but to make sure that every observation is studied with clarity, evidence, and scientific discipline," said Sumer Singh, who has been a judo coach "for 27 years". "Devesh began participating in judo at the age of 10 when he used to go to Hisar's Mahavir Stadium where I coached for years. By 2006, he was part of a seven-member junior team from Haryana that won gold at the Junior Judo Federation Cup in

Hisar. After he turned 17, his interests shifted. We noticed he was more keen on science and decided to encourage him," Singh said. Shakuntla says Devesh's fascination with science began "much earlier". "By the time he reached Class 8, he had developed an interest in the stars. He would ask endless questions about their size and names, and even bought a telescope to observe them more clearly. Soon, he was watching documentaries on Stephen Hawking and reading books on science," she said. Nandal says, "My first

passion is understanding how stars evolve, and I have always wondered that the sheer numbers of stars in our galaxy, the Milky Way, let alone the universe is so vast, there is a large statistical likelihood that life could have originated elsewhere in the universe. Now I have the chance to explore this with an approach deeply rooted in physical laws, and find out whether we are seeing something otherworldly or not." Nandal is married to Dr Virginia Thompson, a US citizen who is currently a human rights officer at the United Nations Of-

fice in Geneva. On the new council, he features among several experts with specialisations across sectors — from data analysis and statistics to anomaly identification, AI tools, oceanography, physics, economics, molecular biology, anthropology and quantitative psychology. In a blog posted on June 19, Prof Avi Loeb wrote: "My approach was to select a few young nerds with exceptional technical skills who are fluent with the latest AI systems... The unifying thread among all members is that L... can attest they are all brilliant."

Trump

The rare reprieve allows Balogun to feature in his country's maiden quarterfinal appearance against Belgium on Tuesday. When the US team management was fretting over alternatives and blaming the referee, Trump found the solution in a simple tap on his phone. According to the *New York Times*, Trump called his "friend" and FIFA boss Gianni Infantino, who had bestowed on him a peace prize during the draw ceremony last year, and asked if FIFA's disciplinary committee could review the decision. Trump called Infantino thrice, reports said. The intervention didn't end there. *The New York Times* reported that the Trump administration recruited lawyers, while

Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick and Scott Goodwin, a donor to US Soccer and hedge fund manager, also played a role. Finally, on Sunday evening here, FIFA announced that the ban on the striker, who is USMNT's top scorer with three goals, was lifted by invoking Chapter 4, Article 27 of the Disciplinary Code. The first clause of the article reads: "The judicial body may decide to fully or partially suspend the implementation of a disciplinary measure." Within minutes, Trump posted on X, "Thank you to FIFA for doing what was right and reversing a great injustice!" Later, speaking to reporters in the Oval Office, Trump said, "All I did, I asked for a review, because I didn't think it was a foul... I didn't tell him what to do. I can't tell him what to do."

It was not the first time that a red card had been revoked in a

World Cup. In 1962, Brazilian legend Garrincha was sent off after kicking a Chile player, angered by a rough tackle. He was let off with a warning after the game, as the linesman did not appear for the hearing. But red cards back then did not carry automatic suspension. It was not the first time heads of state were involved, either. Chilean President Jorge Alessandri and his Brazilian counterpart, Joao Goulart, began negotiating a deal wherein Garrincha, the winger with electric heels, would not miss any game. Peruvian President Manuel Prado Ugarteche personally called the referee, his compatriot, to downplay the incident. But these details were known only much later. In the modern era, after FIFA's regulations were codified, overturning one-match bans has been rare. Now, the "aston-

ished" Royal Belgian Football Federation is deliberating whether to appeal against the overturned ban. The team's coach, Rudi Garcia, said: "I just found out that July 5 is FIFA's April Fools' Day." European football's governing body, UEFA, questioned FIFA's integrity. "Sometimes rules are open to interpretation. In this case not. A minimum automatic suspension of one match following a red card is not a discretionary option and does not require the decision of a competent body to be enacted," UEFA said. Bans are seldom fully wiped away, but often reduced. "It is a principle embedded in regulations, which cannot be made subject to exceptions, let alone in the middle of a tournament where several other players have been in the same situation and regularly served their suspension," it said.

25% ethanol blend

concerns: one, central excise duty exemption for blended fuel (22%-30% ethanol) and two, fuel standards notified by BIS for these blends. These measures were inferred as heralding the government's intent to prepare the vehicular and fuel ecosystems for the next stage of ethanol adoption, with the specific proposal to go beyond E20 stoking concern among both car makers and motorists. But even before this, the rapid upshift or advancing of the transition to E20 by five years has left a section of consumers complaining about a perceptible drop in fuel economy. They have also expressed concerns over vehicular part damage in older cars, especially as ethanol content progressively goes up. In the backdrop of such sentiments, a meeting at the most senior levels of the government last week is learnt to have advised about the need to scientifically address some of the genuine concerns. This included an effort to ask OEMs (original equipment manufacturers) to address the consumer complaints. Officials also said some of which are inferred to be "overblown". The sources said the government reckons the need to give sufficient time for ecosystem readiness and why they must avoid pushing through the transition to the E25 fuel, especially in the context of the rushed E20 transition earlier. "There is a view (within the government) that the transition beyond E20 will need to be spaced out. That is the sense we have got from vehicle manufacturers too. The idea is to go to E25 in a calibrated, graded manner for existing vehicles," a senior government official told *The Indian Express*. It is, however, the transition to the E25 fuels that has players in the vehicular ecosystem worried, especially given how rushed the E10 to E20 transition was. For older vehicles and those certified for E10 petrol, this transition came about rather quickly, without sufficient warnings of the consumer-end pitfalls. The experience left motorists, especially those owning older cars and two-wheelers, feeling somewhat short-changed. Using a higher ethanol blend in petrol for engines, especially those not designed for these Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mIjMzg1

blends, results in a drop in fuel economy depending on when the car was manufactured. Older vehicles fare comparatively worse in this transition. While a fuel with 10% ethanol (E10) made little difference to a car's performance, the transition to E20 did impact the operational parameters of older vehicles. And the worsening of the performance does not exactly progress in a linear fashion as the blending levels keep increasing. Ethanol has lower calorific value than petrol, which results in a perceptible drop in mileage. Also, regular petrol cars running on higher ethanol blends, alongside the drop in mileage, are harder to start on winter mornings because ethanol burns at a higher temperature than petrol. The concern that auto companies have expressed is that filling E25 fuel in internal combustion engine vehicles, especially older ones, could see some damage to parts owing to factors like corrosion, given ethanol's hygroscopic nature that promotes water uptake. Ethanol also has its positives, including a higher octane number (or the fuel's ability to withstand premature combustion due to compression). Plus, higher blending is more eco-friendly given ethanol's lower carbon content and cuts down on fuel imports. Multiple car-makers in India told *The Indian Express* that they have now begun working on engines with higher compression ratios to extract the maximum mileage out of higher ethanol blends, but that is all for the future. The transition to E25 is something that vehicle owners privately admit to be concerned about, especially if this is rushed through. On its part, the government continues to maintain that the rollout of higher ethanol-petrol blends will only be done after proper testing and stakeholder consultations. The proposed E25 transition requires automakers to do additional engineering and validation work around engine calibration, fuel-system durability, corrosion resistance, and material compatibility. And homologation — the process that officially certifies a vehicle or component as compliant with regulations pertaining to safety, environment, and roadworthiness — at the end. All this needs time, which could be impacted if the transition is a rushed affair.

2020 riot victims

were killed and more than 700 were injured in the riots that began on February 23, 2020. "The SC's judgment (Re: Destruction of Public & Private Properties vs. State of AP and Ors, April 16, 2009) says that the compensation will be given by the persons who have caused the destruction, and not by the government, certainly," standing counsel for Delhi government Sameer Vashisht told a division Bench of High Court Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia on Monday. The court responded orally: "Under the earlier judgments of the Supreme Court, you have to recover the amount from those who are responsible [for the damage]. Have you recovered that amount? They (victims) can't go to them (perpetrators) to recover the amount, can they?... You have to evolve a mechanism for realisation of the damage caused by such persons; is that mechanism in place?" Vashisht responded that trials of the accused were "still continuing". On whether the mechanism for the realisation

of damages had been set up, Vashisht said, "Not yet". On January 15, 2025, following a request by the victims, a single judge Bench of the court had directed the government to disburse the compensation. The AAP government, which was in power at the time, did not oppose the request. The current government, which took over in February last year, has since claimed that the proxy counsel who appeared on behalf of the standing counsel when the order was passed had given the government's 'No Objection' "inadvertently" and "without any instructions or authorisation from either the standing counsel or the concerned departmental authorities". In September 2025, the Delhi government moved an application before the single judge seeking a recall of the court's January 15, 2025 order. The single judge dismissed the recall application on May 7 this year. On May 29, the government appealed against the May 7 order, and asked for the January 15, 2025 order to be recalled.

Purge

Secretary) or on co-terminus basis or till he ceases to function as Private Secretary to the Minister, was being "terminated" with immediate effect. "In pursuance of Department of Personnel and Training's O.M. No 23/1/2024... dated 2nd July, 2026, and with the approval of the competent authority, the appointment of Shri Ayush Saran as Additional Private Secretary to the Hon'ble Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change is terminated with immediate effect. Shri Ayush Saran is relieved of his duties immediately," said the order, signed by Under Secretary Vibhuti Panjiyar. Copies of the order were marked to the PMO, Cabinet Secretariat and DoPT, among others.

the order said. A third order said the appointment of Ayush Saran, also Additional Private Secretary to the minister, was being "terminated" with immediate effect. "In pursuance of Department of Personnel and Training's O.M. No 23/1/2024... dated 2nd July, 2026, and with the approval of the competent authority, the appointment of Shri Ayush Saran as Additional Private Secretary to the Hon'ble Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change is terminated with immediate effect. Shri Ayush Saran is relieved of his duties immediately," said the order, signed by Under Secretary Vibhuti Panjiyar. Copies of the order were marked to the PMO, Cabinet Secretariat and DoPT, among others.

ARRESTED IN DOWRY DEATH CASE ‘Husband didn’t like her working, hit her’: Kin of Delhi woman who ‘fell to death’

Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 6

WHEN AKRITI, 28, took up a job as a sales executive at a firm in Delhi’s Chattarpur in 2021, it marked both a career step and a responsibility she had to shoulder. Her father, Ashok Sutar, a civil contractor, had died from cancer, leaving behind Akriti, her mother Anu Sutar, and a younger brother who had just completed his B.Com.

At 24, she had become the family’s main support. She sent money home regularly, her family said. “She was always happy...,” said Mananjay, her uncle. “She wanted to take care of her mother and for her brother to be set before she settled down.”

On July 4 — a little over two months after getting married — Akriti was found dead inside Palika Kunj apartment complex in Lodhi Colony. Her husband, Arastu Sikka, has now been arrested in the case, said police.

It was around 2023 that she reconnected with a former schoolmate. Through her, Akriti renewed contact with her brother, Arastu, whom she had also known from school. The friend suggested that Akriti date her brother. Akriti and Arastu were in a relationship for three years before getting married on April 24. What followed after the wedding would upend the life she had built. There were fights over her job, which she eventually quit, alleged demands for dowry and physical abuse, claimed her family.

Last week, however, they said Akriti decided to rejoin work. The apartment complex in Lodhi Colony where she was found dead days later, is a cluster of three-storey, brutalist grey stone buildings she had never visited. “Prima facie, it is a case of suicide,” said a police officer. “It seems she jumped off the third floor.”

Her family, however, has alleged harassment by her husband and in-laws. Arastu was arrested after a case was registered under BNS sections 80 (dowry death) and 85 (cruelty).

In the days following her death, her family claimed there were signs of strain from the very beginning.

When Akriti had first told her mother about Arastu, she was a little wary of Arastu’s approach to career and his general behaviour. As per the FIR, Anu had ‘warned’ Akriti about marrying Arastu. But after Arastu reached a “reluctant understanding” over Akriti’s job, said Mananjay, the marriage went ahead. “She quit the job around two months after the marriage after a lot of fights with Arastu.”

“Arastu had a problem that she sent Rs 5,000 to her mother and brother, and wanted her to leave the job. Despite knowing the financial condition of the family, he demanded Rs 10 lakh dowry and a car,” he alleged.

He did not have a stable job, the uncle claimed. He “assaulted her”, alleged her family. According to the FIR, Anu said that just a month into the



Akriti and Arastu got married in April. FILE

marriage, Arastu allegedly started beating her daughter. The initial arguments started because of Akriti’s job.

“Arastu did the household chores as she (Akriti) would go out and earn. That made him feel ‘small’. He felt his father’s money was enough to run the house, and hence started asking her to leave the job. He told police that he used to beat his wife,” said a senior police officer. Arastu’s friend Mahesh said he never suspected there was anything “off” between Arastu and Akriti. “Around Muharram (June 16) this year, we went to a water park. They looked very much in love. The fact that he used to beat her is surprising...”

As per the FIR, however, Akriti told her mother on June 17 that Arastu allegedly hit her with a belt because she did not pick his call; he suspected that she was having an affair. On June 29, the FIR alleged, Akriti was beaten by Arastu again.

“On July 3, I called Arastu’s father and told him that my daughter was becoming depressed because of the violence. He spoke to Arastu and scolded him, but Arastu snapped back and abused him...,” Anu alleged in her complaint to police.

On July 4, Akriti called her mother to say she had another fight with her husband and had decided to rejoin work. She told Anu she was throwing a party for her colleagues to mark her “return to self-reliance”.

“Around 6 pm, she called to tell me she had left the office and was returning to her in-laws’ place in Pushp Vihar,” Anu said in her complaint. At 8 pm, Anu said, she got a call from Arastu. He claimed Akriti was not home and had either run away or was hiding at her mother’s place. “Panicking, I called her multiple times but her phone was switched off,” the mother said.

At 9 pm, Anu asked a friend of Akriti’s to call her. This time, the phone rang, but a policeman answered. “He asked us to come to Lodhi Colony. We found out our daughter was dead.”

Police said they got a call from one Neeraj Kumar, who lives in Lodhi Colony; he had found Akriti’s body. Police found her handbag, slippers and dupatta on the rooftop of the building from where she is suspected to have jumped.

Akriti was taken to AIIMS where doctors declared her dead on arrival, police said.

Govt planning major administrative rejig

EXPRESS exclusive



The move follows directions from Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. EXPRESS

Accounts and 29 Senior Accounts Officers. In addition, 19 Senior Accounts Officers were promoted as Deputy Controllers of Accounts, expanding their responsibilities in recognition of their performance.

“Following the CM’s directions, the transfers and postings have been made purely on the basis of administrative requirements and with the objective of promoting integrity

years” in their departments, sources added.

According to sources, the latest move — which is being executed weeks after the Capital saw a major bureaucratic rejig — comes in the wake of the directions from Chief Minister Rekha Gupta to bring transparency and curb corruption. “The process has already been started and transfers are taking place. The CM strictly ordered that there is no place for corruption, laxity, or negligence at any level of governance...,” said a senior official. The officers may be transferred within or outside their respective departments.

Recently, the government conducted a major reshuffle in the Finance and Accounts department where 52 officers, who had been serving at the same place for five years or more, were transferred with immediate effect. These included 23 Deputy Controllers of

Officers working in ‘comfort zones’ for over five years to be in focus

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 6

THE DELHI government is planning a major administrative reshuffle with around 60-70% of cadre and ex-cadre officials — including DANICS (Delhi, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep, Daman and Diu, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli (Civil) Service) officers, ad-hoc DANICS officers, Sub-Divisional Magistrates (SDMs) and other Grade-I officers — likely to be transferred, said sources. These officials and staffers “have been working in a ‘comfort zone’ for over five

‘Internal combustion engine has reached its technological limit... (But) transition to electric must go hand in hand with cleaner power sources’



EXPERT EXPLAINS
GAUHAH RAZA

Why is the transition to electric vehicles important?

Because the internal combustion engine (ICE) has more or less reached its technological limits. For decades, engineers have tried to improve its efficiency. There have certainly been improvements, but most of them have come through better accessories, electronics, design, and supporting systems rather than dramatic gains in the engine itself. That is why research and innovation are increasingly focused on electric mobility. This is where the next technological leap is expected. The future of transportation is moving in that direction.

You say ICE technology has reached the limits of its efficiency. Can you explain?

The overall efficiency of a vehicle is determined by the combined efficiency of its components, not by the maximum efficiency of any single part. In an internal combustion engine, energy is lost at several stages — through heat, friction and the various mechanical systems that transfer power from the engine to the wheels. Even if individual components are improved, overall efficiency has a practical ceiling. That is why, despite decades of research, there has been only limited scope to

significantly improve the efficiency of ICE vehicles.

Are EVs the last word in environmental terms?

EVs certainly reduce pollution within cities because there are no tailpipe emissions. But we must look at the entire energy chain.

If the electricity used to charge these vehicles comes from thermal power plants, then a part of the environmental burden is shifted from cities to the places where electricity is generated. So, while EVs improve urban air quality, their overall environmental benefit depends on how clean the electricity grid is. The transition to electric mobility should go hand in hand with cleaner sources of power generation.

From an engineering perspective, how are EVs different from conventional vehicles?

One important difference is regenerative braking. In a conventional vehicle, much of the energy is lost as heat when you apply the brakes. In an electric vehicle, part of that energy can be recovered and sent back to the battery. That means driving behaviour becomes much more important. Smooth acceleration, anticipating traffic conditions, and avoiding unnecessary braking all help improve efficiency. The vehicle rewards efficient driving.

Why is the range of an EV such an important part of the conversation around electric mobility?

The battery can run the

motor only for a limited time as it stores a finite amount of energy. Its capacity is measured in ampere-hours, and the amount of energy it delivers depends on the electrical load placed on it. The greater the load on the battery the faster its stored energy is consumed. Rapid acceleration, repeated braking, and aggressive driving all increase the load on the battery, reducing the distance the vehicle can travel on a single charge.

The range of an EV is determined not only by the battery’s rated capacity but also by how efficiently stored energy is used. Manufacturers usually specify a certified range under standard testing conditions. In real-world conditions, the range depends on how the vehicle is driven. If driven smoothly under favourable conditions, the vehicle may even exceed its certified range.

What are the biggest challenges that remain before EVs can become mainstream?

One is the availability of charging infrastructure. Another is ensuring that electricity increasingly comes from cleaner sources. What also needs attention is what happens to batteries after they reach the end of their life. We need effective systems for their reuse, recycling, and safe disposal. As EV adoption grows, battery life-

and transparency in the system. To make the administration more efficient, the government has assigned new responsibilities to 23 Deputy Controllers of Accounts and 29 Senior Accounts Officers,” said an official.

Besides, the CM has also been seen actively keeping an eye on the functioning of bureaucracy and administrative level officials. A few months ago in April, she also carried out a surprise inspection at the Trade and Taxes department at ITO. After finding that several senior level officials were not present in their desks, she ordered for strict implementation of the biometric attendance system for all the officials, including additional chief secretaries and secretary level officials.

Show-cause notices were also issued to several officials who were found absent. The department later transferred a

cycle management will become increasingly important.

Do you see hydrogen as an alternative to battery electric vehicles?

Hydrogen is a promising technology, and research is continuing in that area. But it is still very expensive. Producing hydrogen, storing it, transporting it and building the infrastructure required to use it involve high costs. We know when Hydrogen and Oxygen are mixed, they form water (H₂O). The same reaction is used for charging a ‘bank of cells’ which drives an electric motor. Oxygen is in plenty in the atmosphere, but Hydrogen as fuel is way more expensive compared to traditional fuel or even electricity. Therefore, for the proliferation of this technology, either we have to wait for a major technological breakthrough or a situation where we run out of options.

Hydrogen may play an important role in the future, particularly for certain applications, but at the moment, it cannot replace battery-electric vehicles on a large scale. Only large buses and heavy transport vehicles fuelled by Hydrogen come close to a viable option.

Gauhar Raza is a science communicator and a former Chief Scientist with the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). He spoke with *Sophiya Mathew*.

FULL INTERVIEW ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

total of 162 officers and employees, including three Assistant Commissioners, especially those who had remained posted at the same location for more than three years. The reshuffle included 58 Grade-I Section Officers, 22 Grade-II Assistant Section Officers, 74 Grade-III Senior Assistants and 5 Grade-IV Junior Assistants.

Apart from this, Gupta recently had also recommended to Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu to transfer 39 doctors posted in Tiham and Mandoli jails for over five years. The list included both specialist doctors and General Duty Medical Officers (GDMOs).

Officials said that several of these doctors have remained posted at the same location since 2014, with their tenure exceeding 11 years. The proposal also included the deployment of around 35 other doctors in their place. In total, approximately 74 transfers have been proposed.

Sources said that directions have also been given to departments concerned for making a list of officials posted in the same position for a longer period. “Some staffers are posted in the same post because of health reasons or any important project but the reshuffling has to be done in every three years especially those posted in finance and accounts dealing sections...more such transfers are expected in the coming months,” the official underlined.

Last month, the Delhi government transferred over 50 IAS and DANICS officers, including secretaries of four ministers and secretary-level officials in the Health Department. Sources said the transfers came following alleged irregularities in the procurement of medical equipment.

EXPRESS Careers

NDUAT-07/नियमन/विज्ञापन/2026/658 दिनांक-04-07-2026

Acharya Narendra Deva University of Agriculture & Technology, Kumarganj, Ayodhya - 224229 (U.P.)

Advertisement

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for various posts on regular basis

Advertisement No. 1/2026 - Six (06) post of Professor

Advertisement No. 2/2026 - Ten (10) post of Associate Professor

Advertisement No. 3/2026 - Fourteen (14) post of Professor (Veterinary College)

Advertisement No. 4/2026 - Six (06) post of Associate Professor (Vet. College)

Advertisement No. 5/2026 - Three (03) post of Assistant Professor (Vet. College)

Advertisement No. 6/2026 - Four (04) post of Professor

Advertisement No. 7/2026 - Six (06) post of Associate Professor

Advertisement No. 8/2026 - Two (02) post of Associate Professor & Equivalent

Advertisement No. 9/2026 - One (01) post of Director Agricultural Experiment Station

Advertisement No. 10/2026 - One (01) post of Director Extension

Advertisement No. 11/2026 - Two (02) post of Medical Officer

Details of above advertisements may be downloaded from the University Website - www.nduat.org

Director Administration & Monitoring

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Last date for submitting online applications | 05.08.2026

Details of vacancies may be seen at the official website: www.nhsrcl.in

SCAN FOR MORE INFO

Addendum/further communication in this regard, (if any), will be notified on the NHSRCL website ONLY.

BEWARE OF FRAUDSTERS !!

All vacancy notifications are published only on the official NHSRCL website

 **INSTITUTE OF BANKING PERSONNEL SELECTION**
(The autonomous body set up by Reserve Bank of India, Central Financial Institutions and Public Sector Banks)

आवृत्ति नं. १२४ का परीक्षा तिथि ०५ अगस्त २०२६

CRP PO/MT-XVI and CRP SPL-XVI

COMMON RECRUITMENT PROCESS FOR RECRUITMENT OF PROBATIONARY OFFICERS/ MANAGEMENT TRAINEES AND SPECIALIST OFFICERS (Vacancies of 2027-28) IN PARTICIPATING BANKS

Official Website: www.ibps.in

In case of queries / complaints please log in to <https://cgrs.ibps.in>

The Online Examinations for the upcoming Common Recruitment Process (CRP) for Recruitment and Selection of Probationary Officers / Management Trainees and Specialist Officers' Cadre Posts in Participating Public Sector Banks are tentatively scheduled as follows:

IMPORTANT DATES		
Activity	PO/MT	Specialist Officers
On-line registration including Edit/ Modification of Application by candidates	01.07.2026 to 21.07.2026	01.07.2026 to 21.07.2026
Payment of Application Fees/Intimation Charges (Online)	01.07.2026 to 21.07.2026	01.07.2026 to 21.07.2026
Edit Window for Candidates to Modify/ Correct Application Form (including online payment for Edit)	After closure of Registration (will be notified on Official IBPS website)	After closure of Registration (will be notified on Official IBPS website)
Conduct of Pre-Exam Training	August 2026	--
Online Examination – Preliminary	August 2026	August 2026
Result of Online exam – Preliminary	September 2026	September / October 2026
Online Examination – Main	October 2026	November 2026
Declaration of Result – Main Examination	November 2026	November 2026
Personality Test	November 2026	--
Conduct of interview	November / December 2026	November / December 2026
Provisional Allotment	January 2027	January 2027

Candidates are advised to regularly visit the official IBPS website www.ibps.in for details and updates.

Candidates intending to apply are advised to read detailed Notification carefully and ensure that they fulfil the minimum eligibility criteria on the stipulated dates before registering online. Candidates must follow the instructions mentioned in each detailed Notification.

Mumbai Date: 01/07/2026 DIRECTOR

• Skywatch


Forecast: July 7, 2026
Partly cloudy sky. Moderate or light rain, thunderstorm

MAX: 35-37
0.4°C above normal

MIN: 26-28
0.1°C above normal

- Sunrise: 5:30 AM (July 8)
- Sunset: 7:23 PM (July 7)
- Moonrise: 11:48 PM (July 30)
- Moonset: 1:00 PM (July 8)

• AQI Tracker


Bawana
Moderate
AQI: 133


Anand Vihar
Moderate
AQI: 137


Aya Nagar
Satisfactory
AQI: 72


Najafgarh
Satisfactory
AQI: 69

● Good (0-50)
● Satisfactory (51-100)
● Moderate (101-200)
● Poor (201-300)
● Very Poor (301-400)
● Severe (401-500)

**Government of India**
Ministry of Rural Development
National Rural Infrastructure Development Agency
5th Floor, 15-NBCC Tower, Bhikaji Cama Place
New Delhi-110066

Advt. No. 03/2026

Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme of Government of India to provide good quality road connectivity in rural areas of the country. National Rural Infrastructure Development Agency (NRIDA), under Union Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD), provides technical and managerial support to States/UTs for implementing the Programme. NRIDA invites applications for appointment on Deputation/contract basis as per the following details:

S. No.	Name of the post	Pay Level (as per 7th CPC)	Mode of Recruitment	No. of Post (s)
1.	Director (Finance & Administration)	14	Deputation/contract	01
2.	Director (Project/Technical)	14	Deputation/contract	01
3.	Joint Director (Project/Technical)	13A	Deputation/contract	04
4.	Deputy Director (Project/Technical)	12	Deputation/contract	02
5.	Assistant Director (Finance & Administration)	11	Deputation	01

The no. of vacancies may vary as per actual requirement.

Applications for the post on deputation basis should be submitted through proper channel and accompanied with cadre clearance, vigilance clearance and certified copies of APARs of last five years. Applicants applying on contract basis should submit their applications only through email at nrida-vacancies@pmgsy.nic.in. Applicants (Retired Govt. employees) applying on contract basis may submit copies of APARs for the last five years / VC from where they retired.

The last date of receipt of application in NRIDA is 45 days from the date of the advertisement in the Employment News.

For detailed eligibility criteria and application format, please visit website <https://nrida.dord.gov.in> under the ‘Advertisement’ icon or <https://www.dord.gov.in> under ‘offerings’ icon.

National Rural Infrastructure Development Agency (NRIDA) reserves the right to cancel, withdraw, modify or not fill any or all of the advertised posts/vacancies at any stage without assigning any reason.

Sd/-
Assistant Director (F&A)
CBC 35104/11/0007/2627

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DME invites applications for admission through Management Quota Seats for 2026-27 Session

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B-12, Sector-62, Noida Call: 7042667516

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• B.Tech (CSE, CSE in DS & AIMA and AIMA)

• B.Tech Lateral Entry

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Tuesday, 07 July 2026 at 3:00pm

Venue:
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Prime Ministers Museum and Library
Teen Murti House, New Delhi

All are Welcome.
Those wishing to have their names added to the email list may please email us at: rajnishpmmml@gmail.com

CBC- 09142/11/0017/2627

EXPRESS special

1,091 trees to be transplanted, felled: Forest dept nod clears way for Sarojini Nagar housing project

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, July 6

AFTER MONTHS of site inspections and a review by the Central Empowered Committee (CEC), the Delhi government's Department of Forests and Wildlife has given a nod to the NBCC (India) Limited to make way for the redevelopment of Sarojini Nagar's General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA) Colony by felling or transplanting 1,091 trees, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

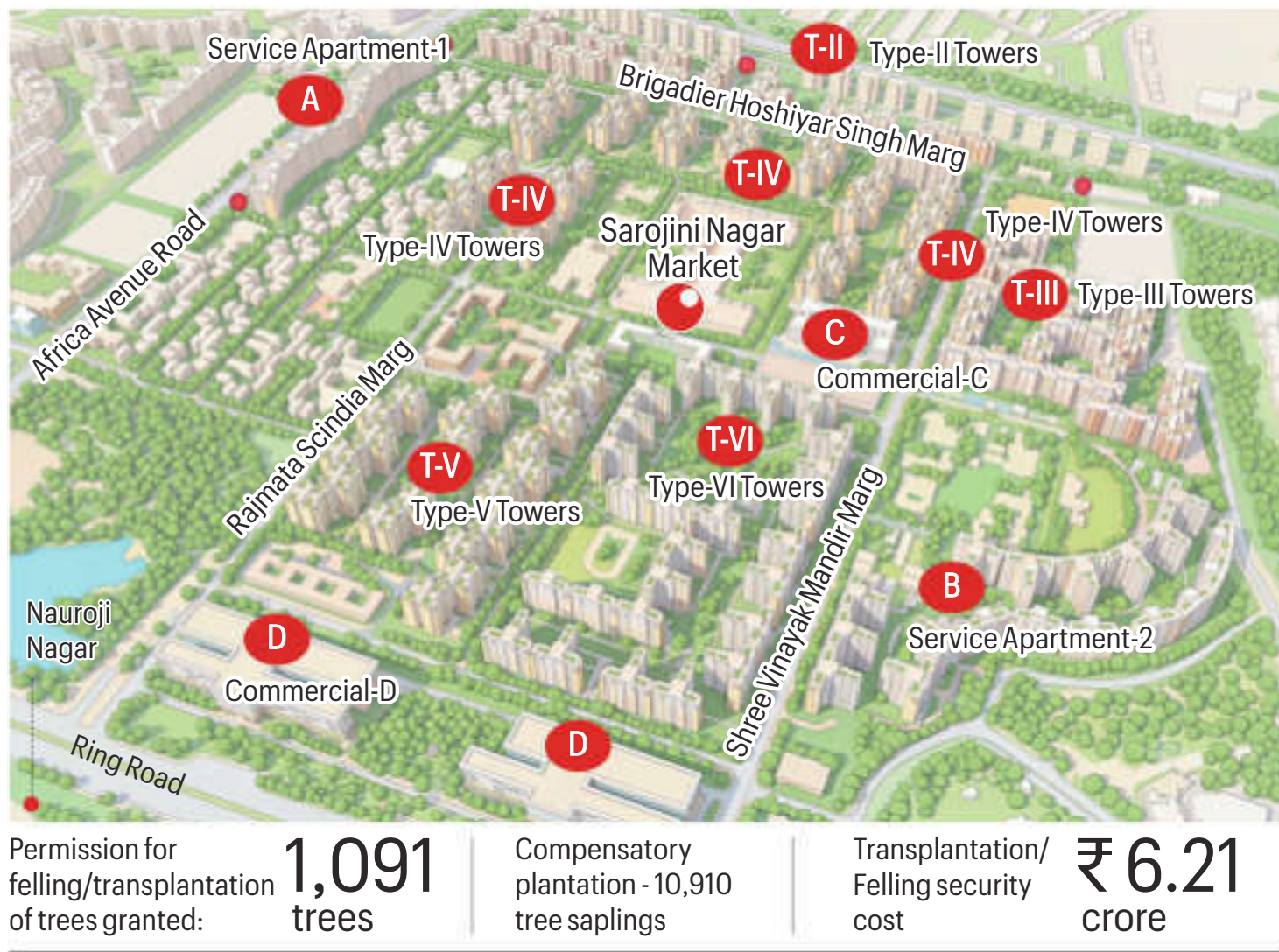
The number of affected trees was brought down through a multi-stage review process before a final approval, said officials. The original count of 1,218 was first brought down to 1,170 after the Tree Officer concerned carried out a site inspection and refined the list, saving 48 trees. The matter was then referred to the CEC, which, in its order dated May 11, 2026, saved a further 79 trees, bringing the final figure to 1,091. The final nod from the Forest department for the project came on June 19, said sources.

While NBCC (India) Limited is a public sector undertaking operating under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA), the CEC is a statutory body set up by the Supreme Court and it is operating under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.

This redevelopment project in Sarojini Nagar is part of a larger Central government initiative approved by the Union Cabinet in July 2016 for the overhaul of seven ageing GPRA colonies in the Capital.

Among these seven colonies, Netaji Nagar and Nauroji Nagar, and Sarojini Nagar were assigned to NBCC (India) Limited for redevelopment, while

• Sarojini Nagar is one of the biggest areas being covered



SOURCE: DELHI URBAN ART COMMISSION (2020)

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Kasturba Nagar, Thyagraj Nagar, Srinivaspuri and Mohammadpur were handed to the Central Public Works Department (CPWD), which also operates under MoHUA.

The plan envisages replacing roughly 12,970 old Type I to IV government flats with over 21,000 modern units, along with new office space, using a self-financing model in which commercial development along stretches such as the Ring Road helps fund the housing construction. Sarojini Nagar is among the largest areas being covered in this programme, with the colony's redevelopment covering both large-scale residential towers and a planned commercial hub

named Bharat Business Park.

What are GPRA colonies

The GPRA colonies — that date back to the 1940s — were set up to house Central government staff, and have long been administered by the Directorate of Estates. Officials have pointed to a persistent shortage of government housing in the National Capital Region as the rationale for demolishing the older, low-rise quarters in favour of denser, high-rise development that makes more efficient use of available land under the Master Plan for Delhi.

The project has been moving forward in phases over the past decade, with newly constructed

flats in Sarojini Nagar and Kasturba Nagar formally inaugurated earlier this year. These are part of a broader tranche of 2,700 new units, with roughly 6,600 more units planned across the four NBCC and CPWD-led colonies.

NBCC has already delivered comparable redevelopment work at Nauroji Nagar, where its World Trade Center complex was completed early last year, and at other GPRA sites such as New Moti Bagh and East Kidwai Nagar. The overall seven-colony programme, estimated to cost around Rs 32,000 crore, is expected to be complete by 2028.

'Every tree mapped'

It is against this backdrop

that the Delhi Forest department's recent order, permitting NBCC to fell or transplant 1,091 trees at the Sarojini Nagar site, fits in, clearing one of the remaining regulatory requirements for construction to proceed on the colony's undeveloped pockets. "It was a long process to approve the project. Ground inspections were carried out and every tree was mapped. After this, the site map was extensively studied and superimposed with the trees surveyed to count the number of trees affected. Since we realised the project is important. The aim was to reduce the number of trees affected," a top official involved in the permission process told *The Indian Express*.

The senior official explained that, under the Delhi Preservation of Trees Act, 1994, a legislation enacted by the government of Delhi to protect, preserve, and regulate the felling or transplantation of trees, a tree is defined as any woody plant with branches supported by a trunk measuring at least 5 cm in diameter (taken 30 cm above ground level) and standing at least 1 metre tall. By this definition, several rootstocks of Prosopis juliflora and other immature specimens are also classified as trees. Consequently, the actual number of fully grown trees affected on the ground is lower, the official said. As part of the compensatory framework, a plantation site at Bharat Vandana Park in West Delhi's Dwarka was inspected by forest field staff and found suitable to accommodate 10,910 saplings, while the same site was also cleared for the transplantation of 1,049 of the affected trees, said officials.

Inside the plot targeting Guru Randhawa's gym and Haryana gym trainer

Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 6

ON JUNE 10, six men allegedly picked up a cache of foreign-made firearms — Turkey-made Zigana pistols and Pakistan-made TT-30 .30-bore weapons — from a location between Hansi and Sonipat in Haryana.

They were assigned separate targets in Delhi and Haryana the next day, police said.

On June 11, in a span of two hours, one group fired at Guru Randhawa-owned 24 HS Gym in Delhi's Paschim Vihar while the second group shot dead gym trainer Kapil Redhu outside his gym in Hansi.

The six accused — Arman, Tushar, Sagar, Haqeeqat, Pravesh and Himanshu, aged between 19 and 22 -- were from Haryana's Hisar and Sonipat districts. Police said all of them were allegedly connected to Anil Pandit and Sunder Hansi, associates of the Harry Boxer-led Lawrence Bishnoi gang, through encrypted messaging applications Signal and Zangi.

Arman, Tushar, Sagar and Haqeeqat were arrested by the Delhi Police Crime Branch and Special Cell after they were identified through CCTV footage later in June.

The two other alleged shooters, Pravesh and Himanshu, were gunned down during an encounter with a joint team of the Haryana and Delhi Police in Bahadurgarh during the early hours of Sunday.

Police said the case is the latest example of gangsters increasingly using foreign-made pistols in shootings across Delhi and the National Capital Region (NCR). "The pistols used in both crimes are suspected to have been smuggled through the Pakistan border using drones, which is happening on a massive scale," a police officer said.

According to a police of-



Pravesh and Himanshu were killed in an encounter on Sunday

ficer, the Lawrence syndicate lured these young men, all of whom had studied up to Classes 10 and 12, with promises of a lavish lifestyle. The "lavish lifestyle", the officer said, included expensive shoes, parties, and drinks at high-end bars and hotels. This continued for a few days before they were allegedly assigned their first task. "Arman, Tushar, Sagar and Haqeeqat were assigned to target Guru Randhawa-owned 24 HS Gym while Pravesh and Himanshu were tasked with allegedly targeting Redhu — locations nearly 130 km apart. Stolen vehicles were also provided to them, following which they allegedly opened fire at their respective targets," the police officer said.

When police arrested Sagar and Haqeeqat, they claimed to have recovered a Pakistan-made TT 30-style .30-bore pistol from one of the suspects. They said it matched the type allegedly used in the gym shooting. While the TT 30 design dates to the Soviet era, police said the seized weapon is a Pakistani-manufactured version of that model, which is often smuggled into India.

'Gang' claims responsibility

In the Paschim Vihar case, police had said two men on a bike fired seven rounds, which shattered the window panes of the gym. The gym is located on the fourth floor of a commer-

cial building. The other floors house popular fast-food chains Popeye's and Domino's, which see heavy footfall throughout most of the day. Redhu, 25, was shot dead while he was conducting an outdoor morning training session near Fawwara Chowk in Hansi, when two men fired 10 rounds at point-blank range within five seconds, killing him on the spot. The bullet fragments also injured a female trainee.

Soon after the shootings, an audio clip went viral in which a man claiming to be Harry Boxer, who is believed to be operating from the US, took responsibility for both attacks.

In the purported recording, he alleged that he had warned Randhawa to stay away from Bollywood actor Salman Khan and claimed that the shooting was intended as a warning after the singer allegedly ignored his advice. In the same clip, he claimed Redhu was killed because he was allegedly involved in planning a recent shootout in Shekhpura and Dhani Purnia. Following the two cases, the Special Cell invoked the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) against Boxer, Pandit and other members of their syndicate. Police said the investigation will focus on dismantling the syndicate's financial and logistical network while securing their extradition or deportation.

DESPITE FACING HIGH COURT IRE

Delhi eyes child protection panels in all schools but 7 vacancies in DCPCR yet to be filled 3 yrs on

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 6

EVEN AS the Delhi government on Monday announced that it will set up child protection committees in all 5,363 schools across the Capital, it has failed to fill seven vacancies in the Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights (DCPCR), a statutory body on matters of child rights, over the last three years, that is since July 2023, drawing the High Court ire repeatedly.

According to a press release issued by the government, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday chaired a high-level review meeting at Raj Niwas where di-

The government has issued directions to set up panels in all 5,633 schools across the Capital by the end of July

rections were issued that child protection initiatives should become a permanent and integral part of the functioning of all institutions. Directions were also issued to constitute committees in all 5,633 schools across Delhi by the end of July. These include schools run by the government, MCD, and private schools.

Earlier in February, the High Court had pulled up the

Delhi government's Women and Child Development, with a division bench orally remarking that the state should repeal the Commission for Protection of Child Rights (CPCR) Act if it continues to progress at a snail's pace. The state at the time had sought time till April this year to complete the appointments and justified that the time taken so far has been essential "in the interest of ensuring transparency, fairness" in the process of appointments. But, in April, the state sought further extension by six weeks to issue notification of selected candidates.

However, according to the latest affidavit filed on July 2 by the state, the appointments have not been made, submit-

ting that the department is "making all earnest and necessary efforts to complete the appointment process at the earliest." Advocate Prabhsahay Kaur, who has been assisting the court as amicus curiae in the case, referring to the three-judge bench SC judgment of 2018 in the case of Sampurna Behura vs Union of India, told *The Indian Express*. "The judgment had clearly emphasised on the importance of the Commissions for Child Protection - both national and state-level - even to monitor the implementation of POCSO Act and the Juvenile Justice Act. The judgment had also emphasised that we cannot drown the voice of children in the din of governance."

2 engineering interventions at heart of Gurgaon's plan to tackle waterlogging along key corridor

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 6

CROSS-CONNECTIONS between surface and stormwater drains, and new water chutes: these are the two key engineering interventions introduced by the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) to prevent waterlogging along the Hero Honda Chowk-Umang Bhardwaj Chowk as the Millennium City takes a series of steps to tackle the perennial issue of waterlogging this monsoon season.

The corridor between the two intersections is among Gurgaon's key arterial routes for residents and daily commuters and a lifeline for commercial transit.

Located along the Delhi-Jaipur Expressway (NH-48), Hero

Honda Chowk — that sees heavy vehicular movement — is a major hub for office spaces. It is flanked by the Info Technology Park and houses significant manufacturing bases, including the Hero MotoCorp facility in Sector 33. The intersection also anchors the city's civic administration, with the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) headquarters situated nearby in Sector 34.

Further down the corridor, Umang Bhardwaj Chowk serves as the link connecting the Dwarka Expressway to Delhi-Jaipur Expressway and East Gurgaon.

For thousands of residents in the developing real estate clusters between Sectors 81 and 95, this chowk is the main transit point into the city's residential parts and business hubs. Addi-

tionally, it funnels a substantial volume of traffic entering the city from Pataudi and Rewari.

Because of this high convergence of local, industrial, and inter-city traffic, any waterlogging on this brief corridor leads to severe bottlenecks. When the road floods, it cripples movement across West Gurgaon and leads to traffic snarls that spill over onto the national highway.

To accelerate the discharge of rainwater from the main carriageway, the GMDA has constructed three cross-drain connections along the Sector 10A/37-2 master sector dividing road. Officials said the 600-mm diameter pipelines have been laid to link the surface drains directly with the master stormwater drain. "Coupled with this, new water chutes, or road gullies, have been constructed

at strategic locations along the corridor. These chutes are designed to channel rainwater rapidly from the road surface into the surface drains, which will then empty directly into the master drainage network through the new cross-connections," a GMDA spokesperson said.

These interventions are key to addressing a long-standing infrastructural bottleneck in the city. According to officials, drainage capacity in several areas is severely compromised due to illegal overlaps made by residents between the sewage and stormwater drainage networks. By creating direct cross-drain connections and dedicated road chutes along this high-traffic corridor, the GMDA aims to bypass these compromised networks.

GROUND report

'No child has been missed, right?': Campaign launched after polio virus is found in Ghaziabad sewage

Drishiti Jain
Ghaziabad, July 6

AT 11 ON a Thursday morning, Rajkumari balances a blue vaccine cold box in one hand and a pink file in the other as she knocks on an iron gate in Vijay Nagar, a densely packed neighbourhood in Ghaziabad.

A little girl leans out from a second-floor window. "Is there a small child in the house?" Rajkumari calls. Moments later, a young mother emerges carrying her five-month-old daughter.

Rajkumari asks the baby's name, age and father's name, recording each answer in her register. Beside her, an ASHA worker gently tilts the infant's head back. Two drops of polio vaccine land on her tongue. The baby bursts into tears.

Before leaving, Rajkumari

pauses. "No child has been missed, right?" she asks. "Tell me honestly."

The team moves on.

The urgency behind Rajkumari's rounds lies in a sewage sample collected from Vijay Nagar on June 5. It tested positive for vaccine-derived poliovirus, a rare strain that can circulate in communities where immunisation coverage is low.

India was declared free of wild poliovirus in 2014 after decades of mass immunisation. But environmental surveillance — testing sewage for traces of the virus — continues as an early warning system. After the detection in Ghaziabad, officials traced the sewage network, identified 12 neighbourhoods with about 150,000 residents as high-risk areas, and intensified vaccination efforts under the

watch of the National Centre for Disease Control and the World Health Organization.

Rajkumari is one of hundreds of health workers now working under this intensified campaign, going door to door to ensure no child under five is missed.

They weave through narrow lanes lined with closely packed houses. Some doors stay shut despite repeated knocks. Others are locked, their occupants away at work. Each missed house is marked in Rajkumari's register for another visit.

A few hundred metres away, Vijay Nagar's concrete homes give way to a cluster of tin-roofed shelters beneath an under-construction apartment tower. Families from Bihar and nearby districts of Uttar Pradesh have made homes here, many of



At each house, health workers urge families to tell them if they have a child under 5 years so they can be vaccinated. AMIT MEHRA

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

the men working at construction sites while the women care for children or work as domestic helpers.

Stepping past piles of garbage and algae-covered drains, Rajkumari and Manisha stop at every shack.

"Is there a child under five?" When Shyam, a 32-year-old

"Isko bhi pila do (Give him the drops too)," he says.

Shyam says vaccination campaigns were a familiar part of life in his village.

Every household gets the same question more than once. If someone says there are no children inside, Rajkumari asks again before moving on.

After the sewage detection, officials say they strengthened supervision, redrew vaccination maps and instructed teams to revisit locked homes until every eligible child had been reached.

"We reviewed every area covered in the last round to make sure nothing had been missed," says Dr Soniya Patel, the medical officer in charge overseeing the campaign. "We cannot miss any child."

But reluctance is not confined to the city's poorest neighbourhoods. Amit Pal, 22, another vaccination worker, says some parents refuse to open their doors or insist there are no young children inside. If

persuasion fails, supervisors return to counsel the family.

"We cannot leave any child," he says.

Across the road, in the gated towers of Paramount Symphony, the conversations are different, but the hesitation can be much the same.

Auxiliary Nurse Midwife Usha Yadav recently spent 45 minutes persuading a mother to allow her child to receive the vaccine. Only after showing news reports on her phone about the virus detected in Ghaziabad's sewage did the woman agree. "Only then did she agree," Yadav says.

By 1 pm, Rajkumari returns to the Ayushman Arogya Mandir after five hours on foot. "Some families were away. We will visit again over the next few days," she says.



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

“आप, इस बार सब को साथ जोड़ कर- स्वच्छता और वृक्षारोपण के लिए कुछ प्रयास जरूर करें। आप, खुद भी पेड़ लगाइये और दूसरों को भी प्रेरित करिए।”
नरेन्द्र मोदी, प्रधानमंत्री



मिशन 70 लाख पौधा रोपण अभियान का शुभारंभ

एवं
300 इलेक्ट्रिक बसों सहित
विभिन्न परियोजनाओं का लोकार्पण

मुख्य अतिथि

श्री अमित शाह

माननीय केंद्रीय गृह एवं सहकारिता मंत्री, भारत सरकार

गरिमामयी उपस्थिति

श्री भूपेंद्र यादव

माननीय केंद्रीय पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्री,
भारत सरकार

सरदार तरनजीत सिंह संधू

माननीय उपराज्यपाल, दिल्ली

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

श्री हर्ष मल्होत्रा

माननीय केंद्रीय राज्य मंत्री
(सड़क, परिवहन और राजमार्ग तथा कॉरपोरेट कार्य)

श्री आशीष सूद

माननीय गृह मंत्री, दिल्ली सरकार

सरदार मनजिंदर सिंह सिरसा

माननीय पर्यावरण, वन एवं वन्यजीव मंत्री, दिल्ली सरकार

डॉ. पंकज कुमार सिंह

माननीय परिवहन मंत्री, दिल्ली सरकार

सुश्री बांसुरी स्वराज

माननीय सांसद, नई दिल्ली

श्री प्रवेश वाही

माननीय महापौर,
दिल्ली नगर निगम

श्री अनिल कुमार शर्मा

विधायक, आर के पुरम



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On-field Huddles

ENVIRONMENT MINISTER Bhupender Yadav and senior officials of the ministry will huddle for several back-to-back meetings centred on wildlife this week. Meetings of the Wildlife Board standing committee, Central Zoo Authority, and Wildlife Institute of India Society are slated to be held in Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, in line with the trend of wildlife body meetings on-field. Yadav is also likely to visit Annamalai Tiger Reserve and Parambikulam Wildlife Sanctuary.

Tea Break

ONE OF the stops on BJP president Nitin Nabin's packed itinerary in Uttar Pradesh soon after arrival on Saturday was the popular 'Sharma Ji Ki Chai' shop in Lucknow. Located near the BJP's headquarters in Hazratganj, Nabin, BJP national general secretary (organisation) B L Santhosh, the party's Uttar Pradesh chief Pankej Chaudhary and the party's senior leaders from the state were among those who halted for a quick tea and 'bun maska'. Party workers welcomed Nabin at 40 locations on the way from the airport to the party headquarters.

Traditional Touch

AS ASSAM Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and Japanese Ambassador Ono Keiichi met at the latter's residence in New Delhi on Monday, tradition took the lead. While Sarma presented Keiichi with a 'gamusa' (scarf), the Japanese ambassador hosted the CM for cha-no-yu — the traditional Japanese tea ceremony. The meet came in the wake of the recent India visit of Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi, who was slated to land in Guwahati, but the summit venue was later moved to Delhi.

PM backs Nabin amid row over Kejriwal's 'who are you' jibe

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Monday praised BJP chief Nitin Nabin for his 'simplicity and openness' in an apparent response to former Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal's 'who are you?' jibe directed at the BJP chief.

Sharing two posts from journalist Piyush Padmakar, Nabin's former roommate during his academic years, which detailed how he boarded with three other friends while studying in Delhi and depended on public buses to attend college, PM Modi said in a post on X: "This simplicity and openness is a matter of pride for each BJP 'karyakarta'."

In response, Kejriwal posted: "Thank you for providing information about Nitin ji. Prime Minister ji, the entire country wants to know why those involved in the theft at Shri Ram Mandir, the land scam, and siphoning off commissions in the construction are being protected. When will they receive strict punishment?"

The AAP chief triggered a row Sunday after he asked Nabin "who" he was, quoting his statement from an organisational event in Lucknow. Nabin had accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav, and Kejriwal of keeping mum on "anti-Hindu" statements.

PRIME MINISTER BEGINS THREE-NATION TOUR

Defence, critical minerals on table at India-Indonesia meeting today

Shubhajt Roy
New Delhi, July 6

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Monday began a three-nation tour of Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand. He said the visit, from July 6-11, "will further strengthen India's Act East Policy, MAHASAGAR Vision as well as our outlook towards a free and open Indo-Pacific".

Modi, who reached Jakarta Monday afternoon, was received at the airport by Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto. The two leaders are expected to focus on bilateral cooperation in defence and maritime partnerships, critical minerals, food security and digital economy at their meeting on Tuesday.

"I'm touched by President Prabowo Subianto's gesture of welcoming me at the airport," Modi said on X. "In 2018, we elevated our relations to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, which has benefited our people. During this visit, President Prabowo Subianto and I will hold discussions aimed at adding even more momentum to this partnership across diverse sectors," he said.

While this is his fourth visit to Indonesia, it is the first bilateral visit since the elevation of ties to Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGjOKH6oBd0F>



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Indonesia President Prabowo Subianto after arriving in Jakarta on Monday. ANI

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in May 2018. "President Prabowo and I will visit the Prambanan Temple complex at Yogyakarta. This will ensure closer cultural linkages between our nations," Modi said on X.

Sources said India's defence and security cooperation with Indonesia has seen increased momentum and expanding scope through high-level visits, regular bilateral and multilateral exercises, and deeper defence industry cooperation, including the sale of BrahMos missiles.

As maritime neighbours, both countries adopted the Shared Vision of India-Indonesia Maritime Cooperation in the

E. EXPLAINED

Strong trade ties

Indonesia has emerged as India's second largest trading partner in ASEAN region with bilateral trade of US\$ 24.78 billion in 2025-26. Over 130 Indian companies are invested in different sectors in Indonesia.

Indo-Pacific in 2018. "The stationing of an Indonesian liaison officer at IFC-IOR (Information Fusion Centre - Indian Ocean Region) will give further impetus to our maritime domain awareness. India will also be earmarking slots for Indonesian cadets and officers at the National Defence Academy and Defence Services Staff College which will enhance defence capacity building," sources said.

On cooperation in critical minerals, officials said Indonesia dominates the sector, commanding roughly 21% of world's nickel reserves and ranking among the top global producers of copper, bauxite and tin. On trade and investments, officials said there are "strong synergies

between developmental visions of Viksit Bharat 2047 and Emas (Golden) Indonesia 2045".

The two sides will also work towards building resilient food security cooperation. Officials said several Indonesian delegations have visited India to learn from social welfare schemes like the PDS, fortified rice scheme and fertiliser subsidy reforms. Indonesia's free nutritious meals initiative is modelled on India's midday meal programme.

According to officials, India is set to commemorate the centenary of Rabindranath Tagore's visit to Indonesia in 2027.

From Indonesia, Modi will travel to Australia. "My visit will strengthen our Comprehensive Strategic Partnership and I shall, in my discussions with PM (Anthony) Albanese, take forward our relations in areas of defence and security, trade and investments, education and mobility, and people-to-people ties," Modi said on X. On his New Zealand tour he said on X, "I shall discuss with PM (Christopher) Luxon how to further enhance economic, trade and commercial engagements. India and New Zealand have committed themselves to strengthening bilateral trade and commercial ties with the signing of the FTA."

Bypolls to 3 RS seats in Bengal on July 24; NDA tally set to rise

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

WITH THE Government apparently considering introduction of a fresh constitutional amendment Bill to advance women's reservation along with the Delimitation Bill and also set the ball rolling for the 'One Nation, One Election' Bills during the Monsoon Session, the Election Commission on Monday announced bypolls to three Rajya Sabha seats from West Bengal which fell vacant after three TMC MPs resigned last month.

With the former CM Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction reeling under rebellion with 60 of her 80 MLAs breaking away, the BJP is likely to win all three seats.

Sukhendru Sekhar Ray, Sushmita Dev and Prakash Chik Baraik, who were all elected to the RS on TMC tickets, resigned from the House and exited the party in June. While Ray and Baraik's terms were until August 8, 2029, Dev's term was to end on April 2, 2030.

BJP currently has 114 MPs in RS, and if the party pulls off wins in all three seats, the tally would climb to 117, consequently taking NDA strength in the 245-member Upper House to 155, just nine short of two-thirds mark of 164, if all members are present and voting — a requirement for passage of a constitutional amendment Bill. The EC said nominations can be filed from Tuesday until July 14, followed by scrutiny of nominations on July 15 and last date of withdrawal of candidature on July 17. Counting will be held on July 24.

JANA SANGH FOUNDER BIRTH ANNIVERSARY



Union Home Minister Amit Shah pays tribute to Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee in Kolkata on Monday. EXPRESS

Modi: Article 370 abrogation fulfilled dream of Syama Prasad Mookerjee

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata July 6

PM NARENDRA Modi on Monday said the abrogation of Article 370 had fulfilled the dream of Bharatiya Jana Sangh founder Syama Prasad Mookerjee, while Union Home Minister Amit Shah, who was in Kolkata to mark the nationalist leader's 125th birth anniversary, laid the foundation stone of a 125-ft statue of Mookerjee.

Addressing a programme via a video message, Modi described Mookerjee as a visionary, patriot and champion of national unity, and drew a direct ideological link between Mookerjee's political struggles and several of BJP's policy decisions, including the revocation of J&K's special status. "By abrogating Article 370, we have fulfilled the dream of Syama Prasad Mookerjee."

"Mookerjee gave the nation the mantra that one country cannot have two Constitutions, two heads and two symbols. This was not merely a slogan; it was a call for equal rights, an equal Constitution and an equal national consciousness. His idea 'Ek Bharat Shrestha Bharat' is now the motto for the country," said Modi.

Highlighting Mookerjee's role during the Partition, Modi said there had been an attempt to include the entire Bengal province into Pakistan.

"Mookerjee stood firm against these conspiracies. He mobilised public opinion, fought political battles and ensured that Bengal remained an integral part of India." "Congress divided the country, and I divided Pakistan," he quoted Mookerjee.

Meanwhile, at an event in Kolkata, Shah noted how he had urged CM Suwendu Adhikari to get Mookerjee's statue erected in his birth place and declare July 6 a public holiday. "I have also asked Adhikari to set up a Syama Prasad Mookerjee research centre near the statue."

Shah also recounted Mookerjee's resignation from independent India's first Cabinet over the Nehru-Liaquat Pact. "He emphasised that the policies of free India should emerge from India's soil and not remain under the shadow of the West."

Shah also praised Adhikari for fulfilling the promises made in BJP's election manifesto. "The Annapurna Yojana and free bus rides for women have been rolled out as well as Ayushman Bharat. Border land for fencing has been handed over to BSF. Maintenance of Public Order (Amendment) Bill, 2026, has been passed to tackle lawlessness. A committee has been constituted to pave the way for the implementation of the UCC in the state. We have started to trace and send back infiltrators too," Shah said.



Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction leaders Kalyan Banerjee, Mahua Moitra and Sagarika Ghose after meeting the EC, Monday. ABHINAV SAHA

AITC organisational committees valid until 2027: Mamata faction to poll panel

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

DAYS AFTER the Ritabrata Banerjee faction met the EC, the Mamata Banerjee-led camp of the TMC on Monday submitted its response to the poll panel, rejecting the rival group's claim over the party and saying that the AITC organisational committees remain valid until 2027 under the party constitution.

Speaking to reporters after submitting the response, TMC LS MP Kalyan Banerjee said the party filed a "very detailed reply" in response to a representation made by rebel group.

Kalyan Banerjee rejected the rebel faction's main contention that the tenure of the AITC committee and National Working Committee expired in 2025, and said the party constitution had been amended over the years to extend the tenure from three years to four years in 2000 and subsequently to five years in 2006, with the changes communicated to the EC.

"The last organisational election was held in 2022. Therefore, automatically, the life of the AITC and National Working Committee remains for a period of five years. It will expire in

2027," Kalyan told reporters outside the EC office in Delhi.

He also said the allegation that the committee's tenure had ended in 2025 was "incorrect and not supported by the constitutional provisions" of the party.

The TMC MP said that the rebel leaders had themselves recognised the authority of the existing party leadership by contesting the 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections on the TMC symbol using candidature papers signed by party chairperson Mamata Banerjee.

"If they are saying the party ceased to exist after 2025, then on what basis did they contest the election? Their own argument would make their election illegal. They should resign immediately," he said.

The TMC leader alleged that the rebel faction's June 22 "special session", in which it claimed to have reconstituted the party organisation, violated the AITC constitution. EC officials said the Ritabrata faction wrote to EC Monday, seeking more time to respond to Mamata faction's earlier letter on working committee. "The EC will assess responses of both sides and then decide whether to lodge a dispute case," an EC source said.

EXPRESS special

Curious case of Goa Congress Party: A 'namesake' Cong did not see coming

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, July 6

IN THE Monty Python classic Life of Brian, hilarity ensues when the eponymous Brian joins the People's Front of Judea and is left puzzled when he finds out that they are resisting both the Romans and the Judean People's Front. The people of Goa may now somewhat identify with Brian's predicament.

Last week, a public notice appeared in a local newspaper announcing that a new outfit called the Goa Congress Party (GCP) had submitted an application to the EC for registration as a political party. Months before Goa polls, the Congress has labelled it an attempt to set up a dummy party to split its votes, an allegation that members of the new outfit deny.

Congress's suspicion also came from the fact that the announcement came amidst internal dissent and resentment following veteran leader Girish Chodankar's recent appointment as its state president. On May 29, Chodankar replaced Amit Patkar, who said earlier he was removed from the party chief's post by the high command without any discussion.

Two members of the party's social media department resigned, while some grassroots workers voiced their discontent, claiming the decision to bring Chodankar back "after defections under his tenure and after the debacle in the 2022 elections" was "surprising". Back then, BJP had emerged as the single-largest party in the polls, winning 20 of the state's 40 seats



Goa Congress chief Girish Chodankar with party's general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal in Panaji last week. GIRISH CHODANKAR/X

while the Congress returned with 11. In a setback for the Congress, eight MLAs defected to BJP on September 14, 2022, bringing its tally down to three.

Since the emergence of its apparent doppelganger, the Goa PCC has been quick to dismiss any speculation of a "split" in Congress and has accused BJP of "sponsoring another political outfit to split the secular vote".

GPCC chief Chodankar alleged BJP had floated a "Rs 100-crore party", labelling it the ruling party's "divide-and-rule strategy" to split votes. "Whenever BJP senses public anger and anti-incumbency, it falls back on the same formula: float or support new parties to divide votes instead of answering for its failures. After years of rising prices, unemployment, law and order concerns, corruption allegations, land controversies and broken promises, the BJP knows it cannot seek votes on governance alone," he said.

"Goans are politically aware and will not fall for another engineered experiment designed

to benefit BJP," Chodankar said. Hitting back at Chodankar, BJP Goa spokesperson Siddhesh Naik said that during his last tenure as the state Congress president, the party weakened and faced defections.

At a press conference on July 4, Congress general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal — who was on a visit to Goa for "organisational purposes" — denied that the GPC would have any effect. "I am told somebody is going to start a new party named 'Goa BJP Party'. Anyone who wants to form a party, let them go ahead. We are not worried about all these things," he said.

The public notice of the Goa Congress Party lists one Francisco Antonio Jacinto Gouveia as its president. Sources said Francisco works as a master mariner in the merchant navy and has not been formally affiliated with any political party. His house in South Goa's Velsao is listed as the party's office.

A senior leader associated with the nascent outfit said the

In UP's 14 general seats, SP plans to field 100 Dalits, tribals

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 6

WITH AN eye on the Dalit vote in Uttar Pradesh for the 2027 elections, the SP is working on a plan to give Scheduled Caste (SC) candidates tickets in 14 general seats, taking the total tally of reserved candidates to at least 100, including 84 seats reserved for SCs and two for ST. The plan has been put in motion to further solidify the party's PDA — pichhda (OBC), Dalit, alpsankhyak (minorities) — plank.

Sources in the SP said the idea behind fielding Dalit candidates in unreserved seats was a step towards reaching out to UP's Dalit community, which will play a decisive role in the elections next year as the traditional party that the community backs, the Mayawati-led



SP chief Akhilesh Yadav in Lucknow on Monday. VISHAL SRIVASTAV

BSP, is slowly fading away from the state's electoral politics.

"We are working on zeroing in on candidates from Dalit communities who can contest on general seats. While our target is to give 100 seats to the

community, it will depend on suitable and strong candidates. The general seats where we are likely to give Dalit candidates tickets are those where SP is not too strong," said an SP insider.

The SP had fielded two Dalit candidates in 2024 LS polls — Meerut and Faizabad (Ayodhya). While Awadhesh Prasad had managed to win the all-important Faizabad seat, Sunita Verma had lost to BJP's Arun Govil in Meerut.

"The idea is to help build a narrative the SP is willing to give SCs a larger share than the reserved seats. We had done this in 2024 poll too, and it had worked," said a senior SP leader. Beyond sending a message to Dalit community, the objective, insiders say, is also to build a larger narrative that the SP is shedding its image of being a

Yadav-Muslim party.

In 2024 LS elections, the party had fielded five Yadav candidates — all from SP's first family led by Akhilesh Yadav — and four Muslim candidates of the total 62 candidates it had fielded. All nine had won, and seven Dalit candidates apart from Verma and Prasad had also made it to the Lok Sabha.

Parties in UP, including the SP and Congress, which are allies, have over the last few years gone all out to reach out to Dalits in an attempt to fill the vacuum left by the BSP.

Dalits, who have in the past been the core base of BSP, make up 21% of UP's population, as per the 2011 Census. But that has been changing. The Mayawati-led party won just one seat in 2022 elections down from 19 in 2017. Even BSP's core base ap-

peared to erode in 2024 LS polls, with the BSP failing to win a single seat and its vote share falling to 9.4% from 19.43% in 2019.

"Akhilesh ji has been telling Yadav and Muslim leaders the party will stick to 2024 formula and not give too many tickets to the communities. Later on, once the government is formed leaders from these communities will be accommodated through the Legislative Council route," said a senior party leader from the Muslim community.

RSMP Ramji Lal Suman, an SP leader from Dalit community, told *The Indian Express*: "We will be getting the anti-BJP vote from the Dalit community. The Dalits have realised that BJP's and RSS's inherent mindset is anti-Dalit, which is reflected in their Manuvadi agenda."

UAPA invoked against Kerala man for offensive post on Pahalgam attack victim

Press Trust of India
Idukki (Kerala), July 6

THE POLICE have invoked the stringent UAPA against a Kerala native, who was arrested on his return from Saudi Arabia over an alleged offensive comment posted under a video featuring the daughter of a victim of the Pahalgam terror attack, officials said on Monday.

The Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) has been invoked against Muhammed Sanoof (26), a native of Aikkarappadi in Malappuram district, who was detained on his arrival at Karpur airport on July 4.

Last year, Muttam police in Idukki district registered a case against Sanoof for allegedly posting an offensive comment under a video featuring the daughter of N Ramachandran, a Kochi native who was killed in the Pahalgam terror attack.

The case was registered on a complaint lodged by a leader of the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM). Police said they had obtained crucial evidence during the preliminary investigation, based on which the decision was taken to invoke the UAPA.

Sanoof has been remanded to judicial custody.

Two injured in separate lion attacks in Gujarat, says forest dept

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, July 6

AT LEAST two incidents of lion attacks on humans were reported from Bhavnagar and Amreli districts since Sunday night — with victims in both the incidents now undergoing treatment for their injuries in hospitals.

In Bhavnagar, a sub-adult lion attacked a man and a video of the incident surfaced on social media. In the video, the lion is seen sitting on top of the injured man and the latter is trying to break free, while villagers raise an alarm nearby.

The incident was reported from Garajiya village of Palitana tehsil in the district, which falls under Palitana Wildlife Range. Forest department officials identified the injured as Kalubhai Parmar, a resident of Garajiya village.

In another incident in Thhavi village of Savarkundla tehsil in Amreli district, a man, Raju Vaghela, was attacked by a lion while he was asleep in his hut on Sunday night. The man suffered serious leg injuries. The area falls under Jesar Wildlife Range.

According to a statement by Jesar Range of the Forest Department, the incident happened around 10:45 pm on Sunday night. The lion suddenly attacked Vaghela, after which local residents raised an alarm and the lion ran towards the jungle area. Vaghela was shifted to Savarkundla Government Hospital for treatment.

NIA names Hafiz Saeed as accused in Pahalgam attack chargesheet

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 6

THE NATIONAL Investigation Agency (NIA) has named Lashkar-e-Taiba founder Hafiz Saeed as an accused in its supplementary chargesheet on the Pahalgam terror attack.

“On Sunday, the chargesheet was filed before the NIA Special Court in Jammu. Hafiz Saeed has been charged in his individual capacity and as the chief of the banned LeT and its proxy, The Resistance Front,” an NIA spokesperson said.

The NIA has charged Saeed under various sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), invoking, among others, sections related to waging war against India and hatching a conspiracy from across the border.

A dossier on Saeed, attached with the chargesheet,

details his involvement in various other terror attacks in India — the Red Fort attack in 2000 in which three persons, including two soldiers, were killed; the attack on a CRPF camp in Ramapur in 2008 in which seven security personnel and one civilian were killed; the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks in 2008 in which 166 people, including foreign nationals, were killed; and the attack on a BSF convoy in Udhampur in 2015 in which two security personnel were killed.

“Hafiz Saeed is accused in various cases registered and being investigated by the NIA, which inter alia include Jammu and Kashmir terror conspiracy and terror funding case and Dukhtaran-e-Millat case, and chargesheet had been filed against him in the 26/11 Mumbai terror attack. A Red Corner Notice was issued against him on August 28, 2009,



Hafiz Saeed is the chief of the banned LeT and its proxy TRF

for his role in the 26/11 Mumbai terror attack case and he was designated as a global terrorist by the United Nations under the United Nations Security Council Resolution, 1267, on December 10, 2008,” says the dossier.

In India, Saeed was designated as terrorist on September 4, 2019. Last week, his son-law, Hafiz Khalid Waleed, was also designated as a terrorist. Waleed, the mastermind behind

the June 2016 Pampore attack in which eight CRPF personnel were killed, was designated as a global terrorist by the US Department of the Treasury in August 2012.

The latest chargesheet, filed in continuation of the original 1,597-page chargesheet on the Pahalgam attack, provides details of Pakistan’s conspiracy, Hafiz Saeed’s role, and supporting evidence collected by NIA in the case through scientific investigation and on-ground examination.

Twenty-six people were killed in the attack in Pahalgam on April 22, 2025.

“Chargesheeting Hafiz Saeed will enhance the capacity of security and law enforcement agencies to initiate coordinated legal, investigative and preventive actions against him at both the national and international levels,” a source said.

In its earlier chargesheet

filed on December 15 last year, the NIA had named Pakistani “handler” Sajid Jatt, three terrorists who were killed by security forces in July 2025 — Faisal Jatt alias Suleman, Habeeb Tahir alias Jibran, and Hamza Afghani — and two arrested accused, Kashmir residents Parvaiz Ahmad and Bashir Ahmad Jothar. It had also named the LeT/TRF as accused.

“NIA continues to probe the case to unravel the complete conspiracy by Pakistan, which has been actively sponsoring terrorism on Indian soil from across the border,” the NIA spokesperson said.

The NIA chargesheet has relied on, among other things, two Android phones found at the site of the encounter in which the three terrorists were killed in July 2025, sources said, adding that the probe agency has confirmed the devices were bought in Pakistan.

ZEE5 removes ‘Satluj’ after govt cites security, IT Rules; SGPC and SAD slam move

OTT content is not regulated by CBFC, but covered under the IT Rules, 2021

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 6

OTT PLATFORM ZEE5 has removed actor-singer Diljit Dosanjh-starrer film ‘Satluj’ after receiving a notice from the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB), citing security issues and obligations under the IT Rules 2021, it is learnt. The film, which was stuck with the Central Board of Film Certification for more than three years, was released uncut on ZEE5 on Friday and removed on Sunday evening.

The development gave way to a furious debate with political parties and the SGPC pushing for the release of the film and the actor-singer saying that he “had a feeling that something like this would happen”.

The film is based on the life of Punjab-based human rights activist Jaswant Singh Khrala, who disappeared in 1995. In 2005, four Punjab Police personnel were convicted for his abduction and murder and sentenced to seven years in prison. Two years later, the Punjab and Haryana High Court enhanced their sentence to life imprisonment.

OTT content is not regulated by the CBFC, but covered under the provisions of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021.

Officials said the makers of ‘Satluj’ had applied for CBFC certification in 2022 under a different title, ‘Punjab 95’. However, the makers did not comply with the 127 cuts and title change as suggested by the CBFC. The makers challenged Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VrB6RGJOKH6Bd0F>



Jaswant Singh Khrala biopic ‘Satluj’, starring Diljit Dosanjh. ZEE5 Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mJmZg1

the CBFC objections in the Bombay High Court, but later the plea was withdrawn.

The original title of the Honey Trehan-directed film was changed for release on ZEE5 without any other modification, an official said. Once the matter came to the government’s notice, it asked ZEE5 to take down the film due to “security” concerns.

Subsequently, on Sunday evening, just two days after its release, ZEE5 informed viewers that the film was no longer available in India.

A code of ethics, part of the IT Rules, requires OTT platforms to avoid publishing content prohibited by law and to undertake age-based classification of content.

The Bombay High Court placed an interim pan-India stay on Rules 9(1) and 9(3) of the IT Rules 2021, which required digital news media and online publishers to adhere to a “code of ethics” and a three-tier grievance redressal mechanism.

The code of ethics also states that when deciding “to feature or transmit or publish or exhibit” any content, a publisher shall exercise due caution and discretion when it affects the sovereignty and integrity of India or threatens, endangers or jeopardises the security of

the state.

It states that caution should also be exercised in case the content is detrimental to India’s friendly relations with foreign countries or is likely to incite violence or disturb the maintenance of public order.

Meanwhile, Kulwant Singh Manan, chief secretary of the SGPC said: “The government should ensure that people see this film. What is wrong if reality is shown and public comes to know of what happened during those days in Punjab.”

SAD president Sukhbir Singh Badal said, “This is not mere censorship; it is an assault on our collective memory, truth, and freedom of expression...”

In an expansive session on Instagram Live from the US where he is on tour, Diljit expressed his anguish. “I had a feeling on Friday that something like this will happen. This was already on my mind. It is not something to be shocked about (the ban) ... But I am satisfied that people have seen the film; it has reached them,” Dosanjh said in Punjabi.

In an Instagram post, ZEE5 said: “We are doing our bit to bring ‘Satluj’ back. Please do yours — don’t support piracy. We remain committed to exploring every possible avenue to bring ‘Satluj’ back to you.”

— WITH PTI

• BRIEFLY



Tibetan spiritual leader the Dalai Lama greets devotees after attending his birthday celebrations in Leh on Monday. PTI

HIMACHAL PRADESH

Tibetan community celebrates Dalai Lama’s 91st birthday with devotion

THE 91ST birthday of the 14th Dalai Lama was celebrated with devotion and enthusiasm across Himachal Pradesh by the Tibetan community on Monday. The Dalai Lama was born on July 6, 1935 in the small village of Taktser, located in Amdo in Tibet. Chief Minister Sukhinder Singh Sukhu also extended birthday greetings to the Dalai Lama and said he is a global symbol of compassion, non-violence, and universal human values. While the principal birthday ceremony was held at the Shewatsel Teaching Ground in Leh, Ladakh, where the Dalai Lama is currently on a visit, celebrations also took place at the Tsuglagkhang Monastery in McLeod Ganj near Dharamshala in Kangra district, the headquarters of the Central Tibetan Administration (CTA). PTI

Girl stabbed at bus stand in Karnataka

A PRE-UNIVERSITY college student was allegedly stabbed by a 28-year-old man on Monday while waiting at a bus stop, police said. The incident occurred at the Montimaru Padpu bus stop in Bantwal taluk of Dakshina Kannada district, they said. The accused has been identified as Mohammad Javvar (28), a resident of Montimaru Padpu, who reportedly runs a grocery shop near the bus stop, police said. The accused who fled from the spot later surrendered to the Buntwal rural police station, they added. Other passengers present at the bus stop raised an alarm, following which Javvar fled the scene. PTI

Man dies after wife injects toilet cleaner into him

A WOMAN in Nizamabad district of Telangana allegedly killed her husband by injecting toilet cleaner through a cannula when he was undergoing medical treatment, police said on Monday. The mother of the deceased complained on July 1 that she came to know about the death of her son Prasanth (35). As per technical evidence and the facts that emerged during police investigation, Sandhya (32) had an illicit affair with one Anil (35). The accused admitted their crime during the investigation. Police arrested and produced the three accused before a court which remanded them to jail. PTI

‘Don’t sensationalise’: SC declines PIL over alleged derogatory remarks

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

THE SUPREME COURT Monday refused to entertain a Public Interest Litigation (PIL) seeking its intervention over the alleged “derogatory” remarks by a BJP leader in Mumbai and asked the petitioner to approach the local authorities instead.

A bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and Sheel Nagu also cautioned the petitioner from sensationalising such matters, saying “others will get ideas”.

“It’s the responsibility of all counsels. In such sensitive matters, you are also a citizen of India first. You should understand the implications. You are a counsel before the law. You know the ramifications. Don’t sensationalise these things unnecessarily, it will have ramifications,” Justice Amanullah, presiding over the bench, said.

“If one person has made a mistake, pin him down with the full force of the law. Absolutely no issues about it. If you don’t, come to us, our doors are open,” Justice Amanullah added.

The counsel appearing for the petitioner said it was against certain alleged “derogatory” remarks by Bharatiya Janata Party minority morcha leader Nazia Elahi Khan. He expressed the concern that it can disturb communal harmony.

Last month, the police in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR) registered two FIR against Khan for allegedly making derogatory remarks about Prophet Muhammad that hurt the sentiments of the Muslim community.

Justice Amanullah then asked him why he had not approached the jurisdictional court and advised him to trust the system. “You file a case. Why have you not filed? I fail to understand. Have faith in the system. We are here as a system. We are only the apex. We are here to monitor. It is also an eye-opener for us whether our lower functionaries are working or not,” the judge said.

Joyride over Patna at Rs 2,100 part of Bihar’s heli-tourism push

Santosh Singh & Yuvraj Singh
Patna, July 6

SEEKING TO improve access to some of Bihar’s key tourist and pilgrimage destinations, the state government will launch helicopter and fixed-wing aircraft services connecting Patna with Rajgir, Kaimur and Valmikinagar from July 15 under a six-month pilot project.

The Bihar Cabinet has approved the Chief Minister Heli-Tourism and Air Tourism Scheme, 2026, under which subsidised air services will be introduced to reduce travel time to major heritage, religious and wildlife destinations. The government will also introduce weekend helicopter joyrides over Patna.

Tourism Secretary Lokesh Kumar Singh said the helicopter service from Patna to Rajgir would be priced at Rs

4,000 per seat.

“We are starting a helicopter service from Patna to Rajgir to connect visitors to the state’s premier Buddhist and heritage destination at Rs 4,000 per seat. We will also provide fast-track access to Bihar’s only tiger reserve at Valmikinagar — the only national park in the state — along the Indo-Nepal border via a government fixed-wing aircraft for Rs 5,000 per seat from the state capital,” he told The Indian Express.

The helicopter service to Maa Mundeshwari Temple in Kaimur will cost Rs 6,000 per seat.

“Besides, a 10-minute helicopter joyride over the capital city will run every weekend, offering four rounds a day for up to five passengers per ride, priced at Rs 2,100 per seat,” Singh said.

The Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation



An aerial view of Patna City. X/@TOURISMBIHARGOV

(BSTDC) will handle bookings, marketing, refunds and tourism packages, while the Directorate of Civil Aviation will oversee flight operations. A state-level committee, headed by the Development Commissioner, will monitor the project, with district administrations

responsible for helipad security and emergency preparedness.

Revenue push

The heli-tourism initiative comes as Bihar seeks to expand tourism as a source of economic activity. The state government has recently announced

a series of measures aimed at strengthening its own revenue base, including the introduction of tolls on state highways.

The Cabinet has also approved the Sindhu Darshan Pilgrimage Financial Assistance Grant Scheme, under which permanent residents of Bihar travelling to Leh-Ladakh to visit the Indus River will be eligible for reimbursement of up to Rs 20,000.

According to the Tourism Department, the scheme will be open to a maximum of 100 beneficiaries every financial year on a first-come, first-served basis. Applicants must be at least 18 years old, be permanent residents of Bihar and can avail of the assistance only once in their lifetime.

Tourism Secretary Singh said the scheme was intended to encourage pilgrims from Bihar to visit the Sindhu River, which the government de-

scribed as having cultural and civilisational significance.

The push comes amid a sharp rise in tourist arrivals in Bihar. According to official data, the state recorded more than 82 million visitors in 2023, including about 5.47 lakh foreign tourists, compared with over 35 million visitors in 2019, before the Covid-19 pandemic.

Government spending on tourism has also increased in recent years, with the Tourism Department citing higher allocations for infrastructure and promotion. According to Reserve Bank of India data, the state government’s developmental revenue expenditure on tourism reached an all-time high of Rs 287.5 crore in 2026, up from Rs 214.9 crore in 2025. This is a major shift from historical spending patterns — between 1991 and 2026, the annual average spending hovered at around Rs 4.5 crore.

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E-Tender is invited for supply and delivery of Primary Current Injection Set along with all associated item as per technical specification. Bid documents can be downloaded from **07.07.2026, 06:00 P.M.** Bid submission closing date (online): **05:00 P.M., 05.08.2026.**

Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details.

The Energy and Resources Institute, New Delhi
Date: Monday, 06.07.2026

Sealed tenders under two Bid System (technical & financial) are invited for following work from all bidders.

NIT No.	Brief Tender Description	Due Date and time of Submission	Date and time of opening of technical bid
TERI/MAT/2026-2027/039	Design, Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Operation and Maintenance of cumulative capacity of 57.5 MW/ 115 MWh Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) at Grid Stations in Delhi under Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding.	Monday, 27 July 2026 at 5:00 PM IST	Tuesday, 28 July 2026 at 11:00 AM IST

For details in respect of Tender terms & conditions, purchase/submission of documents etc. Please visit www.bharat-electronictender.com & www.teriin.org/announcements

Contact person: Mr Dickens Kumar, Sr. Manager - Purchase, TERI, e-mail: dickens.kumar@teri.res.in

Regd. Office: The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI), Darbari Seth Block, Core 6C, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110 003, India, Tel: (+91 11) 2468 2100, 7110 2100

Day not far when BJP will form its govt in J&K: Nabin

Arun Sharma
Jammu, July 6

BJP NATIONAL president Nitin Nabin Monday called upon party workers to continue their struggle, saying the “day is not far when Jammu and Kashmir also will have a BJP government”.

“Lotus is blooming in Jammu and it will soon bloom in Kashmir also,” he said while addressing party workers gathered in large numbers at a banquet hall near Mishriwala during his maiden visit to J&K after assuming charge of the party.

Nabin is on a two-day visit to Jammu at the conclusion of the fortnight-long birth anniversary celebrations of BJP ideologue Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee. Recalling the contributions of Dogra warriors such as General Zorawar Singh and Brigadier Rajinder Singh, he urged the present generation of party workers to strengthen the BJP by reaching out to people and apprising them of the Centre’s policies.

Pointing out that a lot has changed in J&K since Prime Minister Narendra Modi assumed office in 2014, Nabin recalled his visit to Kashmir during the Rashtriya Ekta Yatra in 2011. “I was general secretary of the BJYM then,” he said, adding that he was among a three-member delegation that went to Srinagar to inform the administration of its plan to unfurl the national tricolour at Lal Chowk.



BJP national president Nitin Nabin in Jammu on Monday. PTI

“The administration told us that unfurling tricolour at Lal Chowk will disturb peace and result in law-and-order problem,” he said, adding that it even imposed curfew to stop them from unfurling the tricolour. However, after 2014, the tricolour is unfurling at the same Lal Chowk, Nabin said.

“Today, the youth of Jammu and Kashmir are known as Ranji Trophy champions and not stone pelters,” he said, reiterating that J&K is moving toward “a new era of peace, progress and prosperity”. His remarks set the tone for a politically significant two-day tour blending ideological reaffirmation, organisational review and symbolic outreach. The visit coincided with the concluding ceremony of the fortnight-long Dr Shyama Prasad Mookerjee Pakhwada, observed nationwide from June 23 to July 6.

Mahendragiri, an indigenous stealth frigate, to be commissioned on July 11

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 6

THE INDIAN Navy is set to commission its sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate, Mahendragiri (F38), at Visakhapatnam on July 11. It was designed by the Navy’s Warship Design Bureau and built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, Mumbai.

According to the Navy, it exemplifies India’s growing expertise in indigenous warship design and construction.

The warship incorporates advanced stealth features, enhanced survivability, a reduced radar signature, and a high degree of automation. The frigate is powered by a modern combined diesel or gas propulsion system, enabling high-speed operations with exceptional endurance across the full spectrum of maritime missions.



It is powered by a modern combined diesel or gas propulsion

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
“Capable of undertaking anti-air, anti-surface, and anti-submarine operations, Mahendragiri is equally suited for maritime security, power projection, humanitarian assistance, disaster relief, search and rescue, and sustained presence missions,” the Navy said in a statement.

With over 75 per cent indigenous content, the construction of the frigate has

brought together a vast network of Indian industries, including numerous micro, small, and medium enterprises, generating employment while strengthening the nation’s defence industrial base, the statement added.

“As successive frigates of the class join the fleet, they continue to strengthen the Indian Navy’s combat capability while reinforcing India’s position as a

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E. EXPLAINED

Sixth addition under Project 17A

Stealth frigate is equipped with an advanced suite of indigenous weapons and state-of-the-art weapons and sensors, including surface-to-surface and surface-to-air missile systems, electronic warfare capabilities, comprehensive anti-submarine warfare systems, and an integrated combat management system.

leading indigenous warship-building nation,” the Navy said, adding that Mahendragiri will serve as a formidable force multiplier, safeguarding the nation’s maritime interests and contributing to a secure, stable,

and prosperous Indo-Pacific.

The frigate is named after the Mahendragiri mountain range in the Eastern Ghats, and embodies resilience, strength and unwavering resolve, according to the Navy. The frigate is the first naval warship to bear the name.

Six of the seven Project 17A stealth frigates have been commissioned into the Indian Navy since 2025.

Last month, the fifth Project 17A stealth frigate, INS Dunagiri, was commissioned into the Navy. Earlier this year, in April, the fourth frigate, INS Taragiri, was commissioned. In August last year, the Navy commissioned the second and third Project 17A frigates, INS Udayagiri and INS Himigiri. The lead ship of the class, INS Nilgiri, was commissioned in January 2025. The seventh and final Project 17A frigate is also expected to be commissioned later this year.

Punjab Congress rift deepens as Randhawa & Pargat join Channi camp; Warring asserts party unity intact

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 6

IN A major development in the ongoing factionalism crises of Punjab Congress, several other leaders of the party including Gurdaspur MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa joined hands with former CM Charanjit Singh Channi at a meeting held at Mohali Monday.

What began as a meeting at Channi’s residence in Morinda last Friday has now snowballed into a significant show of strength, with fresh faces from across the state joining the chorus demanding Amrinder Singh Raja Warring’s removal as Punjab Pradesh Congress Committee (PPCC) president.

Randhawa along with the newly appointed working president of Punjab Congress, Sangat Singh Gilzian, Jalandhar MLA Pargat Singh, Kapurthala MLA Rana Gurjeet Singh, Shahkot MLA, Hardev Singh Laddi Sherowalia, Gurdaspur MLA Barindermeet Singh Pahlra, former MLA Razia Sultana and Barnala MLA Kuldeep Singh Dhillon also posted for photographs with Channi and his supporters. In a



Former Punjab Chief Minister Charanjit Singh Channi with Gurdaspur MP Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, newly appointed Punjab Congress working president Sangat Singh Gilzian and others after a meeting in Chandigarh on Monday. ANI

post on his official handle on X, Randhawa posted the photos with the caption ‘unity is strength’.

Channi, too, in a cryptic post on X, wrote, “In continuation of earlier meeting... Unity is Strength.” Congress sources said that it was resolved at the meeting that all official engagements of Warring will be boycotted by the rebel group. Efforts were made to reach out to

Sukhjinder Randhawa, Charanjit Channi, Pargat Singh but they did not take calls.

Also present at the meeting today were former MLA and Channi supporter Bharat Bhushan Ashu, Madan Lal Jalalpur, Kushaldeep Singh ‘Kiki’ Dhillon, newly appointed OBC Cell Chairman, co-chairperson of election management and coordination committee and former Nawanshahar MLA

Angad Saini, former MLAs Gurkirat Singh Kotli, Gurpreet Kangar, sitting MLA Tript Rajinder Singh Bajwa, Inderbir Singh Bolariq, Majitha halka in-charge Bhagwan Singh Sachar and former MLA Devinder Singh Gubaya.

The development comes when AICC General Secretary in-charge of Punjab Congress, Bhupesh Baghel arrived in Chandigarh to resolve the fac-

tionalism in the party post the announcement to retain Amrinder Singh Raja Warring as the state president.

Meanwhile, state Congress chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring dismissed that there was any factionalism in the Punjab Congress.

Asked about Channi having posted that Monday’s meeting was in continuation of the Morinda meeting, Warring said, “You (the media) are talking as if the Morinda meeting was some meeting held in Pakistan, PoK. I have said that Channi is the chairman of our campaign committee and leaders went to meet him.”

He added, “That meeting and even today’s meeting were to strengthen the Congress. In the coming few days, you will see all leaders on one platform.”

He said a section of the media is saying Channi is in Delhi, but he is here, Warring said. Warring asserted that the Congress is united. “Channi, Raja Warring, Rana Gurjit, Par-tap Singh Bajwa, Tript Rajinder Bajwa, Sukhjinder Randhawa, we are all together,” he said.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Enterprise)
CIN: U85110KA1970SGC001919

Tender No. KPCL/2026-27/IND2765 **Date: 06.07.2026**

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Two Cover System) (Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Tenders are invited from reputed companies/persons having adequate knowledge, expertise and funds mobilization capacity for the work of Procurement of 2,00 lakh MT of Domestic Coal from Coal India Ltd.its subsidiaries or from the Private Coal Companies in India and Transportation and Supply of the quantity of coal so procured to Yeramarus Thermal Power Station (YTPS) of Raichur Power Corporation Limited (RPCL) located at Chikkasurgur, Raichur by All Rail Route over a period of Six months with a stipulation that unloading (YTPS) and results are final along with other terms and conditions detailed in the tender document. The last date for receipt of the completed bids is upto **17.00 hrs on 04.08.2026**. The tender document can be downloaded from the website: <https://www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in> Further details can be had from **The Chief Engineer (Mines), KPCL, # 82, Shakti Bhavan, 3rd Floor, Race Course Road, Bengaluru - 560001. E-mail: sefuels@gmail.com / cemineskpcl@karnataka.gov.in** **Telefax:** 080-22203894; **Mobile:** 94495 98901. **Website:** www.kpcl.karnataka.gov.in; **KPP portal helpdesk:** +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777.

नगर निगम अलीगढ़

ई-निविदा सूचना सं० : 1573/नि०न०वि०/ न०नि०अली०/26-27 **दिनांक : 03/07/26**

ई-निविदा सूचना

नगर निगम, अलीगढ़ द्वारा निम्न कार्यो को ई-निविदाई नगर निगम अलीगढ़ में पंजीकृत किसी भी सरकारी/अर्द्ध सरकारी एवं अन्य विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निविदाई आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदाओं से सम्बन्धित जानकारी ई-टेंडर की वेबसाइट www.etender.up.nic.in एवं वेबसाइट www.nnaligarh.in पर उपलब्ध है। निविदा सम्बन्धित कार्यो की सूची नगर निगम कार्यालय के नोटिस बोर्ड पर चर्या की गयी है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी हेतु किसी भी कार्य दिवस में नगर निगम अलीगढ़ कार्यालय में सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है। किसी भी प्रकार के शुद्धि पत्र के सम्बन्ध में ई-टेंडर की वेबसाइट को देखते रहे। निविदाओं हेतु निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय का विवरण निम्नतः है-

ऑनलाइन निविदा

1	निविदा वेबसाइट से डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	दिनांक 06 जुलाई 2026 सांय 05.00 बजे
2	निविदा अपलोड करने की अन्तिम तिथि	दिनांक 15 जुलाई 2026 सांय 05.00 बजे
3	निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक 16 जुलाई 2026 प्रातः 11.00 बजे
4	प्री-बिड मीटिंग तिथि	दिनांक 08 जुलाई 2026 दोपहर 2.00 बजे कमरा न० 205 नगर निगम अलीगढ़।

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	आगमन घनराशि (लाख में)	घरेलू घनराशि (लाख में)	निविदा शुल्क 18 प्रतिशत जी०एम्०टी० सहित (रु० में)	कार्य की अवधि (दिवस में)
1	खैर रोड शेखर मन्दिर से आगे सिटी एट्रेस पर (DFCCIL (Dedicated freight corridor Corporation of india Limited)) के निक्ट सड़क के दोनों ओर सौन्दर्यीकरण का कार्य।	272.35	27.24	33276.00	90

मुख्य अभियन्ता
नगर निगम अलीगढ़।

Ro. No. 6252 **मि०व जनसम्पर्क /NNA/26-27** **दिनांक 06/07/2026**

Govt. of Bihar

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT ENGINEER
BUILDING DIVISION, BIHAR BHAWAN, NEW DELHI
National Competitive Bidding by e-tendering Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
E-tender Notice
CORRIGENDUM

This is to inform to all that in E-tender notice No-01/2026-27 whose PR No. is IPRD_PR_006317/26-27 Published in daily new-paper and issued from this office by letter No. 384 enc, dated 19.06.2026 following modifications are being made.

Name of Work:- Comprehensive Housekeeping, Maintenance and operation Contract (for 5 years) of Bihar Sadan, Dwarka, New Delhi 2026-31

Sl. No	Particulars	Last Modified Date and time	2 nd Modified Date and Time
1	Last date and time of sale (download) of BOQ	from Date 07.07.2026 to 30.07.2026 upto to 15.00 hrs	from Date 22.07.2026 to 17.08.2026 upto to 15.00 hrs
2	Last Date and time of submission (upload) of tender	Date 01.08.2026 upto 15.00 hrs	Date 18.08.2026 upto 15.00 hrs
3	Date and time of opening of tender (Technical Bid)	Date 03.08.2026 upto 15.30 hrs	Date 19.08.2026 upto 15.30 hrs
4	Date and time of opening of tender (Financial Bid)	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee
5	Pre Bid Meeting Date/Time/Place	Date 15.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 20.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.	Date 30.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 06.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.

All other conditions will remain unchanged
Resident Engineer
Building Division
Bihaar Bhawan, New Delhi

This information is available on website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also
PR. No.007073 (BCD) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar Bengaluru-560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383
website : www.kiadb.in

No.IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-20/1982/2026-27 **Date:06.07.2026**

SHORT-TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only)

Item rate Tenders under two cover system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors (Civil) who have got adequate financial resources & sufficient past experience for the following work as per the schedule given below:

Name of the work: **Providing and laying of Domestic Sewer Network at Devanahalli General Industrial Area, Phase-2, Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.
Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders: **23.07.2026 up to 4:00 pm**
Sd/- Engineer-In-Chief, K.I.A.D.B

Urban Development and Housing Department
Office Of Municipal Executive Officer Nagar Panchayat Andar (District- Siwan)
LOCAL / NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
STANDARD BIDDING DOCUMENT PROCUREMENT
(CIVIL WORKS)
TENDER NOTIFICATION (e-tender) – 01/2026-27

Tenders are invited through Electronic Tendering System only for the works detailed below:

BID NO	NAME OF WORK	ESTIMATED COST	AMOUNT OF EARNST MONEY (RS IN LAKH) ONLINE OR OFFLINE MODE	COST OF BOQ IN RS (NONREFUNDA BLE) TO BE PAID ONLINE.	BID PROCESSING FEE IN RS (NONREFUNDABLE PAYMENT ONLY THROUGH ONLINE MODE)	TIME OF COMPLETION (IN MONTHS)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Construction work of Administrative Building for Nagar Panchayat Andar District-Siwan	2,70,40,100/-	5,41,000/-	10,000.00	AS PER E-PROC2	18 MONTHS (INCLUDING NON-WORKING PERIOD) FOR CONSTRUCTION WORK

2. OFFICER INVITING BIDS

: Municipal Executive Officer, Nagar Panchayat Andar

3. DATE OF ISSUE OF NOTICE INVITING BID

: 03-07-2026

4. BID SUBMISSION START DATE

: FROM 23-07-2026 (11.00 AM) Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only

5. TIME, DATE AND PLACE OF PRE-BID MEETING

: DATE 24-07-2026 11:00 AM to 11:45 PM) Nagar Panchayat Andar Office, Siwan

6. LAST DATE AND TIME FOR UPLOAD OF BIDS

: DATE 30-07-2026 TIME (3.00 PM)

7. PHYSICAL DOCUMENT SUBMISSION END DATE AS ALLOWED IN THE TENDER DOCUMENT

: DATE 30-07-2026 TIME TILL (04.00 PM)

8. TIME AND DATE OF OPENING TECHNICAL BIDS

: DATE 31-07-2026 TIME (11.00 AM)

9. TIME AND DATE OF OPENING FINANCIAL BIDS

: TO BE ANNOUNCE LATER

10. PLACE OF OPENING OF BIDS

: Through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only

11. BID VALIDITY PERIOD

: 120 Days

(Shweta Kuamri)

Municipal Executive Officer
Nagar Panchayat Andar (Siwan)

PR. No. 007100 (B&C) 2026-27

This information is available on website www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच करायो।

Yogi govt approves renaming of Jalalabad town as Parashurampuri

Express News Service
Lucknow, July 6

THE BJP government in Uttar Pradesh on Monday gave its nod to change the name of Jalalabad town in Shahjahanpur district to Parashurampuri, after Hindu warrior-sage Lord Parshuram.

The decision was taken at a Cabinet meeting, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. Speaking to mediapersons

after the Cabinet meeting, state Finance Minister Suresh Kumar Khanna said there was a long-pending demand from the residents of Jalalabad to rename the town, citing its historical and religious significance.

Jalalabad, named after Jalal-ud-din Muhammad Akbar or Akbar during the Mughal period, is considered the birthplace of Lord Parashuram — associated with the Brahmin community – and finds promi-

nent mention in Hindu mythological accounts and scriptures.

“After the Centre conveyed to us that it has no objection to the proposal, the state government approved the proposal to rename Jalalabad as Parashurampuri,” said Khanna, who hails from Shahjahanpur district and is an MLA from there.

“The department concerned will complete the necessary administrative and legal formalities,” the minister said.

UP cops detain wrong man over ‘name mix up’, kin allege assault

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 6

SHARING A first name with a wanted suspect turned into a nightmare for a 29-year-old man in Uttar Pradesh’s Hamirpur, who was mistakenly picked up by police on a non-bailable warrant and allegedly assaulted inside the station on Saturday.

Shivraj Singh’s family, in videos online, alleged he was brutally assaulted by police after being wrongfully detained and suffered serious injuries before officers discovered he was not the suspect named in the warrant.

Denying the accusation, Hamirpur Police said an inquiry has been ordered into the assault allegations. They claimed the “mix-up” occurred because he lived in the same area as another man named Shivraj, who was actually wanted in the case. Police also claimed Shivraj’s injuries were self-inflicted from hitting his hand against a window and banging his head against a wall in anger after discovering the mix up. Additional SP Arvind

Kumar Verma said an inquiry had been ordered and that police would review CCTV footage at the police station. Action against officers responsible would be taken based on inquiry’s findings, he said, adding that Shivraj’s condition was stable.

Shivraj is a resident of the Merapur locality, which falls under the jurisdiction of the Sadar Kotwali police station in Hamirpur.

The incident sparked anger among local residents, who staged a protest demanding action against the police personnel behind the alleged assault.

The protest ended after senior officers assured the demonstrators the allegations would be thoroughly investigated and strict action would follow.

According to Circle Officer, Hamirpur, Yashpal Singh, two men named Shivraj lived in the area. But the copy of the court warrant did not include the wanted man’s father’s name, he said, leading officers to the home of the wrong Shivraj. The confusion was compounded by the fact the man they detained had previously faced five criminal cases, he said.

Singh said officers checked the man’s identity after arriving at the station and discovered he was not the person named in the warrant. Police claimed Shivraj became agitated over being wrongly detained and smashed a glass pane, injuring his hand. Police also claimed he banged his head. Officers said they rushed him to hospital for treatment.

In a purported video circulating online, Shivraj, lying on a hospital bed, alleged that police took him from his home on the basis of a warrant that was not issued against him and assaulted him.

His medical report is still awaited. His family could not be reached for comment.

In another video circulating on social media, Shivraj’s mother alleged that three policemen came to their home and forcibly took her son away, claiming a court had issued a warrant against him.

She further alleged he was beaten inside the police station. “Now they are saying the warrant relates to a 2018 case and that a senior police officer had ordered them to bring him in,” she claimed.

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

NINE WEEKS AFTER GRAND OPENING

Landslide damages key Pune-Mumbai e-way stretch ‘Missing Link’; official says ‘act of God’

Sabah Virani, Sushant Kulkarni, Ajay Jadhav, Dipanita Nath & Zeeshan Shaikh
Mumbai, Pune, July 6

BARELY NINE weeks after it was inaugurated as Maharashtra's answer to the Mumbai-Pune Expressway's most notorious traffic bottleneck, the Rs 6,695-crore Missing Link suffered its first major monsoon disruption on Monday, with a landslide damaging a retaining structure near one of its tunnels and forcing the closure of the Pune-to-Mumbai carriageway, as Maharashtra received record rainfall with 670 mm of rain battering Lonavala in over 24 hours.

Mumbai surpassed its average rainfall quota for July in six days even as Pune recorded 108 mm of rain in 24 hours until 8.30 am on Monday, the fourth-highest reading for the month since records started being maintained in 1896.

The landslide that took place around 3.30 am brought down boulders and debris from the hillside, even as heavy rain and water flow across multiple stretches of the expressway paralysed the vital corridor between the two metros for several hours. Traffic on the Old Mumbai-Pune Highway (NH-48) was also disrupted due to rain-related incidents.

Pune-bound traffic resumed later in the morning, but the Mumbai-bound carriageway remained shut till late evening despite debris clearance by 5.30 pm, with traffic diverted via the old highway and Ghat section as MSRDC conducted safety inspections and repairs.

The Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC), however, defended the ambitious engineering project, attributing the incident to exceptionally heavy



A waterlogged road in Mumbai's Virar West after heavy rain inundated the area. AKASH PATIL

rainfall and describing it as “nature at play” rather than a construction failure and saying heavy rainfall was akin to “act of God”. Officials maintained that the tunnel itself remained structurally sound and that the damage was confined to the retaining structure and the tunnel's external false frame.

“As a precautionary measure, a detailed inspection of the slope above the tunnel is underway to assess the presence of any loose material. Owing to persistent heavy rainfall and strong winds, the inspection is taking longer than anticipated,” said an official. While not giving a tentative time when the Mumbai-bound roads would reopen, officials said only two of the three tunnel lanes would be reopened, leaving one lane blocked. After

the rain stopped, officials were considering measures to divert the rainwater and repair the false frame at the mouth of the tunnel.

Monday's disruption also carried an element of irony. The road conceived to free motorists from monsoon disruptions on the old ghat section ended up diverting vehicles back onto that very route during its first rainy season. Adding to the chaos, parts of the old Mumbai-Pune Highway were also affected after a tree fell on power lines and heavy rain caused waterlogging at multiple locations.

Officials said the landslide damaged a retaining wall, blocked the approach to the second tunnel and rendered the stretch unsafe for vehicular traffic.

CM: Heavy rain till tomorrow; Nashik braces for downpour

Express News Service
Mumbai, July 6

MAHARASHTRA CHIEF Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Monday said the state is likely to continue witnessing intense rainfall till July 8, describing the ongoing weather situation as “unprecedented” even as authorities race to restore normalcy in rain-hit districts.

Speaking after a review meeting at the State Emergency Operations Centre in Mantralaya, Fadnavis acknowledged that the heavy rains had resulted in casualties, though he did not provide figures.

“This is high-intensity rainfall, nearly three times the aver-

age. The administration is fully geared up and working round the clock to restore normalcy,” he said.

Earlier on Monday morning, the legislative assembly and council were adjourned for a day amid predictions of intense rainfall and prevailing water logging situation in different parts of the state which brought the traffic to standstill.

At the press conference, the Chief Minister said Nashik district is likely to witness an extremely intense spell of rain on Tuesday, with forecasts indicating precipitation of nearly 300 mm, prompting authorities to place the district on high alert.

Manipur: Two Assam Rifles soldiers killed in ambush

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 6

TWO ASSAM Rifles personnel were killed in an ambush by suspected militants in Manipur's Ukhrul — the fourth fatal ambush so far this year in the conflict-hit state.

The personnel were part of a convoy of the 40 Assam Rifles that came under attack on National Highway-202 near Nounshong Kong village in Ukhrul district by suspected militants, police said. The two deceased personnel have been identified by the Assam Rifles as Warrant Officer Balwant Singh and Havildar Chandra Mohan Singh.

According to police sources, the incident took place at around 1.30 pm near Nounshong Kong, about 16 km east of Ukhrul Police Station. They also said the assailants first used explosives, followed by heavy firing. “Security forces rushed to the site of the attack and there was an exchange of fire. Further operations are underway to neutralize the militants,” the Manipur Police said in a statement.

Condemning the incident, Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh said: “My deepest condolences to the bereaved families. Their supreme sacrifice will never be forgotten. Such acts of terror will not be tolerated. The Government of Manipur is committed to bringing the perpetrators to justice and remains steadfast in upholding peace, security, and the rule of law.”

The Tangkhul Naga-majority district of Ukhrul has seen tensions since February this year, when tensions between local Kuki and Tangkhul communities began simmering in

8-yr-old girl, man injured in firing by armed groups in Kangpokpi

Imphal: Two persons, including an eight-year-old girl, were injured in a firing by armed groups in Manipur's Kangpokpi district, police said on Monday.

The incident took place in Thingkhongjang village on Sunday evening, and the injured, Nengneichong Kipgen (56) and Lamneingah Kipgen (8), were brought to Imphal for treatment late in the night, they said.

The injured were initially provided first aid at an Assam Rifles camp and later brought to the Regional Institute of Medical Sciences in Imphal for further treatment. Security has been tightened around the RIMS campus. PTI

the Litan area. However, Monday's incident took place in an area closer to the district headquarters. As of the time of filing this report, no group had claimed responsibility for the attack.

This is the fourth fatal ambush in Manipur this year, with the death toll from such ambushes now reaching eight. In April this year, two Tangkhul civilians were killed in an ambush in Ukhrul district. Three Kuki-Zo church leaders were killed in an ambush in Kangpokpi district in May, and later that month, a truck driver from West Bengal was killed in an ambush on a security-escorted convoy of trucks in Ukhrul district.

Nashik TCS conversion and harassment cases: Nida Khan gets bail, no relief to Danish Shaikh

Express News Service
Mumbai, July 6

TWO MONTHS after her arrest, a sessions court on Monday granted bail to Nida Khan, an accused in one of the TCS religious conversion and sexual harassment cases at the company's Nashik unit. A similar relief was, however, rejected to Danish Shaikh, another accused in the case. The court also granted bail to Tausif Akhtar. While Akhtar faced allegations of sexual misconduct, Danish was booked for sexual assault on the pretext of marriage.

A Special Investigation Team (SIT) of the Nashik Police is probing a total of nine cases — one filed in Deolali Camp police station and eight in Mumbai Naka — registered in connection with the alleged exploitation, attempt of forceful conversion, hurting religious sentiments, molestation and mental harassment of female employees at Nashik TCS unit.

Nida Khan was named in the Deolali Camp case, facing allegations of hurting religious sentiments and “influencing” one of the TCS employees to practice Islamic traditions. She was arrested in May 2026 when she was three months pregnant.

During the bail hearing, Nida Khan's lawyer, Rahul Kasliwal and Baba Sayyad, argued that her continued custody was unnecessary as a chargesheet had already been filed, also requesting bail on medical grounds.

A Special Investigation Team of Nashik Police is probing a total of nine cases

The court rejected Danish Shaikh's plea, saying he faced grave allegations in the TCS case. The court said, “Accused Danish gained the victim's trust by lying to her and promising marriage, subsequently engaging in sexual relations with her, despite he is already married and thereby deceived her.”

It also added that the prosecution had expressed apprehension over possible influence on material witnesses if the applicant is released on bail at this stage of investigation.

“Considering the overall circumstances, and the trauma on the victim and the nature of the alleged crime, he does not deserve to be enlarged on bail until evidence of material witnesses, is recorded, in the trial,” special judge K G Joshi said.

Nida Khan was alleged to have aided the religious conversion of a victim by giving her a burqa, religious books and installing religious apps on her phone. A sessions court had rejected her anticipatory bail plea and she was eventually arrested on May 7 from a house in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, making her the last of the eight accused to be taken into custody.

‘Don’t call me... police are beating me up’: Kin recalls last call from Sanoj Kumar

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, July 6

ON AUGUST 13, Sanoj Kumar's family answered a call from him. They were stunned to learn from him that he had been detained during an excise raid near Bihya in Bhojpur.

A few minutes later, when the family was trying to gather more details and frantically calling him, Sanoj called back. “Please don't call me... the [excise] police are beating me up,” Sanoj had said. It was his last call. It's been more than 10 months since.

The 31-year-old Dalit man, a mason in Bihar's Bhojpur, has been missing, the family says. Investigators said he was one of the three detained during an excise raid near an illegal watering hole.

Earlier this week, five officials and two of their van drivers were arrested over the disappearance — a development that came after sustained monitoring by the Patna High Court.

The arrested are Excise Assistant Sub-Inspectors Dheeraj Kumar and Raj Kumar, Home Guards Dharmendra Paswan, Umesh Kumar Yadav and Raju Kumar Singh, and two drivers, Surendra Kumar Singh and Vikash Kumar. They have been remanded in judicial custody,

Bhojpur SP Raj told *The Indian Express*. Sanoj has not been traced yet, he said. All the five officials have also been suspended pending inquiry, officials said.

The family claims that Sanoj has been killed in custody. “For days, whenever we heard that an unidentified body had been found, we rushed there immediately, no matter the time. We went everywhere — from police stations to the State Human Rights Commission and the National Human Rights Commission, from Ara to Chapra, Patna, Buxar and Aurangabad — hoping to find him,” his youngest brother, Rakesh Kumar, said.

After Sanoj's disappearance, his wife suffered a miscarriage, the family said. She was expecting their second child. “She was devastated and stopped eating,” Sanoj's mother, Kalawati Devi, said.

Sanoj had also borrowed Rs 50,000 just to build a house. “Installments still have to be paid. The lenders won't understand our helplessness. We have no choice but to return to work. Life doesn't stop,” Rakesh said.

What happened that day

The second of the four children, Sanoj was a construc-



Sanoj Kumar was a construction worker in Dubai but returned in 2024 to be with his family

tion worker in Dubai until late 2024, when he decided to take up work locally to stay home with his wife and three-year-old son.

That day, Sanoj called the family around 6 pm to say he would be home soon. “He said ‘don't buy babu (Sanoj's son) anything, I'll get something,’” Sanoj's father, Gauri Shankar Ram, told *The Indian Express*. “I told him to come home soon.”

Sometime later, Sanoj called the family to say he had been detained. “While I was still asking for more details, the call was disconnected,” Rakesh said. Sanoj's elder brother, Manoj Kumar, allegedly called him. “This time he answered crying and asked me to stop calling,” he said. “The next time I called, his phone was switched off.”

At 12 that night, after searching for him for hours, the family members first ap-

Four dead, one missing in Pune as 48 hrs of rain wreaks havoc, causes landslides

Soham Shah
Pune, July 6

AT LEAST 22 landslides occurred in Pune district due to excessive rainfall over the past 48 hours, District Collector Jitendra Dudi said on Sunday evening.

Four people have died, one person was washed away, and over 20 have been injured in rain-related incidents across the district. Nine roads in rural parts of the district have also been closed due to the landslides and are expected to remain shut on July 7 as well, Dudi said.

Three people were killed after a landslide struck a house in Patan village, Mulshi. Construction worker Sunil Baltha died in Pimpri Chinchwad after a retaining wall collapsed at a construction site, injuring another worker.

In Khed taluka, a bike rider was reportedly washed away by flowing water. The bike has been found, but the rider's body is yet to be recovered, according to Khed Police Inspector Shubhash Chavan.

Rainfall exceeding 65 mm was recorded in 27 revenue circles across the district, with Maval taluka recording the highest rainfall at 237.3 mm. Thirty people were rescued, and over 270 citizens were relocated to safer locations through rescue and relief operations carried out in coordination with the Revenue Department, Police, Fire Brigade, NDRF, SDRF and local self-government bodies.

EXPRESS special

After 10 months, missing Bihar Dalit man's family sees hope: Five arrests after HC rap

proached the Jagdishpur Excise police station, but were dismissed that day. “On the second day, they said nobody had been detained,” brother Nirranjan said. “When we went the third time, we were told three persons had been detained, but one escaped.”

The family alleges they found Sanoj's motorcycle near the site of the alleged raid. On August 14, Gauri Shankar Ram lodged a missing person's report at Bihya police station.

With the investigation crawling, the family moved the Patna High Court on April 17.

What the HC said

During its hearings on a habeas corpus plea filed by Gauri Shankar Ram, a Division Bench of Justices Rajeev Ranjan Prasad and Kumar Manish pulled up the police over the pace of the probe. The HC said it gave an impression that investigators were “only helping the accused persons”.

On June 30, the HC said: “We place on record our displeasure on the manner in which the first IO and then the SHO of the Jagdishpur Police Station have conducted the investigation. They are moving slowly... giving an impression to this court they are only helping the accused persons... even when they have found suspects, the investigating agency is not able to find out the truth from them,” the court said.

The court's observations came after the investigators



Mohammed Shahid Faisal

Engineering graduate who fled Bengaluru in 2013 figures on MHA terrorists list

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 6

THE NAME of a tech-savvy engineering graduate from Bengaluru who had fled the country in the wake of a 2012 terrorism conspiracy case has figured on the MHA's new list of 23 “designated” terrorists, released on July 4.

Mohammed Shahid Faisal, alias Zakir Ustaid, now 42, went missing as a 28-year-old, following the unearthing of an alleged LeT-linked terror plot. Faisal, whose parents had settled in Bengaluru after moving from Kerala, has been identified in recent years as the online handler for terror incidents in south India since 2020, including the Mangaluru auto blast in November 2023 and Bengaluru Rameshwaram Cafe blast in March 2024.

In the MHA list, Faisal has been described as being of “Pakistani nationality (originally Indian, currently active in Rawalpindi) and is affiliated with LeT, Al-Qaeda, and ISIS”.

“He is the key mastermind and handler behind the 2012 Bengaluru LeT conspiracy case and the 2013 Nanded LeT case, which involved plots for the targeted killings of right-wing politicians and journalists. He fled to Pakistan in 2013 with the assistance of terrorist Farhatullah Ghorri,” says the MHA list's description of Faisal.

A computer science engineering graduate from a prominent private engineering college in north Bengaluru, Faisal earned a reputation as a hacker and computer expert in his college days before being drawn to radical Islam by local and online preachers.

Amid rising accidents, Goa may stop issuing new licences for rental Thars

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, July 6

CITING CONCERNS over the rising number of accidents in Goa, Goa Transport Minister Mauvin Godinho Monday said the government is considering restricting issuance of new licences to rental Thar vehicles in the coastal state.

After a meeting with the officials Monday, Godinho told the media: “As far as the transport sector is concerned, several is-

ssues were discussed. We are concerned about the rising number of accidents and a discussion was held on the reasons and how to curb them. As far as Thar vehicles are concerned, we are going to restrict issuing [new] licences to [operators of rental] Thar vehicles...and it is going to come up in the next STA [State Transport Authority] meeting and they will decide what action has to be taken”.

“We are going to recommend to the STA to take action on this

and further permissions for Thar [rental vehicles], perhaps, will not be given. It has got too much speed and no control...in the vehicle. So, they [people] just go and bang [vehicles] somewhere,” Godinho said.

The minister said an audit will be done to assess how many ‘rent-a-car’ vehicles and operators are operating in the state and whether they have proper parking facilities, as mandated by norms and licencing rules. “Strict enforcement is going

to be done as far as monitoring is concerned...whether they have got Vehicle Location Tracking Device installed, whether speed governors are installed and in cases of drunken driving...the drive will continue to ensure fewer accidents,” he said.

This comes in the aftermath of a spate of road accidents, involving Thar vehicles, particularly the ones rented by tourists in the state. In May, a 32-year-old man was killed and a minor was critically injured after a rented

Thar vehicle driven by a tourist allegedly rammed into their scooter in North Goa. Subsequent probe found the accused Thar driver was inebriated. In another incident in February, a 65-year-old tourist from Madhya Pradesh was killed after a rented Thar, with a group of young tourists, allegedly rammed into his car in North Goa.

Godinho said the State Transport Authority has decided to take stricter action against cases of drunk driving

and that drivers, who are caught driving under the influence of alcohol and involved in fatal road accidents, will now be booked and face arrest immediately.

Earlier in 2024, the Goa Police had mandated that tourists intending to rent vehicles in Goa would have to sign an undertaking, pledging adherence to road safety and traffic norms. The government had also mandated the installation of speed governors — devices that keep speeds under a set limit — for all

rental vehicles. The undertaking, by those who want to rent vehicles in Goa, had 10 road safety laws and the corresponding legal penalties for violations. It included pledges such as “I will not drive the car under the influence of alcohol” and “I will not use the mobile phone while driving the car...” The document also included the name and personal details of the person renting the vehicle, including their driving licence and Aadhaar number.



The Indian EXPRESS

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RAMNATH GOENKA

BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

How to absorb rain: What cities must learn

FOR MUMBAIKARS, there’s a grim familiarity to the crisis unfolding in the city that has taken at least seven lives in the past five days. Relentless rain has submerged roads, inundated homes in low-lying neighbourhoods, delayed commuters, and forced educational institutes to suspend classes and examinations. The India Meteorological Department has warned of more rain over the next three days, raising fears of further flooding in the country’s financial capital.

Built on what were once seven islands, much of Mumbai is land reclaimed from the sea. Large parts of the metropolis lie only a few metres above sea level. Urban expansion has disrupted the city’s intricate hydrological network — creeks, salt pans and wetlands that used to absorb the rain before gradually releasing it into the sea. During every spell of intense rainfall, water tries to flow along the erstwhile water channels — that explains the regular inundation of areas like Hindmata, Kurla, Sion and parts of the western suburbs. After the devastating floods of 2005, the city’s administrators did initiate meaningful changes — pumping stations were installed, and forecasting systems strengthened. However, despite being revamped on large stretches, Mumbai’s drainage network is ill-equipped to deal with short but intense bursts of rainfall. The storm-water system relies on gravity to empty water into the sea. This mechanism comes apart when heavy downpour coincides with high tide, like in the past few days — the seawater rises above the drainage outfall and pushes it back.

The predicaments of Mumbai’s administrators are similar to those of their counterparts in several parts of the world — it’s increasingly becoming apparent that improving drainage systems alone does not offer security against climate vagaries. China’s Sponge City policy, adopted after the Beijing floods of 2012, tries to address this challenge by enhancing the water retention capacity of the country’s urban centres — replacing concrete pavements with permeable ones, restoring urban wetlands and creating artificial lakes to store rainwater. Planners in the Netherlands’ low-lying cities have also been innovative. Instead of only strengthening traditional flood defences, they have created everyday amenities like water squares — these collect water during episodes of extreme rain, while doubling as recreation centres during the dry season — and incentivised the construction of green roofs. Mumbai’s municipal agency, too, has lake restoration projects on its agenda. However, “blue-green infrastructure” remains largely a niche concept in most parts of India, including in its financial capital. The country’s urban centres need housing, transport, commercial districts and modern infrastructure. The task for planners and administrators is to design them in a manner that does not render cities defenceless against extreme weather.

FIFA lets Donald Trump, the bully, win

TNSPORT — as in so much else — America does its own thing. Major League Baseball has a “World Series” every year in which most of the world does not participate. So, too, with what Americans call football. “Soccer”, though, is a truly global sport, in which the US is far from ruling the roost. It is full of upsets and heartbreaks, and part of the joy of the Beautiful Game lies in its sorrows — a shot that goes off the pole, a spectacular save during a penalty shootout, the offside that robs the elation of what looked like a goal. The greatest of these, though, may be crying foul at a foul against your country’s star player. Everywhere, fans know that sinking feeling after a Red Card and complain against the referee, knowing that it is futile and they must live with the decision. Everywhere, that is, except in Donald Trump’s America.

Until last week, Trump’s imprimatur did not dominate the FIFA World Cup, which the US is co-hosting: While the actions of his administration, including the ordeal faced by Iran’s national team and the refusal to grant Somali referee Omar Artan a visa, made headlines, Trump himself did not attend a single game and has hardly mentioned the tournament on his prolific social media posts. Then, on Wednesday, the US’s star striker Folarin Balogun was given a Red Card in the game against Bosnia and Herzegovina, which carried a one-match ban. Trump reportedly made multiple phone calls to FIFA, which announced that it had suspended the ban under Article 27 of its disciplinary code.

“The thing about football,” Terry Pratchett wrote, “is that it’s never just about football”. The Balogun episode is a reminder of that axiom. Even before the tournament began, Article 27 was used by FIFA to suspend a ban that allowed Cristiano Ronaldo to play in the first two matches. After all, no Ronaldo would have meant a lot less money and fewer eyeballs. And FIFA President Gianni Infantino awarded Trump a “peace prize” — made up all but on the spot — in December last year. The logic of his actions is familiar to anyone who has played gully cricket: It’s best not to upset the rich guy who owns the bat. Turns out, even on the biggest sporting stage, the backyard bully rules the roost.

Teejan Bai claimed her right to sing

ONE WILL probably remember the remarkable talent of Chhattisgarhi folk musician Teejan Bai, who died in Raipur on Sunday at 69, as an innate gift. But what was often admired as genius was her extraordinary resolve.

In Ganiyari village, where singing on any public platform was forbidden for women, people didn’t want their daughters to become like Teejan, the 10-year-old, who under the pretext of collecting cow dung for the hearth would escape to the ponds, fields and naalas to belt out the verses of Pandavani — an oral storytelling tradition from Chhattisgarh, where a lone performer combines music and narration to bring a story from the Mahabharata to life. The sun would go down and Teejan would return home, only to be shunned by family and community because she dared to sing a form that was a preserve of men.

Married at 12, she would run away from her husband’s home at 13 to live alone in a neighbouring village to become Teejan Bai, the first woman to perform Pandavani professionally from the Pardhi community. For decades, one saw Teejan become the Pandavas, Kauravas, Krishna, Bhishma and Karna, shifting effortlessly between characters, conjuring kingdoms and battlefields, with just her voice and an ektara. In the 1970s, Urdu playwright Habib Tanvir, struck by her talent, brought her into Naya Theatre, introducing her to a national audience. She later appeared in Shyam Benegal’s *Bharat Ek Khoj* and received the Padma Vibhushan and the Sangeet Natak Akademi award. But perhaps her greatest achievement lay in winning the hardest battle to begin with: Claiming her right to sing.

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi is travelling to Jakarta, Auckland and Melbourne, undertaking a sequence of visits that may define New Delhi’s approach to the Indo-Pacific in the coming decades. A bold and audacious redrawing of the map of this vast maritime region is underway. This effort will seek to recover autonomy for the powers that reside here, and it will recentre the region’s story on good growth and inclusive development, away from the whims of extractive super-power contestation. India envisions a new geometry of collaboration, one not dependent on axioms outlined in Washington or Beijing, but drawn up by those who live here and thus have the most to gain or lose.

The first stop, and the lynchpin of any plan for the Indo-Pacific, is Indonesia. The world’s third-most populous nation is the archetypal Indo-Pacific power. Indeed, it is the nation the term might almost have been coined to describe. The archipelago sits astride every crucial trade route between the two oceans, has abundant natural resources and, like India, is a civilisational state that has long been committed to a “free and active” foreign policy that secures its autonomy.

It is the relationship between India and Indonesia that will set the course for the broader maritime region. And what is often overlooked is that this partnership has already grown manifold. Objectively, Jakarta

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VaN2VRb6RGJOKH6oB0f>

is one of New Delhi’s most important partners. If you look at goods alone, trade between the two nations, at just under \$30 billion a year, is significant. It has overtaken trade between India and the United Kingdom, and runs neck and neck with Indo-German trade. Goods trade will only grow, stimulated by the upgradation of India’s free trade agreement with the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), and so will services, under-represented and under-reported at present. With a focus on marine logistics, technology and financial services, and new supply chains, this partnership will form the foundation for a free and open trading architecture in the region.

And it will be necessary, as well, for Prime Minister Modi and President Prabowo Subianto to move the relationship forward if the Indo-Pacific is to create a genuinely indigenous and independent security framework. These two maritime powers are the only ones with the scale, capacity and presence required to manage the region’s most vital chokepoints. Together they are the only powers positioned to become net security providers of this ocean, not by invitation from Washington or deference to Beijing, but because the sea lanes are theirs to protect in the first place.

Australia, meanwhile, is India’s breakout partner. A new economic partnership, Australia-India Econ-



SAMIR SARAN

It will be necessary, as well, for Prime Minister Modi and President Prabowo Subianto to move the relationship forward if the Indo-Pacific is to create a genuinely indigenous and independent security framework

NATO’s challenge: Spending on collective defence



AJAI SHUKLA

WITH EASTERN Europe and West Asia in prolonged turmoil, leaders of NATO’s 32 member countries are gathered in Turkey for the Ankara Summit. The cornerstone of the world’s most powerful alliance, enshrined in Article 5 of the North Atlantic Treaty, stipulates that an armed attack against one or more of its members will be considered an attack against all. But now, alongside the military threat from its principal adversary, Russia, NATO faces demands for more equitable burden-sharing from its principal financial contributor, the US.

Last fortnight, NATO outlined the broad themes expected to dominate discussions during the Ankara Summit. The first is a topic that has been contentious ever since NATO’s beginnings: Spending levels on defence by the alliance’s European members.

At last year’s summit in The Hague, the European members committed to investing 5 per cent of GDP in defence. This covers two categories. Each member must spend at least 3.5 per cent of GDP on core defence equipment and to meet NATO capability targets. In addition, NATO countries must spend 1.5 per cent of GDP on defence- and security-related investments, such as protection of critical infrastructure, defence networks, and strengthening the defence industrial base.

The focus of the summit will be on delivering on the 5 per cent pledge with the US piling pressure on the European allies to step up. Washington is altering its contribution to NATO, pressing Europe to grow high-end capabilities such as logistics, command and control, aerial refuelling, missile defence, and special operations forces.

NATO watchers expect three themes to dominate the summit. The first will be a continued focus on “alliance adaptation”, as NATO seeks to transform from a force optimised for crisis management to one focussed on collective defence against peer competitors. The second will be “capability delivery”, with NATO identifying its security requirements and actually fielding those capabilities at the speed demanded by today’s security environment. The third will be “technology and industrial resilience”.

The rocky path to NATO’s current 5 per cent commitment dates back to its founding in 1949. For its first 40 years, NATO formed the first line of western European defence against the threat of invasion by the

Soviet-led Warsaw Pact. During the 1950s, NATO’s European allies willingly spent an average of 4.8 per cent of their GDP on defence. Alongside this, the US heavily subsidised NATO, picking up 60-76 per cent of the tab for Europe’s defence.

With the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991, NATO countries sharply pared defence spending to fund public infrastructure and social programmes. In 2006, at the Riga Summit, NATO’s defence ministers issued a guideline advising member countries to spend at least 2 per cent of their GDP on defence. But, with the Soviet threat having receded, the non-binding Riga commitment was largely ignored.

Russia’s annexation of Ukraine’s Crimean peninsula in 2014 was the wake-up call that goaded NATO into reversing a quarter century of spending cuts. At the 2014 Wales Summit, the allies signed the Defence Investment Pledge, committing themselves to a spending target of 2 per cent of GDP by 2024.

Even so, it took a full-scale Russian invasion of Ukraine in 2022 to push NATO countries into adopting the new target of 5 per cent of GDP by 2035. Galvanised by the Russian threat, 2023 saw an unprecedented 11 per cent increase in NATO’s real defence spending. In 2024, the European allies spent a combined total of \$380 billion. In 2025, collective defence spending rose by another \$90 billion. Some NATO allies are on track to reach the 5 per cent target in 2026, far ahead of schedule.

European security experts say the success of the Ankara Summit will rest not just on pushing NATO allies into spending more, but on directing spending into the right capabilities. NATO increasingly believes that Ukraine, which has demonstrated astounding capabilities in battlefield adaptation and innovation, provides the right blueprint for a more effective way to operate in a war fuelled by AI. Kyiv has demonstrated how to sense the domain, adapt cheap commercial tools, and iterate fast.

Ultimately, military advantage will be generated less by platforms and weapons and more by the ability to innovate, to produce, to sustain and to adapt faster than the adversary. Developing an agile defence industry will be the centrepiece of the Ankara Summit, with the entire day of July 7 being an industry forum.

The writer is a retired Army officer and journalist

omic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA), was negotiated in 2022, signalling New Delhi’s new vision for trade. But it also built trust, a far scarcer commodity. That trust can serve to underpin the next stage of this relationship. That would require deeper integration: Our financial services, nuclear energy and resource processing industries must be integrated. These are areas where we both have great abilities, and our search is for autonomy, scale, and new technology. The strategic objective, once the habit of cooperation settles, must be defence co-production, where both could serve as trusted enablers of broader regional and global security.

New Zealand is a crucial key to the puzzle and not only because of its own strengths. The innovation island hosts advanced manufacturing capabilities, space and deep technology enterprises and agri-processing innovation, making it a vital component of India’s innovation sectors, food-security imperative and farm-income strategy. With the fourth largest exclusive economic zone (EEZ), the blue economy in its entirety is a natural domain of partnership with Aotearoa.

Alongside Canberra, Wellington will provide another crucial bridge to the Five Eyes security-intelligence ecosystem. This adds further resilience to a still new relationship.

Finally, together, India and the Australian and New Zealand Army Corps (ANZAC) can become the delivery mechanism for development across the South Pacific and neighbouring parts of ASEAN. They will provide the financing, digital and physical infrastructure, and human capital the region badly needs, as well as a credible alternative to exploitative or unreliable partners. India is, after all, the largest theatre for discovering development solutions for the planet; once that innovative energy is paired with the capital and standing in the Pacific of the ANZAC nations, it offers a development pathway that does not force smaller nations to be burdened with perverse debt or lease a naval base to supposed benefactors.

Modi’s new arc of trust will hold the Indo-Pacific together in these disruptive times. With India at its centre, draw the arc east from India through Indonesia, Australia and New Zealand. Then draw it west through the United Arab Emirates and the Gulf and down the eastern seaboard of Africa.

This is the real story of the upcoming tour: The geographical centre of the Indo-Pacific resetting and redrawing an emerging order so that those who share this oceanic domain write the rules instead of just inheriting them.

The writer is president, Observer Research Foundation

Don’t scrap WhatsApp username, address the harms



SRINATH SRIDHARAN



ANAND VENKATANARAYAN

THE GOVERNMENT of India’s reported decision to seek an explanation from Meta over WhatsApp’s proposed username feature is about far more than a messaging application. Should governments regulate digital technologies by focussing on the harms they create, or by scrutinising individual product features before they reach citizens? True, India is witnessing an unprecedented rise in cyber fraud, identity theft and so-called digital arrest scams. Yet good intentions do not automatically translate into good regulation. Every regulatory intervention must ultimately be judged by a simple question: Does it solve the problem it seeks to address?

Governments should regulate digital harms, not individual software features whose risks can already be addressed through existing law and better product safeguards. Regulating software architecture risks converting governments into arbiters of product design, an approach that no serious digital economy can sustain. A WhatsApp username replaces the visible mobile number during user interactions. Every account remains linked to an underlying number obtained through verification. Platforms retain account identifiers and records. What does change is something equally important to citizens. Millions of Indians routinely disclose their personal numbers to strangers because digital communication leaves them with no alternative. Ironically, the proposed feature advances another public policy objective that India itself has increasingly embraced over the past decade: Better protection of personal information.

If official concerns remain, regulators can require platforms to adopt privacy-preserving defaults. Users could receive messages from username-based accounts only after explicit consent, much as spam filters transformed email without questioning the legitimacy of email itself. Email has arguably become one of the world’s most important pieces of digital public infrastructure. Every email address is, in essence, a username. Had governments attempted to regulate email by questioning username-based identities themselves, one of the internet’s foundational technologies might never have evolved into the trusted communication infrastructure upon which governments, businesses and citizen now depend every day. The possibility of impersonation is therefore neither new nor unique to WhatsApp. Fraudsters already impersonate public officials over telephone calls, banks through SMS messages, government agencies through counterfeit websites, businesses through spoofed email addresses and public figures across social media platforms.

A proportionate response would focus on platform responsibility rather than platform architecture. Platforms can disable unsolicited messages from unknown username-only accounts by default, provide enhanced verification for public institutions and prominent individuals, and, among other measures, deploy AI to detect deceptive usernames. India requires a more technologically informed philosophy of digital policymaking. Digital sovereignty is a legitimate national objective. It is too important to become an omnibus justification for scrutinising every technological evolution. If India wishes to lead the AI century rather than merely participate in it, its regulatory institutions must display the confidence to regulate principles over products, harms over hypotheticals, and outcomes over architecture.

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
Sridharan is a corporate advisor and author of Family and Dhanda, and Venkatanarayanan is a digital policy researcher

A WhatsApp username simply replaces the visible mobile number during user interactions. Every account remains linked to an underlying number obtained through subscriber verification

40 YEARS AGO

July 7, 1986



Jaggiwan Ram dead

BABU JAGJIVAN Ram, one of the front-ranking leaders of the freedom struggle and president of the Congress (J), died in New Delhi at Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital. He was 78. The President, Zail Singh, and the Prime Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, will attend his funeral, which will take place in his native village, Chandwa in Bihar. The government declared three-day state mourning as a mark of respect to the departed leader. Flags will fly at half mast. All offices of the central government in Bihar will remain closed. The former deputy prime minister, who was taken seriously ill about two weeks ago, went into a deep coma and died. He had been admitted on May 8.

Political rift in Mizoram

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN Mizo National Front chief Laldenga and Chief Minister Lal Thanhawla surfaced with the latter expressing his reluctance to join the interim government, which is to assume office on August 12, as deputy chief minister. The Chief Minister, who resented some of the utterances Laldenga had made soon after his arrival, said he would like to opt out of the new government and work for streamlining the Congress (I) in preparation for the elections due within six months.

Bid to destabilise: Barnala

THE PUNJAB Chief Minister, Surjit Singh

Barnala, said the main objective of the dissidents’ convention at Anandpur Sahib was to build up “forces of terrorism and secessionism to provide political cover to the heinous designs of foreign powers to destabilise and disintegrate the country”. “The dissidents organised a public meeting and not a delegate session,” Barnala, who is also the president of the ruling Akali Dal, told a news conference.

Marcos loyalists’ proclamation

TROOPS AND marines loyal to the ousted Philippine president, Ferdinand Marcos, took over Manila’s main hotel and proclaimed a new government to replace that of Corazon Aquino.



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Some democratic lessons from Global South that our Opposition needs



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

WHY BOTHER with elections? Why not just boycott this increasingly unfair race? This question is being whispered around. It is time we asked this normally, without any tinge of taboo. It is also time we answered it calmly, without a rush of moral outrage. An open public debate may bring us to this conclusion: Election boycott is a good question, but a bad answer. As of now.

The debate should begin with “*Why Bother with Elections?*” — a question raised in the eponymously titled and defining book on the rationale of democratic elections by Adam Przeworski, a leading democratic theorist of our times. In his characteristic clinical way, Przeworski admits competitive elections may not offer the virtues we habitually associate with democracy — good governance, fair representation or social harmony. Yet elections are worth the bother as they enable deeply divided societies to live together without civil war. Those in power agree to risk losing office, and losers accept defeat because elections allow a peaceful transfer of power, or at least keep this possibility open. This is what the historic election of 1977 enabled in India, despite the preceding authoritarian interlude of the Emergency.

This happens only when electoral verdicts remain uncertain. When there is a realistic risk of the rulers losing an election that they are desperate to win. When electoral integrity does not fall below a red line. As it has in India today.

There is no objective way of measuring “electoral integrity”. But an influential 2014 paper by Pippa Norris, Richard W Frank and Ferran Martínez i Coma offers a helpful list of 11 dimensions in the entire election cycle relevant to assessing electoral integrity in any given country. Indian elections were always on the borderline in one dimension —

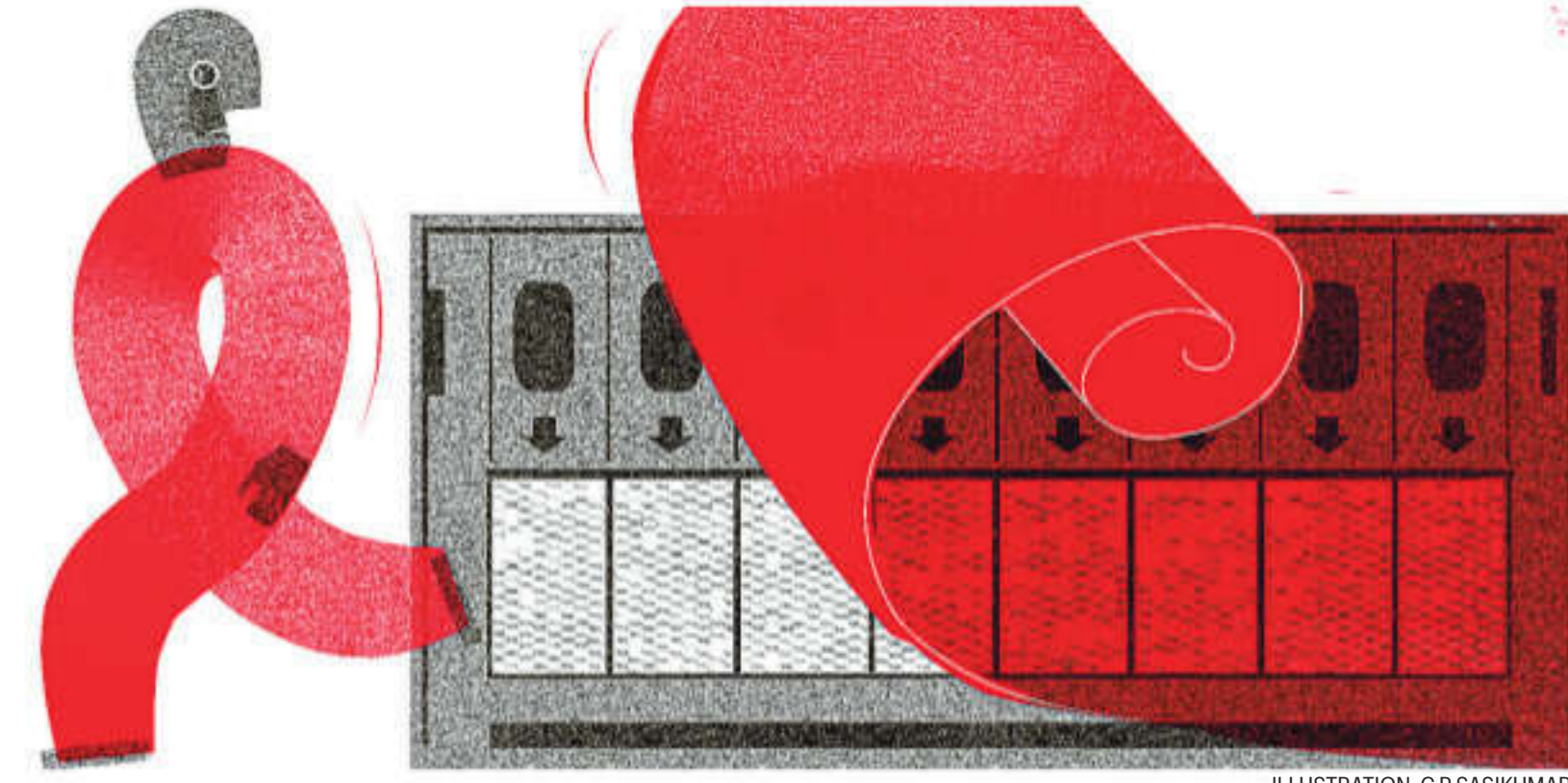


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

campaign finance. Since 2014, our elections have gradually slipped below the threshold of acceptability in three more dimensions: Neutral electoral authorities, transparent procedures and fair access to campaign media. The latest assault of SIR and delimitation, along with the breaking of opposition parties now, crosses three more red lines: Universal voter registration, unrestricted party and candidate registration and fair boundaries of constituencies. Now we are left with the formality of a fair election: Fair electoral laws, standard voting and counting process and binding declarations of results. After the recent allegations of voter suppression in Rampur, Uttar Pradesh (2022) and Kundarki in the same state (2024), and the controversial counting in Rajarhat New Town, West Bengal (2026), this bare minimum, too, is under a cloud.

In sum, Indian elections, once the country's pride and neighbours' envy, may have slipped below the minimum acceptable threshold of electoral integrity. Not to put too fine a point on it, if the ruling party thinks it can and must win an election, it shall do so. That is why the opposition leaders face an existential question: Must they participate in a fixed match? No matter what your answers, it is a real dilemma. It is a good question.

Yet, a complete withdrawal, a full-scale election boycott, is not a

good answer for the Indian Opposition today. Here are three reasons to reject any such proposal at the present stage.

The first is an ethical argument. No, it's not a naive democratic argument about participating in any and every election, even if it is rigged. The argument is about communicative ethics. A commitment to democracy imposes a requirement to communicate with the people. If the Opposition believes that the elections are being rigged, it must convince the people about it. Congress's “vote *chori*” campaign has indeed had more impact on the public mood than is often admitted. Yet it would be premature to conclude that ordinary voters, even if we exclude those who are closed-minded supporters of the BJP, subscribe to this reading. Given the state of mass media, most of them are not quite aware of the extent of electoral irregularities. This may be frustrating, but a democratic ethic requires building public opinion to a point where the public demands it before contemplating such a step.

The second argument is strategic. Even when elections are unfair, it often makes more sense to participate than to opt out. On the one hand, global evidence shows that unless an election boycott brings down the turnout figures dramatically, it is an ineffective strategy against authoritarian rulers. Worse, it allows the rulers to claim that the

The relevant criterion to think about the boycott is not the extent of unfairness but the availability of spaces to expose this unfairness



**R S SHARMA
AND SWETHA RAVI KUMAR**

WHEN PRIME Minister Narendra Modi chaired a meeting of the Economic Advisory Council a few weeks ago, the discussion ranged across fiscal management, ease of doing business, and the reforms required to keep investments flowing. One structural theme connects all of these: Energy.

Energy is more than one sector among many; it is the input cost of the entire economy. Industry is the single largest consumer of electricity. Yet it pays among the highest power tariffs in Asia. For many millions, energy also remains a matter of basic access.

The power sector's transformation in the last decade has been far-reaching. India operates one of the world's largest synchronous grids at a single national frequency. We have moved from chronic shortages to broad supply adequacy. NASA's imagery of artificial light at night has shown India's remarkable progress in making energy accessible to all in the last decade. We are also among the largest producers of renewable energy. We reached 50 per cent of installed capacity from non-fossil sources in 2025 and are now working towards 500 GW of non-fossil power by 2030.

Over the past decade, India has closed longstanding gaps in physical infrastructure, lowering the transaction costs of economic activity. The next substantial gains lie

India Energy Stack could power next-gen enterprise

in digitalising how these systems operate.

The task now is to ensure that the data these systems generate can move securely across institutional boundaries, so this investment delivers its full value. This shift, from building physical assets to drawing value from them through digitalisation, reflects a broader pattern in India's development. Having built cross-sectoral digital public infrastructure in Aadhaar and UPI, India is now developing domain-specific platforms in health, agriculture, logistics, and recently, energy. These share a common design. Aadhaar, UPI, and other digital public infrastructure did not replace existing institutions; each set common standards and provided a framework for securely exchanging information. This facilitated a competitive private ecosystem to flourish, advancing financial inclusion at scale and giving rise to one of the world's largest fintech ecosystems. The public sector provides the rails; providers build on them.

The India Energy Stack (IES), an initiative of the Ministry of Power, applies this approach to the power sector for the first time anywhere. IES is a shared set of specifications that enables every power-sector system to exchange data securely and verifiably, without custom integrations, so that the infrastructure already built can deliver its full

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value to citizens, utilities, and the economy. The design suits India's federal structure: Electricity is a concurrent subject, and distribution is run by utilities owned or overseen by states. A shared, standardised way such as IES enables national coordination at scale. This can further leverage AI to forecast demand, balance a renewable-heavy grid, coordinate millions of distributed resources, and price power dynamically, helping India both power the AI economy and run a cleaner, cheaper energy system.

Electricity is only part of the picture. The wider task is integration across the energy system, spanning more than a dozen ministries, several electricity regulators, and a range of fuels. The 2006 Integrated Energy Policy made the case for whole-system planning; the digital tools to act on it now exist. As institutional capacity for integrated energy planning is addressed, IES can provide a coordinating mechanism that brings these agencies onto shared intelligence.

Structural reforms in energy strengthen external resilience, lower costs across the economy, prepare the sector for AI, mobilise investment, and provide firm foundations for the next generation of Indian enterprise.

Sharma is chair, India Energy Stack, an initiative of the Ministry of Power. Kumar is head of programme, India Energy Stack and executive director, FSR Global

Cool rooms and other solutions to Europe's heatwave

projections over many days in recent weeks resulted in the Orange Code plan.

Instead of resorting to the large-scale use of air conditioners in individual homes, which will only increase heat in public spaces by belching hot air into them, most cities are advocating strategies that will help limit climate change. In Paris, a unique district cooling system pumps cold water from the River Seine through 120 kilometres of underground pipes to cool major public spaces, hospitals, and museums.

Many cities are opening up “cool rooms”, which are temporarily repurposed, climate-controlled spaces in community centres, libraries, museums, town halls, and sports centres, where the most vulnerable citizens can freely seek comfort. In cities like Berlin, local authorities op-

erate an interactive map that directs residents to cooler places in the city, including shaded parks, drinking fountains, and misting points. In the Netherlands, which has a rich tradition of swimming, such “cool maps” direct citizens to safe swimming locations where a dip will cool them down.

Many cities are advocating behavioural change, such as adapting their daily timetables to adjust to these tropical condi-

In Paris, a unique district cooling system pumps cold water from the River Seine through 120 kilometres of underground pipes to cool major public spaces, hospitals, and museums

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 tions. Schools start earlier than normal and operate for shorter hours, avoiding peak heat periods. In Germany, some sections of the autobahn have had speed limits imposed to prevent asphalt from buckling under extreme heat.

In the long term, expanding the green canopy in cities by planting more trees, creating more water bodies, and reducing concrete and asphalt surfaces in public spaces in favour of water-permeable surfaces can lower ambient temperatures. Barcelona mitigates the urban heat island effect by erecting shading sails and seasonal pergolas in areas where planting trees is not feasible.

Reducing the use of private cars in cities and reducing the area covered by concrete and asphalt, while using these spaces for landscaping, can also help. In the Nether-

lands, many cities have restricted access to electric vehicles only (not only cars but also trucks). Cooling in buildings is achieved by passive means such as shading, cross-ventilation, and green roofs and walls. Regulatory measures set legally binding carbon-emissions targets for new buildings, thereby reducing future urban heat.

It is encouraging to see that most cities in Europe have not opted for the large-scale use of air-conditioning since this will only exacerbate the situation. Most cities are taking both short- and long-term measures so that they provide comfort to citizens while reinforcing efforts to mitigate climate change.

The writer is an urban designer, city planner and architect, and co-founder of the knowledge platform MyLiveableCity

Delhi at the Khamenei funeral: Why optics matters



NAJEEB JUNG

AYATOLLAH SYED Ali Hosseini Khamenei was laid to rest in Tehran on Friday. As Iran's Supreme Leader, Khamenei occupied a position of immense political and spiritual authority across the Shia world. India's decision to be represented at his funeral by a relatively junior delegation has therefore generated a debate extending well beyond protocol: Has India, almost imperceptibly, moved away from the strategic autonomy that once made its diplomacy distinctive?

The relationship between India and Persia is civilisational before it is strategic. Yet Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Tel Aviv immediately before hostilities between Israel and Iran inevitably shaped regional perceptions. The timing suggested to many that India was identifying itself more closely with one side of a deeply polarised regional conflict, that India had moved away from non-alignment and towards the United States and Israel. India's abstentions on several United Nations resolutions calling for an end to the violence further reinforced the impression.

Admittedly, none of this diminishes the importance of India's growing partnership with Israel and the United States. Israel has become one of India's most valuable defence partners. The United States is India's leading strategic partner, balancing China's growing influence in Asia. But recent trade disputes with Washington and uncertainty surrounding visas for highly skilled Indian professionals became reminders that even the closest strategic partners ultimately pursue their own national interests. The larger question is whether India retains sufficient diplomatic space to pursue its own interests whenever they diverge from those of its most powerful partners.

Iran, meanwhile, remains indispensable to India's long-term strategic interests. Chabahar Port provides India's most practical route to Afghanistan and Central Asia, bypassing Pakistan. Iran's location along the Strait of Hormuz makes it central to energy security, maritime connectivity and India's Eurasian ambitions.

Despite severe economic distress, political instability and security challenges at home, Islamabad has succeeded in re-es-

tablishing itself as a relevant interlocutor across West Asia. Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's attendance at Ayatollah Khamenei's funeral reaffirmed Pakistan's longstanding ability to engage simultaneously with Iran, Saudi Arabia, the Gulf monarchies, China and, where necessary, the United States. Whether these initiatives ultimately yield tangible strategic gains remains uncertain, but Pakistan has succeeded in creating the impression that it is once again an active player rather than merely a recipient of regional developments.

India's material advantages over Pakistan remain overwhelming. Yet diplomacy is equally about political presence, symbolic gestures, sustained engagement and the confidence to keep channels open with every side. In that respect, Pakistan appears to have recognised an opportunity India did not fully seize.

Jawaharlal Nehru called India's approach non-alignment. Indira Gandhi practised strategic independence during the Cold War. Atal Bihari Vajpayee deepened ties with Washington and Tel Aviv while preserving productive engagement with Tehran and the Arab world. Their politics differed, but each sought to maximise India's freedom of judgement.

Today's preferred expression is “multi-alignment”. Properly understood, it should represent the evolution — not the abandonment — of strategic autonomy. It succeeds only when every major power, friend and rival alike, believes that India possesses both the confidence and the capacity to disagree whenever its national interest so demands.

India today is among the world's fastest-growing economies, an emerging technological power and a respected voice of the Global South. These provide New Delhi with an opportunity few nations possess: To maintain close partnerships with Washington, Tel Aviv, Riyadh and Abu Dhabi while simultaneously preserving deep and meaningful engagement with Tehran.

For over seven decades, India's greatest diplomatic asset has been the belief that its foreign policy would be guided neither by ideology nor by external pressure, but by an independent assessment of its own national interest. In an increasingly fragmented world, that reputation may prove more valuable than any alliance. The real lesson of Khamenei's funeral is not that India should choose between Washington and Tehran. It is that a country aspiring to be a leading global power must never allow others to believe that its choices have already been made.

The writer is chairman, Advanced Study Institute of Asia, former Lt Governor, Delhi, and former vice chancellor, Jamia Millia Islamia



SHYAM KHANDEKAR

THIS YEAR, European cities have seen searing temperatures for extended spells like never before, reaching the high 30s and low 40s Celsius. Attributed to climate change, these hot spells are likely to become more frequent and intense in the coming years. Increasing urban heat affects not only citizens' health but also the economy.

Recognising that these conditions are the result of climate change, rather than merely erratic occurrences, must be followed by long-term policies to address them. While Paris has Plan Canicule, London has created its own Heat Action Plan 2026. In the Netherlands, sustained heat

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Inflation and scarcity

WITH THE impact of the impending El Niño staring the nation in the face, and the West Asia crisis showing no sign of abating, the prospects for agricultural production look bleak (‘El Niño, Iran sharpen food prices challenge’, *IE*, July 6). The government must pull up its socks and formulate a sound strategy to tackle the twin challenges of rising inflation and food scarcity. It is time to ensure the payment of a minimum support price for crops such as pulses, oilseeds, cotton and other less water-intensive crops, over and above open market prices. .

Ravi Mathur, Noida

Bengaluru horror

CALLING THESE cases horrific would be an understatement (‘Bengaluru creche ordeal points to a crisis of care’, *IE*, July 6). Many women leave the corporate workforce after becoming mothers, and incidents like this will only force more of them to quit their jobs so they can take care of their children. This incident is also likely to erode parents' trust in childcare centres. Livestreaming may sound like a feasible option, but it has its own disadvantages, as it may heighten parents' anxiety. Recorded CCTV footage is a better alternative. Background checks of staff, regular inspections, and training employees with the help of child psychologists are the need of the hour for these childcare centres.

Bal Govind, Noida

CJP's momentum

THE BEGINNING of the Cockroach Janta Party has been impressive, drawing huge attention. Its trajectory, however, will depend on a number of factors (‘Cockroaches and a reckoning with unkept promises’, *IE*, July 6). The party needs to evolve into a political outfit with a clear ideology if it wants to sustain this momentum. It should seek representation from the ward level to the Assembly level.

Amitabh Nigam, Ahmedabad

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• SPORT

US striker's match ban reversed: What FIFA rules say

Abhinav Chakraborty
New Delhi, July 6

WHEN THE US striker Polarin Balogun received a straight red card and a one-game ban for fouling Bosnia and Herzegovina's Tarik Muharemovic last week in the Round of 32 knockout game of the ongoing FIFA World Cup, popular reaction suggested that the dismissal was rather harsh. The US managed to win 2-0.

Controversy, however, erupted after FIFA, the world's top footballing body, reversed the red card decision ahead of the crucial Round of 16 game between the US and Belgium late Monday — seemingly at the behest of US President Donald Trump. The Belgian football federation said Monday it would challenge FIFA's decision. UEFA, European football's governing body, said the decision had "crossed a red line".

FIFA's rationale

In reversing Balogun's red card decision, FIFA's Independent Disciplinary Committee cited Article 27 of the FIFA disciplinary code, which states that the judicial committee is authorised to suspend the implementation of a disciplinary measure or sanction (such as a match ban), whereupon the measure itself remains in force but does not have to be served immediately unless the suspension is revoked later.

• RED CARD

- Three things happen when a player gets a red card.
- They have to walk off the field right then and their team cannot replace them. The player is also barred from playing the next match.
- A team can have up to four players sent off in a match.

such a measure cannot be suspended if the offence is related to match fixing.

Rules on disciplinary action

Law 12 of the International Football Association Board's Laws of the Game 2026-27 governs rules pertaining to "Fouls and Misconduct". The laws empower the referee to broadly take four kinds of disciplinary action against offences committed by either players (including substitutes) or team officials: warning, caution, yellow card, and red card. This extends "from entering the field of play for the pre-match inspection until leaving the field of play after the match ends (including penalties)".

For minor offences, referees tend to first communicate a warning or caution to the players or officials concerned; should they repeat such offences, the referee can issue a yellow card — also called a "booking". While a player can continue on the pitch after being booked once, a second yellow card in the same match — which equals one red card — means they would have to leave the field.

A red card communicates graver offences such as dangerous challenges, abusive behaviour towards match officials, denying an open goalscoring opportunity by fouling one's opponent, or handling the ball. As in Balogun's case, the video assistant referee (VAR) can step in to flag missed red card offences; for this tournament, VAR can even overturn a second yellow, if necessary.

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• LAW

Media's 'public function': Impact of Delhi HC verdict on press freedom, privacy

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, July 6

FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS guaranteed by the Indian Constitution have traditionally been viewed as a shield for citizens against the State.

However, a judgment by the Delhi High Court this month extended their "horizontal application", ruling that private media houses perform a "public function" and can be taken to a High Court for violating an individual's right to privacy.

A two-judge bench upheld a single-judge's order directing TV Today Network to pay Rs5 lakh in compensation for broadcasting details that could identify a minor, who was a victim of sexual assault.

The judgment, authored by Justice C Hari Shankar on behalf of himself and Justice O P Shukla, has implications for press freedom, privacy, and avenues through which citizens can sue the media.

• AUTOMOBILES

Ethanol blending in fuel: Why road ahead is bumpy



ANIL SASI

MARUTI SUZUKI'S advertising catchlines of the early 2000s, "kitna deti hai" and "petrol khatam hi nahin hunda", were instant hits, distilling the Indian motorist's fascination with fuel efficiency. Decades earlier, Hero Honda had struck a similar chord with its "fill it, shut it, forget it" campaign, highlighting the efficiency of its four-stroke engines. It also buttressed the notion that thrift at the pump was the ultimate measure of automotive value.

That sentiment has proved resilient even as India's car market has upshifted to premium offerings. The calculus of mileage and the promise of frugality endure in a nation where mobility is expanding, but growth in disposable incomes remain patchy.

Ahead of schedule

That is where the government's new ethanol blending programme is running into opposition. Last year, India fully transitioned to 20% ethanol blending in petrol — five years ahead of the original target of 2030. E20 fuel — 80% petrol and 20% ethanol — is now the standard petrol variant available nationwide.

So, essentially, within three years, the average ethanol blending level in petrol doubled from the earlier 10% to 20% (this was originally slated to happen over eight years). For older vehicles and those certified for E10 petrol — 90 parts petrol and 10 parts ethanol — this transition came about rather quickly, without sufficient warnings of the consumer-end pitfalls. The experience left motorists, especially those owning older cars and two-wheelers, feeling somewhat short-changed.

Now, there are three problems with using a higher ethanol blend in petrol for engines not designed for these blends:

First, there is a substantial drop in fuel economy depending on when the car was manufactured.

Second, E20 fuel in internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles, especially older ones, can damage parts, owing to factors like corrosion, given ethanol's hygroscopic nature (hygroscopy refers to the property of a substance to attract and hold water molecules from the surrounding environment, either through absorption or adsorption).

Third, vehicle owners in India cur-

• URBAN GOVERNANCE

Behind tree-fall deaths in Mumbai, strong winds, concretisation

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, July 6

IN LESS than a week, three people, including an 11-year-old boy, have been killed and several others injured by falling trees in Mumbai. Between July 1 and July 5, Mumbai reported 559 tree-fall incidents, including 203 cases in the last 24 hours alone.

While tree collapses are a recurring feature of the monsoon, this year's surge is unusual, raising concerns over public safety. According to the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's (BMC) data, 687 tree fall incidents were reported in 2023, 653 in 2024 and 855 in 2025. This year's figure is already above 500.

The spike has also put the spotlight on the BMC's ambitious Rs 17,000-crore road concreting project. Two of the three fatal tree-collapse incidents occurred along roads that had recently been concretised.

Mumbai and its trees

According to the BMC's 2011 tree census, Mumbai had nearly 29.75 lakh trees. The number today is likely to be lower, as

the city's green cover is lost to infrastructure projects.

Besides parks and open spaces, a large number of trees line Mumbai's roads. Most are indigenous species such as neem, peepal, banyan and gulmohar. Many of these mature trees grow over 20 metres tall and have expansive canopies that provide much-needed shade and ecological benefits.

These roadside trees are planted in square-shaped soil pits, commonly known as tree basins. However, experts have long criticised the maintenance of these basins, pointing out that many have gradually been encroached upon by cement and concrete during road widening, road concretisation, utility trenching, fibre-optic cable laying and stormwater drain projects.

Tree roots require loose, aerated soil to anchor themselves firmly. When concrete is laid around the base of a tree, it restricts root growth and damages the root zone.

Over time, the roots lose their ability to spread, absorb water and oxygen, and anchor securely. As the foundation weakens, trees become increasingly vulnerable to uprooting during heavy rainfall

Rules flouted

- In 2019, the Centre directed urban local bodies to maintain an unconcretised 6-metre by 6-metre area around trees in public spaces to facilitate water percolation and root development.
- BMC officials said norms are regularly flouted in Mumbai, and concrete is often laid right up to the tree trunk.



A student died and five others were injured after a tree fell on a bus. AMIT CHAKRAVARTY

or strong winds.

The high-wind factor

On Sunday, when Mumbai recorded 203 tree-fall incidents in a single day, wind speeds reached 75-79 kmph, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Mature trees are extremely heavy, with their large canopies acting like sails during high winds. When their root systems have already been weakened by soil saturation

that there are no conclusive studies into the long-term impact blended fuel can have on non-compliant vehicles, but flagged that it could definitely have an impact on the engine's life, its various rubber parts, valves, and piston heads, among others.

It is the E25 transition that has hassled automakers at the moment, since this will require additional engineering and validation work around engine calibration, fuel-system durability, corrosion resistance, and material compatibility.

Consumer bears the brunt

This is just months after the government wrapped up the E20 transition. In all probability, the cost of vehicles will go up too, and the consumer will have to bear it. Not to mention the lower mileage, which a lot of customers are testifying to after the E10 to E20 shift.

According to sources in the government, the move towards blends higher than E20 is "not being pushed through in a hurry and there will be enough time given for vehicles and oil companies to gear up for this transition".

Why is the government pushing for blends beyond E20? The main reason is to lower India's dependence on fuel imports and aid domestic ethanol production.

There's a political angle too: the agricultural lobby, especially from Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, is pushing hard for ethanol blends to be hiked since farmers, such as those growing sugarcane, are sitting on significant overcapacity. For the oil marketing companies such as Indian Oil and Bharat Petroleum too, there are challenges, but as they are mostly state-owned, they are unlikely to protest.

Now for adapting the existing set of vehicles to E25, car makers said they would have to run fresh tests to see what impact the higher ethanol blend will have on vehicles on the road. For new vehicles, the manufacturers will have to recalibrate and redo the certification and homologation for emissions, because all the vehicles that are selling now have been tested, certified, and homologated for emissions using E20.

Then, of course, there is the looming question: the impact on mileage. The problem here is that the brunt of the drop in fuel efficiency from the E10 to E20 transition was borne by the motorist. "In case of this new transition too, the consumer will likely end up bearing the brunt of any drop in fuel efficiency. For older vehicles, there is the added question over vehicle damage due to the high ethanol mix. That too is left to the consumer," a representative of an auto manufacturing association said.

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rently do not have an option to choose different fuels at the petrol pump.

Also, regular ICE cars running on higher ethanol blends, alongside the drop in mileage, are harder to start on winter mornings because ethanol burns at a higher temperature than petrol.

While a fuel with 10 per cent ethanol (E10) made little difference to a car's performance, anything above is said to impact operations. And the worsening of the performance does not exactly progress in a linear fashion as the blending increases.

Material damage

The government deputed The Automotive Research Association of India (ARAI) to study the impact of E20 fuel on the materials used in fuel-system components. An evaluation of eight metals, six elastomers, and four plastics used in various components was carried out through "systematic exercise of laboratory immersion". The study was conducted with E20 as test fuel and commercial petrol (Bharat Stage IV emission standards) as a baseline fuel (E10) for comparative assessment.

The ARAI study concluded that the impact of E20 on metals tested "was found to be insignificant based on the corrosion rates", with polychloroprene and fluoro-elastomer found to perform "similar or better in most of the properties with E20". The impact of E20 on "tensile strength and volume change properties" was found to be

Fuelling protests

Regular ICE cars running on higher ethanol blends, alongside the drop in mileage, are harder to start on winter mornings because ethanol burns at a higher temperature than petrol.

While a fuel with 10 per cent ethanol (E10) made little difference to a car's performance, anything above that is said to impact operations.

around 108 allows it to burn more cleanly inside an internal combustion engine than pure petrol.

have been used in sports cars because of their superior anti-knock characteristics, better power potential and cooling effect stemming from their high latent heat of vaporisation.

ETHANOL AND ethanol-based fuels

more than commercial petrol.

Now, ARAI is a government body, and some of its predictions, including the fuel efficiency ratings that it offers "under standard test conditions", are different in real life driving conditions.

As far as vehicle degradation goes, manufacturers, on record, say they have not encountered any major issue with the E20 transition. Privately though, they admit to this being a concern when the blending levels increase further. Plus, the knock on the fuel economy is absolutely real. As fuel blends increase, this is only going to get worse.

There is a plan to go up from E20 to E25. Alongside that, there is a plan to introduce E85 fuel for flex-fuel vehicles. Even in a flex fuel vehicle, which is equipped to have higher ethanol blends, it's cheaper to run the standard E20 fuel than the proposed E85 because the difference between the price of the fuel normally and in the higher blend has to be more than the fuel efficiency loss of over 25%.

To start off with, E85 fuel will likely cost about Rs 20 per litre less than E20 petrol.

In private, vehicle makers also confide that the impact could be higher from E20 to E25 than it was for E10 to E20. This is especially true for older engines and the ones used on two-wheelers, where high-grade aluminum or steel casts are not used for the engine block. A senior technical expert at a major automaker told *The Indian Express*

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minister", he said. "But the media is typically designed to be an instrument that keeps the State in check. You cannot equate the media with the State."

Sen added that for any act of journalistic irresponsibility, the ideal remedy should be standard civil remedies like defamation suits or tort claims. "By allowing a writ petition against a private media house, the court is essentially constitutionalising a dispute that should have been settled in the realm of private law," he said.

The shift towards writ courts is largely driven by delays in India's civil justice system, according to Divan.

Chilling effect

The primary concern is the potential for weaponisation. Politicians and corporations might use this decision to prevent critical reporting by citing breach of privacy.

Kaushik Moitra, partner at Bharucha & Partners, said: "By declaring all press activ-

ity a 'public function', it hands future litigants an easier maintainability argument". He warned of unintended consequences, including the possibility that "defamation-style claims may be repackaged as privacy/dignity claims".

Sen said that the precedent could create a chilling effect where "journalists will become more docile and defensive, and editorial controls will become overly stringent out of fear of facing constitutional writs".

Yet, experts agreed that context will be crucial. The Delhi HC's strict insistence on consent was rooted in the heightened privacy considerations of a minor sexual assault victim. Divan said that genuine investigative journalism concerning matters of public interest will remain protected, "because public interest will certainly trump the privacy interest." Moitra said that courts could require a strict public interest analysis to avoid allowing privacy to become "a tool for prior restraint."

ELECTRIC 3-WHEELERS MAKE UP 61% OF ANNUAL ELECTRICITY DEMAND FROM INDIA'S EV POPULATION

‘Prioritise charging infra for electric 3Ws’

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 6

AS A government-led push to adopt electric vehicles (EVs) gains momentum, a statistics ministry report has said commercial three-wheeler charging corridors should be prioritised as this category of EVs accounts for the majority of electricity demand.

According to the India EV Electricity Demand Assessment Report, part of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation's (MoSPI) report of the Expert Committee on Energy Statistics, electric three-wheelers make up as much as 61% of the annual electricity demand from India's EV population of 8.97 million vehicles.

"Although 2W vehicles dominate fleet population, their electricity demand remains

lower than 3W and HMV (Heavy Motor Vehicles) categories because of lower annual distance and lower per kilometre energy consumption," the report, released on Monday, said.

As per the report, the annual electricity demand from all the EVs in the country is equal to 20.07 terawatt-hours per year, or roughly 1.1% of India's annual electricity generation. While this indicates that "current EV penetration remains manageable for the national power grid", the NITI Aayog estimates that it may rise to 100 TWh-640 TWh/year by 2030.

"The increasing penetration of EVs introduces additional electricity demand on the national grid, making it essential to quantify category-wise energy consumption for future infrastructure planning," the report said, with the expert com-

● India's EVs and their electricity requirement

EV segment	Estimated number	Electricity demand (million kWh/year)
2-wheelers	4,365,648	2,095.51
3-wheelers	4,144,490	12,320.68
Light Motor Vehicles/cars	425,562	1,276.60
Medium Motor/goods vehicles	5,271	28.46
Heavy Motor Vehicles/buses/trucks	32,940	4,348.08
TOTAL	8,973,911	20,069.43

SOURCE: REPORT OF THE EXPERT COMMITTEE ON ENERGY STATISTICS, MoSPI

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBdF> committee recommending that the government's commitments warrant systematic estimation and dissemination of electricity consumption by EVs in India.

The MoSPI report comes days after the Delhi government said no petrol motorcycles and scooters will be reg-

istered after March 31, 2028, while the registration of new CNG auto-rickshaws will stop in 2026-27. As such, starting April 2028, every new two- and three-wheeler sold in Delhi will have to be electric.

This sweeping policy is a first in India and aims to make



Charging station of electric cars in Gurugram. GAJENDRA YADAV

the country's capital pollution-free by March 2030.

As per the MoSPI report, there are 4.37 million electric two-wheelers in the country and 4.14 million three-wheelers, together making up 95% of all EVs in India.

Heavy Motor Electric Ve-

hicles or buses and trucks, meanwhile, only make up 0.4% of all EVs but command an electricity share of almost 22%, with the report noting that "annual energy consumption increases significantly with vehicle size... due to higher payload and long-distance operation".

Apart from commercial three-wheeler charging corridors, the report also said future infrastructure deployment should prioritise urban fleet charging stations, bus depots and freight charging hubs, and fast-charging infrastructure for heavy-duty transportation.

"Residential charging associated with two-wheelers is comparatively manageable because of lower charging power and lower annual electricity consumption," it added.

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Car retail sales hit Jun record; cleaner fuels gain ground

Akbar Merchant
Mumbai, July 6

PASSENGER VEHICLE (PV) retail sales hit a record high for June, rising 28.63% year-on-year to 411,000 units, while outpacing the roughly 24% growth in wholesale dispatches reported by automakers earlier this month, signalling healthy customer demand and continued inventory normalisation at dealerships.

The month also marked a milestone for the industry, with alternative-fuel vehicles accounting for more than 40% of PV retail registrations for the first time.

As per the data released by the Federation of Automobile

Dealers Associations (FADA) on Monday, retail sales were also up 2.05% over May, supported by healthy bookings, improved supplies and sustained demand across powertrains.

CNG, hybrid and battery electric vehicles together accounted for 40.35% of registrations, up from 38.02% in May. CNG remained the largest alternative fuel at 24.33%, followed by hybrids at 8.27% and battery electric vehicles at 7.75%. Petrol vehicles accounted for 43.63% of registrations, while diesel's share slipped further to 16.02%.

Electric PV sales reached a record 31,823 units during the month, taking EV penetration to 7.75%, compared with 4.8% a year earlier. FE

India can become connector economy, work across divides: Anand Mahindra

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 6

WITH UNCERTAINTY no longer the exception, the next global order may well be shaped by those who can become "connectors" in a fragmented world. This presents an opportunity for India to become a "connector economy" that works across divides, said Anand Mahindra, Chairman of the Mahindra Group.

"It is already beginning to establish this reputation with its low-key 'goodwill towards all' approach over the past year," he said in his letter to the shareholders in the Annual Report of Mahindra & Mahindra. Add to that, India's democracy and political stability, its geographical position as a political and economic buffer against China, its large internal market, and the trust which it generates across ideological blocs, and you have the definition of a perfect "connector economy", Mahindra said.

According to him, uncertainty is no longer the exception; it is the rule.

"Black swan events have become obsolete because the pond is full of black swans. Situations that were previously seen as temporary disruptions are now proving to be a more long-term reset of supply chains, geopolitical alignments and technologies," he said.

"There is a shift from episodic shocks to continuous earthquakes, where anticipating change is increasingly difficult, and the imperative is to build the agility and resilience to navigate a constantly shifting landscape. Manthan 2.0 is, indeed, upon us," the chairman said.

"Can we continue to reap the amrit in this new Manthan? For India, the stars are favourable," he said. India's rise today is being increasingly aligned with the way the world is being re-configured.

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● BRIEFLY



SK Hynix launches \$28 bn US listing to ride global AI wave

San Francisco: South Korean chipmaker SK Hynix Monday launched a US share sale to raise 43 trillion won (\$28.07 billion) and drew indications of interest for up to \$7 billion from major investors, as it capitalises on the global AI boom with one of the world's largest new share sales. Baillie Gifford Overseas, investment funds managed by Coatue Management and

Situational Awareness Partners have each separately indicated interest in buying up to a combined \$7 billion worth of SK Hynix's American depositary receipts, or ADRs, SK Hynix said. Baillie Gifford Overseas declined to comment, while Coatue Management and Situational Awareness Partners did not immediately respond to a request for comment. REUTERS

India, EU to finish legal scrubbing of FTA text: Goyal

New Delhi: India and the EU are expected to complete the legal scrubbing of the FTA text in the next 15-20 days, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said Monday. After the legal scrubbing of the text, both sides are expected to sign the agreement by the end of this year and may implement it next year. PTI

Power Grid secures 80 bn yen loan from JBIC

New Delhi: Power Grid Corporation of India on Monday said it has secured a loan of 80 billion yen from the Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC). The facility will support financing of the Khavda-Nagpur HVDC transmission project, the statement said. PTI

TPG, ICICI Bank, GIC to buy Aseem Infra from NIIF

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 6

US-BASED TPG, a leading global alternative asset management firm, has signed definitive agreements with National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF) to acquire 100% stake in Aseem Infrastructure Finance, alongside co-investor partners GIC of Singapore and ICICI Bank.

TPG's investment is being made through TPG Rise Climate, the firm's dedicated climate investing platform, as part of its global south initiative, a strategy that was launched in partnership with ALTERRA and designed to scale climate solutions across emerging markets.

ICICI Bank will hold up to 5% in the company. While NIIF and TPG didn't disclose the cost of acquisition, market estimates put the deal at around Rs 5,000 crore. Aseem Infrastructure Finance is a leading sustainable infrastructure debt financier with a core focus on renewable energy, power transmission and other infrastructure assets in India. The firm was founded and scaled from inception in 2020 by the NIIF, India's sovereign-anchored alternative asset manager. NIIF, anchored by the government, is the firm's majority shareholder, with the government of India and SMBC Japan as minority shareholders. FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Microsoft to lay off 4,800 workers

Bengaluru: Microsoft is cutting about 2.1% of its workforce, or roughly 4,800 jobs, as the Windows maker restructures parts of its commercial and Xbox businesses, joining other tech titans in a wave of layoffs as they shift investments towards AI infrastructure. Its shares were down 1.5% in early trading.

Big Tech's historic AI outlays, set to top \$700 billion this year, are piling pressure on companies to show returns from

the technology and offset the rising cost of rolling it out across their businesses. Amazon and Meta Platforms have also laid off thousands of employees this year.

In a memo to employees, Chief People Officer Amy Coleman said AI was changing how work gets done by automating some routine tasks, but said the layoffs were part of a broader effort to realign resources and operating structures with the company's priorities. REUTERS



Regd. Office: 3rd Floor, Maker Chambers IV, 222, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021.
Phone: +91-22-3555 5000 • Fax: +91-22-2204 2268 • E-mail: investor.relations@ril.com
CIN: L17110MH1973PLC019786

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to SEBI Circular HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, request(s) have been received by the Company from the Transferee(s) / Claimant(s) to transfer the below mentioned share(s) held in the name(s) of the shareholder(s) as detailed below, to his/her/their name(s).

Sl. No.	Name and address of Claimant(s)	Folio No(s).	Name and address of the registered shareholder(s)	Certificate No.	No. of Equity Shares	Distinctive Numbers	
						From	To
1	Dhani Ram Sharma DA 8, 2nd Floor Vikas Marg, Shakarpur Delhi - 110092	34301158	Rakesh Kumar Singh S P Raghuv 7, Jawahar Nagar Khandhari Cross Agra - 282002	61900520 66509415	20 40	2181210071 6861735543	2181210090 6861735582
2	Sardar Jagjeetsingh Saluja Gandhi Marg, Tarana Post & Tehsil Tarana Distt Ujjain Madhya Pradesh - 456665	48015255	Madhu Devi Saraf 23, Mandeville Gardens Ballygunge Kolkata West Bengal - 700019	55940561	50	303028278	303028327
3	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	65150573	Leelavathi Madhu Steel Corpn 2nd Cross, Nr Road Bangalore - 560002	66794553	100	6887068749	6887068848
4	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	65150581	Venkatamma Law & Laws, I Floor No 41, B Usman Khan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794554	100	6887068849	6887068948
5	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	65158264	S S Sharma C/o Law & Laws No 42, B Oosmankhan Road N R Road, II Cross, 1st Floor Bangalore - 560002	66794559	100	6887069349	6887069448
6	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	65158272	Sakki Bai C/o Law & Laws No 42, B Oosmankhan Road N R Road, II Cross, 1st Floor Bangalore - 560002	66794560	100	6887069449	6887069548
7	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	65158302	Noor Ahmed C/o Madhu Steel Corporation 5/6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore - 560002	66794561	50	6887069549	6887069598
8	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	67341341	Jaishree Law & Laws, I Floor No.41, B Usman Khan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794569	200	6887070285	6887070484
9	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	67378369	P K Aggarwal C/o Law & Laws No 42, B Oosmankhan Road N R Road, II Cross, 1st Floor Bangalore - 560002	66794578	50	6887071235	6887071284
10	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	68851971	Jolly Peter Law & Laws, 1st Cross No 41, B Susmankan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794579	100	6887071285	6887071384
11	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	68878314	Sudha Rani Vijayanagar Steel No.42, B Oosmankhan Rd Bangalore - 560002	66794585	50	6887072165	6887072214
12	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	72359321	Chennamma Law & Laws, 1st Floor No 41, B Usman Khan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794603	120	6887073913	6887074032
13	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	72359330	Jolly Peter Law & Laws, 1st Floor No 41, B Usman Khan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794604	120	6887074033	6887074152
14	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	72394321	Movina Bai Sri Dhanwanthari Steel Ground Floor No 42, BOK Road N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore - 560002	66794614	60	6887075133	6887075192
15	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	73842379	Venkatamma Law and Laws 1st Floor No 41, B Usman Khan Road Bangalore - 560002	66794615	120	6887075193	6887075312
16	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	73842387	Leela Vathi Madhu Steel Corporation 2nd Cross, N R Road Bangalore - 560002	66794616	120	6887075313	6887075432
17	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	73866855	Mohan Sri Dhanwanthari Steels Ground Floor No 42, BOK Road N R Road, 2nd Cross Bangalore - 560002	66794618	60	6887075553	6887075612
18	Deva P Gupta (Kartha) No 5 and 6, Millia Building N R Road 2nd Cross Bangalore Karnataka - 560002	74263313	Kishore Ganga Televisions Mem Complex, N R Rd. II Cross Bangalore - 560002	66794621	60	6887075693	6887075752

These shares were claimed to have been purchased / acquired by respective Transferee(s) / Claimant(s) and were earlier submitted for transfer and / or sent under objection by the Company.

Any person(s) who has / have any objection in this regard, should lodge such objection with the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent viz. "KFIN Technologies Limited", Selenium Tower B, Plot No. 31-32, Gachibowli, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Hyderabad - 500 032, within Thirty (30) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which, the Company will proceed to transfer the aforesaid shares.

For Reliance Industries Limited
Sd/-
Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place : Mumbai
Date : 07.07.2026

www.ril.com

25 killed & over 100 injured in clashes at Sri Lanka prison



Prisoners board a bus after being transferred following clashes at Negombo Prison, Sri Lanka, on Monday. AP

Associated Press
Colombo, July 6

CLASHES BROKE out inside a prison in the outskirts of Sri Lanka's capital, killing at least 25 people and injuring more than 100, officials and a TV station reported Monday.

Police said the unrest at the prison in Negombo, about 35 kilometers north of the capital, Colombo, began on Sunday and continued on Monday. Spokesman Chandana Herath said there were fatalities but could not immediately confirm the toll reported by local television station *Hiru*. Victims include both inmates and prison officials, the TV reported.

Prison spokesman AC Gajayanayake said the violence started among inmates and when prison guards attempted to intervene on Monday, "they (inmates) started attacking the prison officials." He told reporters some inmates attempted to escape but were stopped.

The clashes left several officials and inmates dead while several were hospitalized, Gajayanayake said, without giving the exact numbers.

An official at the area's main state-run hospital said that more than 100 people were admitted with injuries from the prison clash.

U.S. PRESIDENT'S THREAT AFTER IRAN PROJECTS DEFIANCE AT KHAMENEI FUNERAL

Either a deal with Iran, or US will 'finish the job': Trump

Tehran bent on retaining control over Hormuz Strait

Reuters
Washington, July 6

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Monday the United States would either reach a deal with Iran or "finish the job," renewing his threat of military action as Tehran projects defiance following the funeral of Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

Indirect US-Iran talks ended last week without any public sign of headway toward a lasting peace, despite a 60-day ceasefire intended to create space for diplomacy following US and Israeli strikes that triggered the conflict. "We're either going to make a deal or we're going to finish the job. OK. And it won't be tough to finish the job. I'd rather make a deal, because I don't want to affect 91 million people," Trump told reporters in the Oval Office.

"We can knock down their bridges in one hour, we can knock out their energy



A truck carrying coffins of the late Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and members of his family make way through mourners during the funeral procession in Tehran on Monday. AP

supply.... They don't have any money now. We haven't given them any money."

Trump spoke after Khamenei's weekend funeral where, rather than looking weakened by the war that began with US and Israeli strikes on February 28, Iranians appeared to be defiant, united and determined to shape what comes next.

The 60-day clock towards a final deal following the ceasefire agreement and the accompanying MoU is yet to start. In that vacuum, Iran is setting the pace,

including in the Strait.

Although huge revenues might be earned from charging fees for vessels using the strait, Tehran sees Hormuz less as an economic asset than as a source of political legitimacy, said Alex Vatanka of US-based Middle East Institute.

"The symbolic part is more important for the Iranians than revenues," Vatanka said. "They want some kind of symbolic acceptance the Strait is Iran's. It's about accepting Iran as the sovereign power over the Strait."

Mourners call for vengeance on Trump during funeral procession

Tehran: Crowds of Iranians marched through the streets of Tehran on Monday in a funeral procession for slain leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, the biggest day yet in a week of massive memorial ceremonies demonstrating the grip of surviving clerical leaders.

The caskets of the slain leader and four of his family members were driven in a large truck through the streets, while fire hoses sprayed water from above to keep the marchers cool.

As they passed under a bridge, mourners hurled stones at a billboard hung from above showing US President Donald Trump with a bullet aimed at his head. "The US killed our father," it read. "We won't let you go!"

As demonstrators set fire to US and British flags, women in black chadors held aloft red placards with "KILL TRUMP" in black letters.

REUTERS



Emergency services personnel at the site of a Russian missile strike in Kyiv, on Monday. AP

Waves of Russian missiles and drones target Kyiv, killing 22

Associated Press
Kyiv, July 6

RUSSIA UNLEASHED waves of missiles and drones at Ukraine early Monday, killing at least 22 people, authorities said.

All of the ballistic missiles launched by Russia struck their targets, underscoring Kyiv's need for more US-made Patriot interceptor missiles - a point Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy will likely reiterate at a NATO summit in Ankara, Turkey, this week.

Fifteen people were killed in the capital of Kyiv, which was Russia's main target, and 56 were injured, according to administrative head Tymur Tkachenko. Another six people were killed in the wider Kyiv region and 21 were injured.

Moscow has stepped up strikes on Kyiv in retaliation for Ukraine's recent long-range strikes, according to the Russian Defence Ministry. Those attacks have caused severe fuel shortages and put pressure on Presi-

dent Vladimir Putin. On Thursday, a Russian strike killed 31 people in Kyiv, the deadliest attack in the capital this year.

Ukraine's advances in drone technology have given it an edge in recent months, analysts and Western officials say, striking supply routes behind the front line, stripping the Russian army of momentum on the battlefield and slowing its advance.

But Russia is now exploiting a different kind of momentum: vulnerabilities in Ukraine's air defences, which remain heavily reliant on the Patriot missile systems to intercept ballistic missiles it can rarely shoot down.

Ukraine's air force said Russia fired 351 drones and 68 missiles overnight, targeting mainly Kyiv, and all 29 ballistic missiles struck their targets. Ahead of the NATO summit in Turkey, Zelenskyy said Ukrainian forces had performed well against drones and cruise missiles but not against ballistic missiles, a shortfall he blamed on insufficient supplies of interceptors.

REUTERS

Ukraine drones strike Russia's largest refinery

Moscow: Ukrainian drones struck Russia's Omsk refinery, the country's largest and located deep in Siberia, in what would be one of the longest-ranged Ukrainian strikes since the beginning of the war, Kyiv's military said on Monday, with local Russian authorities also confirming a strike.

Ukraine's General Staff said that the strike had caused a fire at the Omsk refinery, which is located around 2,700 km from Ukrainian-held territory and close to Russia's border with Kazakhstan. Sources told Reuters that the Gazpromneft-owned Omsk refinery processed around 23 million metric tons last year, or around 460,000 barrels per day.

REUTERS



Cuba's Bengal Cubs

The birth of four Bengal tiger cubs, including this exceedingly rare white tiger, at the Cuban National Zoo in Havana is being seen as a small miracle on an island stifled by shortages of fuel, medicine and power outages. "It's only the second time" white tigers have been born in Cuba, a zoo-keeper said, gleaming with pride. REUTERS

China test fires missile into Pacific from nuclear sub, region alarmed

Beijing: China's military test-fired a missile from a nuclear-powered submarine into the Pacific on Monday, state media reported, drawing criticism and concerns from Japan, Australia and New Zealand over Beijing's expanding military reach.

A nuclear submarine of the People's Liberation Army Navy launched the missile carrying a dummy warhead toward inter-

national waters in the Pacific at 12:01 pm, the official Xinhua news agency said. The missile landed in "designated waters," it added, without giving further details of the location.

Xinhua described the launch as a "routine arrangement" of China's annual military training and said it was not directed against any specific country or target. REUTERS

NATO defence push strains Europe's budgets

Reuters
London, July 6

NATO SECRETARY General Mark Rutte will insist at this week's alliance summit that member states are keeping their promise to boost defence spending. Yet progress has been uneven and push is already stretching some national budgets.

Under pressure from President Donald Trump, members of the 32-country military pact agreed at last year's summit to boost defence spending to 5% of GDP by 2035 - just over double the overall level for European states and Canada in 2025.

But since then, two camps

have emerged: one is led by Germany and the mostly Nordic and eastern European nations which have found the fiscal space to raise spending; in the other are several big players struggling to do the same.

"The UK isn't managing, for example. France isn't and Italy isn't either," Guntram Wolff, senior fellow at the Bruegel economics think tank, said of the three largest economies in Europe behind Germany.

NATO says its European members plus Canada spent an extra \$90 billion on defence in real terms last year compared to 2024 as they seek to raise core military spending to 3.5% of GDP by 2035 with a further 1.5% GDP on security-related items.

'Restraining order needed': Trump goads Meloni again

Reuters
Rome, July 6

ITALY'S DEFENCE minister stressed the importance of good transatlantic relations on Monday after US President Donald Trump again goaded erstwhile ally Giorgia Meloni, the Italian prime minister.

Meloni last month accused Trump of fabricating a story about her after the US president told an Italian TV channel that she had "begged" him to take a

photo with her at a G7 summit in France. With the two leaders due to attend a NATO summit in Turkey this week, Trump appeared to reignite the dispute when he posted on Truth Social a picture of Meloni looking up at him with the caption "RESTRAINING ORDER NEEDED".

The Italian prime minister has yet to respond.

"I did not have any reaction (to the post), the fundamental thing is to maintain relations with a key ally like the USA," Defence

• NATO SUMMIT STARTS TODAY

WHICH LEADERS WILL BE THERE?: Leaders from NATO's 32 member countries, including Trump. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, South Korean President Lee Jae Myung will join the dinner on Tuesday evening.

WHAT WILL LEADERS DISCUSS?: Progress towards defence spending targets, boosting defence industrial production and how to implement "burden-shifting" from the US to Europe.

WHAT WILL THE ALLIANCE DO ON INDUSTRY?: To focus on scaling up weapons production and boosting defence innovation. Will also host a defence industry



A Turkish flag & NATO banner cover buildings ahead of the summit in Ankara, Turkey. AP

forum in Ankara.

WILL IRAN COME UP?: Members are concerned that the Iran war, and Trump's irritation with Europe over its response to it, could overshadow the summit.



Italian PM Giorgia Meloni. FILE

Minister Guido Crosetto told Italy's Sky TV. "People come and go but relationships remain," he added.

Opposition politicians were

less restrained. "Trump is a despicable, cheap bully," Carlo Calenda, the leader of the small Azione party, wrote on X, expressing his support for Meloni.

Meloni was once a vocal supporter of Trump and was the only European leader to attend his inauguration in 2025. However, she criticised him this year for lashing out at Pope Leo over his condemnation of the Iran conflict. That in turn prompted a blunt rebuke from the US president, who accused her of lacking courage.

• GUTERRES WARNED ABOUT THE CONCENTRATION OF MOST ADVANCED A.I. SYSTEMS WITHIN A HANDFUL OF COMPANIES & COUNTRIES, MEANING DEVELOPING COUNTRIES HAVE LITTLE SAY IN THE PROGRESS OF A.I.

UN's Guterres warns AI outpacing oversight, urges global rules to protect children

Reuters
Geneva, July 6

UN SECRETARY-General Antonio Guterres on Monday warned that artificial intelligence is developing faster than anyone can keep up, calling for globally harmonised rules to reduce potential risks - especially to children.

"A technology that can reshape economies, transform the world of work, sway elections and tilt the balance of security is being deployed faster than anyone, including the people building it, can keep up," Guterres told delegates at the first-ever government-level global dialogue on AI in Geneva.

"Innovation needs guardrails ... If AI is to be powerful, it must be governed," Guterres told delegates.

The two-day inaugural UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance is not intended to forge a treaty, but to discuss how to set rules to mitigate the potential harms of AI and take advantage of its opportunities.

Delegates will consider a report by a UN-backed independent scientific panel of 40 experts, who will present findings from the first global, independent scientific assessment of AI.

A more comprehensive report is planned next year, alongside a second global meet-

ing in New York.

Guterres stressed that globally harmonised rules on AI must prioritise safety for children after examples of minors being steered towards self-harm and being deceived by machines posing as friends.

"We do not let medicine reach a child until it is proven safe. We test every toy. Yet AI has reached our children - their learning, their friendships, their most private questions - before anyone asked what it would do to them," he said.

He also called for an AI Child Safety Pledge, where companies building systems would have to prove they are safe before making them ac-



UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres during a meeting at the UN headquarters in New York City on April 27. FILE

cessible to children.

Systems should also not be allowed to generate sexual

images of children, and when a child shows signs of distress, the system should stop and

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

connect them to a human for help. While AI poses significant opportunities, such as in healthcare, Guterres said the world's institutions were not prepared for machines that make decisions, and that AI's breakneck speed of development meant machines were increasingly making choices with little human or government oversight. "The internet took 15 years to reach a billion people. AI got there in two," Guterres told delegates.

He also warned about the concentration of the most advanced AI systems within a handful of companies and countries, meaning developing countries have little say in the

progress of AI and risk being left behind.

The independent report of scientific experts found that AI development is even more concentrated, with the US accounting for 75% of the computing power among the world's top 500 AI supercomputers, and China 15%.

While globally over a billion people now use conversational AI weekly, adoption in developing countries lags, the report added. Guterres said if used well, AI could compress decades of development into years, potentially becoming "the great equalizer of the 21st century".

The head of Libya's Presi-

dential Council, Mohamed al-Menfi, urged that the AI gap be closed in Africa, which accounts for 10% of the world's population but only possesses fewer than 2% of global data centres.

"AI cannot be a legitimate resource if African countries cannot make use of it," he said, calling for participation of African states in design of AI rules.

Georgian President Mikheil Kavelashvili told delegates that world leaders also had a shared responsibility to create robust international laws to prevent the power of AI from becoming an "instrument of totalitarian control and new digital tyranny".

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Tender Notice No: 12/2026-27/SE(bheemili)/EE-/DB, Dt: 04-07-2026

Number of works : 3 Works, Value of work : Rs.3,89,06,444/-

Tender Downloading Date: 04-07-2026, Closing Date: 20-07-2026.

Note: Further details at <http://www.tender.apeprocurement.gov.in>

O/o the EE-I Cell No.7995333308 Sd/- Commissioner, GVMC

कार्यालय नगरपालिका चिड़ावा जिला झुझुनू (राज.)

E-mail ID :- nagarpalika.chirawa@gmail.com

क्रमांक :- नपाचि / 2026-2027 / 129 दिनांक :- 02.07.2026

(अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना सं 05 /2026-27)

(NIB No. DLB2627A3809)

"IOT Based Door to Door Collection and Transportation in All wards of Municipal Board Area Chirawa" (for 1 years) के कार्य करने के ईच्छुक संवेदकगण / फर्म जो कार्य करने हेतु अधिकृत पंजीकृत है, से दरें निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा वेबे जाने तथा प्राप्त करने की तारीख, निविदा शर्तें आदि का सम्पूर्ण विवरण राज्य सरकार की ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in पर देखी व डाउनलोड की जा सकती हैं।

UBN No. DLB2627SLRC09258

राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 6246

अधिशामी अधिकारी
नगरपालिका चिड़ावा

RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD

No. :- ACE-/RHB/JPR/2026-27/60 Dt. :- 02/07/2026

NIB : 02/2026-27

Online bids are invited from registered firms for the work of 1. Renewal & Maintenance work of B.T. Roads & Construction and Repairing of Drains at Beawar Scheme 2. Renovation Repair and Regular maintenance of Technology Park, Mansarovar, Jaipur 3. Construction of Retaining wall, Sector-13, Indira Gandhi Nagar, Jagatpura, Jaipur through e-proc for S.No. 1 from 08.07.2026 to 28.07.2026 and S.No. 2 & 3 from 08.07.2026 to 20.07.2026 upto 6:00 PM. Complete details like tender form, detailed information and conditions etc. are available on website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> & Board website <https://rhb.rajasthan.gov.in>.

UBN No. :- RHB2627WSOB00087 To RHB2627WSOB00089

Raj.Samwad/C/26/6312 Addl. Chief Engineer-I, Jaipur

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Deputy Chief Engineer, 2nd Floor, 9th Main Road, 9th Cross Road, Jayanagara 2nd block, Bengaluru-560011.

No: DCE/BSCC/TEND/02/2026-27/Corr-1 Date: 06.07.2026

CORRIGENDUM-1

Name of the work : Annual maintenance and desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year.

Ref: Tender Notification No: DCE/BSCC/TEND/ 02 /2026-27, Date: 03.07.2026

Adverting to the above, following Corrigendum to the above tender work is issued

Sl. No.	Description	Calendar of events in tender notification	To be Read as
1	Name of the work Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year (package-1) Rs.200.00 Lakhs Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year (package-2) Rs.190.00 Lakhs		Annual Maintenance and Desilting of Storm Water Drains in Bommanahalli Assembly Constituency for one year Rs.390.00 Lakhs
2	Tender Document may be downloaded through KPP portal from	06.07.2026 onwards	08.07.2026 onwards
3	Last Date & Time for receipt of Tenders	14.07.2026 up to 4:00 PM	16.07.2026 up to 4:00 PM
4	Opening of Technical bid	16.07.2026 after 04:30 PM	18.07.2026 after 4:30 PM

All the other terms & conditions are remaining unchanged. **Sd/ - Deputy Chief Engineer**

Office of the Resident Commissioner
Govt. of Jharkhand New Jharkhand Bhawan
Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi-110001.

Notice Inviting Short-Term e-tender

e-tenders are invited from reputed interested bidders for providing premises for the accommodation to Security Personnel of Jharkhand Bhawan, New Delhi.

1.Date of issue of Tender notice in website - 09.07.2026 11:00 AM
2. Bid Submission start date & time - 09.07.2026 11:00 AM
3. Bid Submission end date & time - 15.07.2026 06:00 PM
4. Date & Time of opening of technical bid - 17.07.2026 11:00 AM
5. Date & Time of opening of financial bid - To be notified when evaluation of technical bid is completed.

Details & tender document can be downloaded from website-jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Non-commercial entities can register themselves by entering GST No./PAN No. etc. in the place of registration number at registration portal at jharkhandtenders.gov.in, in case registration number is not available.

Sd/-
Chief Administrative Officer

PR.NO.384104 Cabinet(26-27):D

GUJARAT ENERGY TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

Registered & Corporate Office, Sardar Patel Vidhyut Bhavan, Racecourse, VADODARA - 390 007

www.getcogujarat.com & <https://www.nprocure.com>

TENDER NOTICE NO. ACE (P&C): Tender No. 07: 2026-2027

[A] CIVIL: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ CIVIL- 627, 628, 629, 648, 649, 650, 651, 652:-

(1) Construction of 4X double circuit RCC Cable trench package-1 from chainage 0.00 to 1900.00m for 220 kV Power cable at 220 kV Khoraj S/s to Maruti Suzuki India Ltd plant under Surendranagar Circle.,**(2)** Construction of 4X double circuit RCC Cable trench package-2 from 1900.00m to 4200.00m for 220 kV Power cable at 220 kV Khoraj S/s to Maruti Suzuki India Ltd plant under Surendranagar Circle.,**(3)** Construction of New Control Room Building (G+1) (on pile) for shifting of existing control room, 11 kV DP foundation, Cable Trench, Paver Block, RCC Road, Septic Tank, Soak pit, Water Sump, new Compound wall, Electrification & Other misc. civil works at 66 kV Motaborasara S/s under AM Division Kim & Bharuch Circle.,**(4)** Construction of Administrative Building (G+2) along with necessary amenities including Electrification, Plumbing, Furniture, Fire safety system & other ancillary work for Asset Management Division & allied offices at 66 kV Vyara S/s campus Dist. Tapi under Navsari Circle.,**(5)** Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, Compound Wall, RCC Road and Misc. Civil works at 66 kV Nesadi-2 S/s, Ta. Khambha & Dist. Amreli under Amreli Circle.,**(6)** Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, C'Wall, RCC Road & misc. Civil works etc at 66 kV Sankhari S/s, Ta. & Dist. Patan under Mehsana circle.,**(7)** Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, C'Wall, RCC Road & other misc civil works at 66 kV Degam S/s Ta. Nanapondha, Dist.- Valsad and Opp. end line-bay foundation at 66 kV Moti-Tambadi S/s & 66 kV Kakadkopar S/s under Navsari Circle.,**(8)** Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Precast Cable Trench, Precast Compound Wall, RCC Road & misc. civil works etc. at 66 kV Roziya S/s Ta. Dhrol, Dist. Jamnagar under Jamnagar Circle.

[B] LINE: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ E-465/TL/UG/ 132kV/S&E:- Supply, Erection, Testing& Commissioning of 132 kV 2x(3+0) 1Cx800sq.mm U/G cable for of 2nd circuit of 132 kV D/C Varshamedi-Wankaner line at 132 kV Mota Dahisara S/s. (Route Length- 1.1Km)

Above tenders are available on websites www.getcogujarat.com (for view and download only) & [tender.nprocure.com](https://www.nprocure.com) (For view, download and online tender submissions).

Note: Bidders are requested to be in touch with our website till opening of these tenders.

Date: 07/07/2026 Additional Chief Engineer (Procurement & Contracts)

GOVERNMENT OF RAJASTHAN
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Watershed Development and Soil Conservation, District Pali

S. No.F31/TENDER/26-27/1003-07 Dt.:- 29.06.2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No- PALI/05/2026-27

Bids for the execution of "Construction of various watershed development structures under MJSa2.2 Projects of estimated value as mentioned below are invited from interested bidders up to 09.07.2026, 06.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state, and www.watershed.rajasthan.gov.in departmental website.

S.N.	DIST	UBN.NO	Scheme	COST IN LACS
1	PALI	WSC2627WSOB00902	MJSa2.2	1230.04 LAC

MOB NO 8764205308

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer

DIPR/C/11722/2026

IN REMEMBRANCE

Corps of Signals salutes its Signallers who left us for their heavenly abode during the month of Jun 2026.

(1) JC-394216W Naib Subedar Vijay Pal

(2) 15695105W Havildar Md Hamim Ahasan

(3) 15685055H Havildar Jadeja Kesrinsinh Indra Sinha

(4) 15739061M Naik Rahul Singh

(5) 15744060N Naik Manoj Kumar

(6) 15754379F Lance Naik Abhijith Nandan N

(7) 15720421H Lance Naik Vaghela Vanarajsingh Popatsinh

(8) 15718896N Lance Naik Bhilare Tushar Rajendra

(9) 15753485N Signalman Ajay Kumar

Deeply mourned by Lt Gen Vivek Dogra, SM, SO-in-C, Col Comdt and all ranks of Corps of Signals.

Central Drug Store
O/o Civil Surgeon Fatehabad

Sect-3, HUDA, Fatehabad, District: Fatehabad (Haryana)

E-mail: dhs.csftb@hry.nic.in, cds.ftb1@gmail.com

Notice for Quotation

Sealed quotations are invited by Central Drug Store O/o Civil Surgeon office Fatehabad with following specifications.

Particulars	Specifications
Stationery items	Its terms and conditions & list of Stationery items to be collected from our office (O/o Civil Surgeon Fatehabad Room no 2 ground floor)

Above said every item should be priced. Quotations will be accepted upto 4 PM on dated 07.07.2026. All quotations will be accepted by registered post or by hand in sealed envelope. No quotations will be accepted after dated 14-07-2026 at 4 PM. All rights for acceptance & rejection of quotations are reserved with Civil Surgeon Fatehabad.

Terms & Conditions:-

- All selected quotations are valid upto 31.03.2027.
- If selected firm's quality will be not upto the measures then the 2nd lowest quotation will be selected.
- Attested ITR documents for the last 3 years are provided. The firm's turnover for the 3 years (2022-23, 2023-2024, and 2024-2025) is 2 lakh.
- All document are attested with Firm Stamp. (Aadhar card, Pan Card, GST Certificate,
- All Quotation are GST No mentioned.

Sd/-
Civil Surgeon Fatehabad

No. 46872/HRY

STATE INDUSTRIES PROMOTION CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED
19-A, RUKMINI LAKSHMIPATHY ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI-600 008.
CIN U74999TN1971SGC005967

(ONLINE ONLY)

Tender Notice NIT.No.04/CD/T.No.04/2026-27 Dt.06.07.2026

For and on behalf of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited, tenders are invited under **"Two Cover System"** through online only for the following work from **qualified Bidders** having experience in similar nature of works as mentioned under. Tenders will be received **upto 15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **10.08.2026** and the same will be opened at **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **11.08.2026**.

Name of Work	Approx. value of work	EMD
Creation of Infrastructure Facilities Viz. Formation of Internal Roads with side drain, culverts, providing street light arrangement and providing Water supply distribution pipe line at SIPCOT Industrial Park, Manapara	Rs.4360.00 Lakhs (including GST @18%)	Rs.21,90,000/-*

* EMD shall be paid through **eBG** only (as per the list of banks attached in the Annexure-III)

The tender schedule can be downloaded at free of cost from the website <https://tntenders.gov.in>

DIPR/ 2215/Tender/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	BOARD/ CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	TENDER FOR PROVIDING OF INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL SECURITY INCLUDING DESPATCH OF MILK AND MILK PRODUCTS AT MILK PLANT, ROHTAK BY A REPUTED SECURITY PROVIDING AGENCY.	04.07.2026 20.07.2026	2,50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9856401185 vitarohak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 46861/HRY**

Government of Arunachal Pradesh
Department Animal Husbandry, Veterinary & Dairy Development Nirjuli

NO. AHV/12011/03/2026-27/ Date: -30/06/2026

//Notice Inviting Tender (NIT//)

The Department of Animal Husbandry, Veterinary & Dairy Development, Government of Arunachal Pradesh, invites sealed tenders from the reputed Companies/Authorized Suppliers Manufacturing veterinary Medicine, Vaccine, Instrument & Dairy Appliances for empanelment under the Department for supply of essential veterinary medicines and instruments.

1. Eligibility Criteria: -

- The company must be a registered manufacturer of Veterinary Medicines, vaccines, instrument, Dairy Equipment etc with valid manufacturing license under the Drugs & Cosmetics Act, 1940.
- Valid Research & Development Certificate for patent medicines.
- Must have a Minimum three (03) years of experience in the field.
- Approval from Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)/State Drug Control Authority for veterinary medicines.
- GST registration and PAN Card
- Audited financial statements for last three (03) years.
- Affidavit of non-blacklisting and no pending litigation.
- Financial records (Turnover of minimum ₹ 20.00 crore (Rupees Twenty Crore) for patent drugs and ₹ 5.00 Crore (Rupees Five Crore) for non-patent drugs and surgical instrument and appliances
- Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP)/International Organization for standardization (ISO) certification.

2. Documents to be Submitted

- Company registration certificate.
- Manufacturing license
- Valid Research & Development Certificate for patents Drugs, R& D certificate exempted for non-patent and Instrument, appliances etc.
- Product catalogue
- Financial records (Turnover of 20.00 Crore (Rupees Twenty Crore) only for Patent Drugs and 5.00 Crore (Rupees five crore) for non-patent and other instruments & appliances.
- Major supply orders carried out, by way of marketing or supply invoice of last 3 months supported by E-way bills in Northeast region.
- Undertaking of compliance with tender conditions.
- Declaration or undertaking in Affidavit of company not blacklisted by any Government Department/Agency.
- GST Registration & Pan Card
- Audited Financial Statement for last 3(Three) Years.
- Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP)? International Organization for Standardization (ISO) Certificate

3. Submission of Tender: -

- Tender forms and prescribed formats may be obtained from the Directorate of Animal Husbandry, Veterinary & Dairy Development, Nirjuli, Arunachal Pradesh during office hour on payment of Rs 5000 (Rupees Five Thousand) only in cash or in demand draft in favour of the Director AHV&DD Nirjuli payable at SBI Nirjuli which is nonrefundable.
- Completed tender must be submitted in sealed cover addressed to the Director, Department of Animal Husbandry, Veterinary & Dairy Development, Nirjuli.
- Date of Issue of NIT Paper (Documents): - 06/07/2026 to 23/07/2026 4.00PM
- Last date of submission: -24/07/2026 up to 3.30 PM.
- Date of pre-bidding: -27/07/2026 at 11.00 am
- Opening of tenders: - 28/07/2026 at 11:00 AM.
- Contact Shri Nabam Ram for collection of Document :9402448964

4.General Conditions:

- Only two representatives from the company, carrying valid identity cards issued by the company, will be permitted to participate in the entire tender process.
- Empanelment will be valid for three (03) years, subject to performance review.
- The Department reserves the right to accept/reject any or all tenders.
- Incomplete or late submissions will be summarily rejected.

Sd/-
Director
Animal Husbandry, Veterinary & Dairy Development
Govt of Arunachal Pradesh

DIPR/ARN/0193

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Samiran Kumar Sarkar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Nowgam area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

	CONSTABLE SAMIRAN KUMAR SARKAR 26 BN BSF 01.08.1969 – 07.07.1992	
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CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable P.C.H. Pullaiah of 5 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating militants during an attack on a CRPF post at Safapora, Ganderbal, Jammu & Kashmir on 7 July 1998. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

	Veer Balidani Constable P C H. Pullaiah 5 Bn 10-11-1960 To 07-07-1998	
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INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

	Sub-Inspector Pramod Sajwan		Veer Balidani Constable Tapan Kumar Pal 3 Bn 28-06-1968 To 07-07-1999
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DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable S.K. Mukherjee and Constable Tapan Kumar Pal of 3 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in East Garo Hills, Meghalaya on 7 July 1999. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

ITBP salutes its bravehearts Sub Inspector Pramod Sajwan and Constable Kishan Ram of 19th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in J&K in 1996.

	Constable Ajay Singh Pathania		Constable Roop Singh
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ITBP salutes its bravehearts Constable Ajay Singh Pathania of 9th Battalion and Constable Roop Singh of 12th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty fighting bravely with the militants on this day at Embassy of India in Kabul, Afghanistan in 2008.

LATE SEP MUNSHI RAM

In proud memory of Sep Munshi Ram of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Ukhrul in Manipur on 07 Jul 1986. Your act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

"BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE"

Remembered by Commanding Officer and All Ranks 6 DOGRA

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER WATER RESOURCES ZONE, JAIPUR
Sinchai Bhavan, J.L.N. marg, Malviya Nagar, Jaipur,
E-mail-acejpr.wr@gmail.com

No.-F(430&431)/ACE/JPR/Acctts/2026-27/2473 Date: 25-06-2026
e-NIB No-03/2026-27

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, bids are invited from eligible bidders for the work of -

- Restoration of Madhyha Pushkar Sarovar, Village Nedaliya, Gram Panchayat Kamas & Restoration of drainage System for IDSMT Colony Pushkar, Tehsil Pushkar, District Ajmer. (Estimated value of work is Rs. 544.28 Lac)
- Renovation of Majewala Anicut and Drainage channel, Devnagar and Repair and Renovation of Miyapur Anicut Cum Causeway near Bheru Baba Mela Ground, GP Miyapur, Pushkar District Ajmer. (Estimated value of work is Rs. 557.92 Lac)
- "Bank Protection and Recharging Structure near vidhyapeeth Enhancement of RHS feeder of Budha Pushkar Tehsil Pushkar, Repair work of Bhanwa anicut Tehsil Ajmer, District Ajmer. (Estimated value of work is Rs. 616.82 Lac)

Last date of submission of Bid is 20/07/2026. Detailed Bid & Bid document can be seen on & downloaded from official website (<http://eprocrajasthan.gov.in> & <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>)

NIB Code No.:-WRD2627A0129
UBN No.:- WRD2627WLOB00310,(2) WRD2627WLOB00311
(3) WRD2627WLOB00312

Additional Chief Engineer WRD, Zone Jaipur

DIPR/C/11539/2026

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DEHRADUN
Paras Tower, 2nd Floor, Majra Niranjanpur, Saharanpur Road, Dehradun

R.C. No. 38/2026 Date: 25.06.2026

Bank of India Certificate Holder

Versus

Manoj Narain Agarwal & Anr. Certificate Debtor

DEMAND NOTICE

CD 1. Manoj Narain Agarwal S/o Sh. Karmendra Narain Agarwal R/o Prag Farm Post Gokul Nagar Turka Gori Tehsil Kichha District Udhham Singh Nagar-263148, Uttarakhand.

CD 2. Shalendra Singh S/o Sh. Ramchandrar Singh, R/o MIG A 183, Ward 5, Kichha, District Udhham Singh Nagar -263418, Uttarakhand.

In view of the Recovery Certificate issued in **O.A. No. 153 of 2025** passed by the Presiding Officer, DRT, Dehradun an amount of **Rs. 45,71,357.62** (Rupees Forty Five Lakhs Seventy One Thousand Three Hundred Fifty Seven and Paise Sixty Two Only) along with pendente lite and future interest @ **11.00%** simple interest yearly w.e.f. **20.02.2025** till realization and costs of **Rs. 1,00,005/-** has become due against you (Jointly and severally)

You are hereby called upon to deposit the above sum within 15 days of the receipt of the notice, failing which the recovery shall be made as per rules.

You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on **03.09.2026** at 10.30 a.m. for further proceedings.

In additions to the sum aforesaid you will be liable to pay.

a. Such interest as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the execution proceedings.

b. All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and other process that may be taken for recovering the amount due.

Recovery Officer
Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
[email-essjammu@jkpolice.gov.in](mailto:essjammu@jkpolice.gov.in)
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Gopal Singh S/O Milap Singh R/O Chatta Gujrian, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 169/2009 U/S 379 RPC of P/S Bakshi Nagar, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Gopal Singh
S/O	: Milap Singh
Address	: Chatta Gujrian, Jammu
Height	: 5' 03"
Complexion	: Wheatish
Eyes	: Black

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail ID	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City North	: 0191-2547038
5. SDPO City West	: 0191-2580251
6. P/S Bakshi Nagar	: 0191-2580102

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

No. Date:- .07.2026

DIP/J-5094/26- DATE 06 JULY 2026

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,PARVEEN w/o ABDUL SATTAR R/O A-15/120, DDA FLATS INDERLOK SARAI ROHILLA , Delhi -110035, inform that PARVEEN and PARVEEN BEGUM both are one & the same Person.PARVEEN is my Name for All legal Purposes.

0040864416-3

I, Navita Bakshi R/o P-11, Kasturba Niketan Complex, Lajpat Nagar -II, New Delhi-110024 have changed the name of my Minor Child aged 13 yrs from Tejas to Tejas Bakshi

0071046061-1

I,Moxa D/O Jaswinder Singh R/O House No-9, Second Floor, Pocket-21, Sector-24, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Moxa Singh.

0040864448-2

I,MERUNISHA,W/O-ZAHIR SHAH,R/O C-68,4TH FLOOR,FLAT.NO.10, ABUL-FAZAL ENCLAVE PART-1,JAMIA-NAGAR, OKHLA,SOUTH DELHI-110025.INFORM THAT GIVEN NAME-ASMA,FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040864408-7

I,Ravinder Singh Tanwar S/o Sh. Daryav Singh Tanwar R/o B-70, Third Floor, Naraina Vihar, New Delhi-110028, declare Ravinder Singh Tanwar & Ravinder Singh is one and same person

0040864313-1

I, hitherto known as RUCHI MISHRA W/O SUSHIL KUMAR R/o Flat No-203, Plot No-606A, Sector-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201010, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as RUCHI TRIPATHI.

0071046012-1

I,Gurmeet Singh S/o Gurbaksh Singh R/o,Ground-Floor,A-206 (Old-No.WZ-33/7),Sudershan-Park Extn.,New Delhi-110015, have changed my-name to Gurmeet Singh Panesar.

0040864435-9

I, Vrinda Aggarwal D/o Peeyush Kumar Aggarwal, W/o Mukund Goel R/o 355 Deepali, Pitampura New Delhi-110034 India, have changed my name to Vrinda Goel.

0071046125-1

I,Virbala Sharma,W/o-Chhabi Raj Sharma,R/o-Y-36A,Budh Vihar Phase-1,Delhi-110086, have changed,my name from Virbala Sharma, to Veerbala Sharma, as per affidavit dated-03/07/2026.

0040864409-7

I,AYUSHI ARORA W/O MANAN ARORA R/O M-6/15, FIRST FLOOR, DLF PHASE-2, GURGAON,HARYANA-122008, have changed my name to AYUSHI MALHOTRA.

0040864435-2

I,Mithlesh Pathak S/o Gajender Pathak R/o Flat-D-4, H.No.698, Shiva Apartments, Shiv-Colony, Old Faridabad (HR-121002), have changed my name to Mithlesh Pathak for all purposes.

0040864349-1

I,Urmila Chauhan,W/o-Jeet Singh Chauhan,R/o House.No.-330A,Chauhan Mohalla,Madanpur Khadar,Sarita Vihar,New-Delhi-110076,have changed my name to Urmila Devi, for all purposes.

0040864448-4

It is for general information that I, AKASH CHAUHAN, S/O PUSHPENDRA SINGH, R/O FLAT NO-104, 3RD FLOOR, BLOCK-C, POCKET-8, SECTOR-5, NEAR MOTHER DAIRY PRIDE SCHOOL, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, declare that name of my minor son has been wrongly written as SHIVANSH LAKDA (aged-3- years) in my Service Record. The actual name of my minor son is SHIVANSH LAKRA respectively, which may be amended accordingly.

0040864318-1

I,Manoj Kumar S/O Ramesh Pasrija R/O-120, S.F.Pocket D-16,Sector-3, Rohini, North-West Delhi-110085, Have Changed My Name To Manoj Pasrija For All Purposes.

0040864408-11

I, DIVYA AGGARWAL W/o Kapil Gupta, RZ-770/2, Gali No-14, Sadh Nagay, Palam Colony, Delhi-45, have changed my name to DIVYA GUPTA.

0071046071-1

I,Vijaylaxmi W/o Manish Ahuja R/o Flat No-73, Surya Kiran Apartment, Vikasपुरi, New Delhi-110018,have changed my-name to Vijay Laxmi.

0040864435-11

I SEVAK RAM TYAGI S/O SUNDAR R/O TALEHAITA, POST-TALHATA, GHAZIABAD U.P.-201201 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SEWAK RAM FOR ALL THE FUTURE PURPOSE.

0071046077-1

I,ARVEEN KAUR,D/O GURWANT SINGH,R/O 1526A HOUSING BOARD COLONY SECTOR-29,FARIDABAD-121008 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME ARVEEN KAUR ANAND.

0040864408-2

I, Anash S/O Mohd Zavvar, R/o House Number-310 D, Pocket-E, LIG Flats, Near GTB Hospital, GTB Enclave, Mandoli, Saboli, North East, Delhi-10093 have changed my name to Mohd. Anash for all future Purposes

0071045993-1

I,Shyam Sundar Bochiwal,S/o-Bajarang Lal,R/o-A-7/5,Block-A,Krishna-Nagar Delhi-51,have changed my name,from Shyam Sundar Bochiwal to Shyam Sharma for all future purposes.

0040864409-9

I, DEEPAK S/O VIKRAM TANWAR, B-147A, Shyam Vihar Ph-1, Najafgarh, Dindar Pur, Delhi-43 have changed my name to DEEPAK TANWAR.

0071046085-1

I,Nutan Prabhat S/O, Sohan Lal Rohella R/O C 102, Unique Apartments, Plot 38, Sector 6, Dwarka, New Delhi 110075 have changed my name to Nutan Prabhat Rohella.

0040864312-1

I,BINDIYA SINGAL W/o- SANJAY SINGAL R/o- House Number-54,New Anaj Mandi Hsar,Haryana-125001,Have Changed My Name BINDIA SINGAL,For All Purpose.

0040864435-4

I,Priti Sharma,w/o Bharat Sharma,Add D17A,2nd floor east Jyoti-nagar,east Delhi-110093,have Changed my Name to Preeti Sharma,for all purposes

0040864448-6

I,SURENDRA AGARWAL S/O SUDHIR AGARWAL R/O A1-267 4TH FLOOR SUSHANT LOK PHASE 2 SECTOR 55 GHATA PO GURGAON SECTOR 45 GURGAON HARYANA 122003 have changed my name SURENDRA KUMAR AGRWAL for all future purpose

0071046096-1

I,Susham Lata alias Sushma Luthra,W/o Rakesh Kumar Luthra,R/o-A-62,SF, West Patel- Nagar Delhi-8,have changed my name to Sushma Lata Luthra

0040864409-2

I,RAYEES AHMED,S/O SYED SIDDIQ ALI,H.NO.1965, NALANDA-POCKET NEAR NALANDA SCHOOL SECTOR-8 FARIDABAD SECTOR-7,HARYANA-121006,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SYED RAYEES AHMED

0040864409-12

I, ERA W/O PRADEEP RANA R/O HOUSE NO-153, 1ST FLOOR, SHAHBAD DAULATPUR, DELHI-110042, have changed my name to ERA RANA for all future purposes.

0071046046-1

I,Javed S/o Mohammad Dilshad R/o:- F-55, Sector-3, Phase-3, Dwarkd, Delhi-110078, have changed my name to Javed Ansari.

0040864435-13

I, SONIA GUPTA W/o Pardeep Jain, F-115, 82, Mahaveer Enclave-3, DK Mohan Garden, Delhi-59, have changed my name to SONIA JAIN.

0071046083-1

I,MANJARI SHARMA,D/O VISHWANATH CHOUDHARY, H.NO-15A/9 INDERDHANUSH,APARTMENT-GROUND,FLOOR KISHAN -GARH VASANT KUNJ,NEW DELHI-110070,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MANJARI MAGAN SHARMA.

0040864408-4

I,Karan S/o Ashwani Dhingra R/o Plot No-31, Neeti khand-1, Indrapuram Ghaziabad U.P.-201014 have Changed my name from Karan to Karan Dhingra. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Karan Dhinrga for all future Purposes.

0071045995-1

Jitinder singh R/o 101f/5 gali no. 4 krishna nagar N. D. 110029 changed my name as Jitender singh

0130066498-1

I, ATHER IQBAL S/O IQBAL AHMED R/O 1108 PUNJABI PHATAK HAVELI HISSAMUDDIN HAIDER BALLIMARAN DELHI 110006, have changed my name to ATHAR IQBAL Permanently.

0071046005-1

I,Neetu Khatana D/o Paramjeet W/o Suresh Kumar R/o-House No.18, Gali No.06,Sheetla Colony,Gurgaum (Haryana)-122001,have changed my name to Neetu.

0040864435-6

I, Anurag Gupta, S/o Mr. Om Prakash Gupta, R/o TF-2, 602, Sector-3, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201012, have changed my name from Anurag to Anurag Gupta. Both names refer to the same person. I shall hereafter be known as Anurag Gupta for all future purposes, including my Passport and all other Government documents.

0040864344-1

I, Subrata Roychowdhury, Date of Birth- 18/09/1966, S/o Sudhankar Roychowdhury, R/o 1A, Solok Pally, P.O.-Haltu, P.S.-Garfa, Kolkata-700078, West Bengal, inform that my father's name wrongly recorded as Sudhankar Roychowdhury in my Madhyamik Pass Certificate/documents. My father actual name is Sudhankur Roychowdhury, which has been rightly recorded in my Aadhaar Card, PAN Card, Madhyamik Admit Card and more relevant documents, which may be amended accordingly. Sudhankur Roychowdhury and Sudhankar Roychowdhury are one and the same person i.e. my father.

0040864451-1

I,Nazma W/o Naushad Siddiqui R/O S-78 Gali no-23, Brhamपुरi Garhi Mendu, Delhi-110053, informed that My name and My Husband name and MY DOB has been wrongly written as Nazima W/o Noushad Ali and DOB-11/11/1969, the correct name of mine and my husband and DOB is- Nazma W/o Naushad Siddiqui -16/8/1969 Respectively.

0040863711-2

I, Kuldeep Singh S/O Late Tirath Singh Alag R/O 353, Gali no 2, Saraswati Bhandar, Gandhi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi 110031, have changed my name from Kuldeep Singh to Kuldeep Singh Alag. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Kuldeep Singh Alag for all future purposes.

0040864416-2

I,SUMMAIYA AFTAB W/o Zameer Ahmad and D/o Aftab Alam Ansari solemnly declare and affirm that my Father's correct name is AFTAB ALAM ANSARI. In my previous passport it was erroneously printed as Aftab Alam. Both name refer to one and the same person. This must be sworn before a notary public. Address: 514/3 Gali No 3,Sangam Vihar Wazirabad, DELHI 110084.

0071045997-1

I, VIPUL DEV RATHORE S/o ROOP KISHORE, R/O HOUSE NO-3530, GALI KALAL KHANNA, OLD SUBJI MANDI, MALKA GANJ, DELHI-110007, have changed my name to VIPUL DEV for all future purposes.

0071046053-1

I,Anil S/o Billa Ram R/o House No-80/35 Rajendra Malka Ganj Delhi -110007 have changed my name to Anil Kumar

0040864448-1

I, Shailesh Kumar Giri S/o Arun Kumar Giri R/o- 1005, PBEL City, Near TGPA, Peeramcheru, VTC: Rajendranagar, PO: Dan Bosco Nagar, District: K.V Rangreddy, Telangana-500086, have changed my minor son's name from Sanskar Aged 14 Years to Sanskar Anand Giri forever

0071046086-1

I,AFSHAN w/o AZIM r/o D-401,Gali no 7,Near-Bengali Hotel,Shaheed Nagar, Sahibabd Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201006,has changed my name to AFSHA, permanently.

0040864408-6

I, SHAMSHAD KHAN S/O MOHD SARDAR R/O 2043 GALI QASIM JAN AHATA KALE SAHAB BALLIMARAN CHANDNI CHOWK DELHI 110006, have changed my name to MOHD SHAMSHAD Permanently.

0071046002-1

I, hitherto known as ANKITA JAINARAYAN TIWARI W/o PAWAN KISHORE R/O House. No. 158, Shiba Nagar Colony, Phase-1, Ramna, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh - 221011, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ANKITA TIWARI.

0071046010-1

ILALIT BHAGAT S/O JAGDISH CHANDER R/O HNO.407 BLOCK-AG EAST SHALIMAR BAGH DELHI-110088.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO LALIT KUMAR.

0040864409-4

I,Kunal S/o Sunil Kumar R/o H.No.-62,Lala Ki Dhani, Rampura,Gurgaon (Haryana)-122004, have changed my name to Kunal Yadav.

0040864403-8

I, Anubhav Pandey S/o Subhash Chandra Pandey R/o Sc 02 / A1 Tower T2 -1704Eureka Park Gautam Budh Nagar, Noida Up-201310, have changed the name of myminor daughter Inaaya Pandey to Shridha Pandey aged 2 years.

0071046121-1

I,SUMAN SAINI W/o Nareesh Kumar Saini,R/o H.No.433 Bank Wali Gali Jonti Delhi-110081, have changed my name to SUMAN RANI

0040864409-6

I IDRIS S/O -Medkhan Address- Alipur tigma (80) mewat Haryana 122104, have changed my name to IDRISH

0040864435-1

I, Sanjay Goyal, Sanjay Kumar Goyal, Sanjay Goel, Sanjay Kumar Goel S/o-Late Mahavir Prasad R/o-D-645, Third Floor,Saraswati Vihar, Pitampura,New Delhi-110034 have changed my name to Sanjay Kumar for all purposes.

0040864328-1

I,Jeet Singh,S/o-Nain Singh Chauhan, R/o House.No.-330A,Chauhan Mohalla, Madanpur Khadar, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi-110076, have changed my name to Jeet Singh Chauhan, for all purposes.

0040864448-3

I,ZAINAB,D/O FARUKH,R/O-H.NO.B-145,GALI-NO.2,INDIRA VIHAR,GOKAL PUR,DELHI-110094,I inform that my father and mother name is wrongly-written Farooq,and mother shiri in my-10 class marksheet,but correct name my father farukh,and mother name is Sheeri

0040864390-1

I, Nitin Maheshwari alias Neha Maheshwari D/o Vinod Kumar Maheshwari W/o NitinMaheshwari, R/o A-25 Second Floor Gali No-3 Near Vijay Block Gaur Nanakpura Laxmi Nagar, Delhi - 110092, have changed my name to Neha Maheshwari.

0071046136-1

I,Rameshwari, W/o Late Soban Singh Negi, residing at 95-B, Platinum Enclave, Pocket-I, Sector-18, Rohini, Delhi-110089, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Rameshwari Negi for all future purposes, vide affidavit dated 02.07.2026 sworn before Notary Rajkumar, Delhi.

0130066499-1

I,Daljeet Kaur W/o Gurmeet Singh Panesar R/o,Ground-Floor, A-206 (Old-NO-WZ-33/7), Sudershan-Park Extn., New Delhi-110015,have changed my-name to Daljeet Kaur Panesar.

0040864435-10

I,REETU GOEL W/o Dinesh Gupta, RZ-770-A/3, UGF, B/S, Gali No-14/1, Sadh Nagar, Palam Colony, Delhi-45, have changed my name to REETU GUPTA.

0071046076-1

I,CHAND BIBI W/O ABDUL SALAM R/O GALI.NO.4 EKTA VIHAR JAIPUR-EXTN JAIPUR BADARPUR,NEW DELHI-110044 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME CHAND BEEBEE.

0040864408-1

I,Rizwan S/o Babu Khan R/o E-2nd/2, JJ Colony Madangir, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, Pushpa Bhawan, South Delhi, Delhi-110062, have changed my name to Rizwan Khan for all future Purposes.

0071045992-1

I, Jasmeet Singh S/O Kuldeep Singh Alag R/O B6-1404, Cleo County, Sector 121, Gautam budh nagar, Up 201301, have changed my name from Jasmeet Singh to Jasmeet Singh Alag. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Jasmeet Singh Alag for all future purposes.

0040864416-1

I,hitherto known as Kamlesh alias Kamlesh Kumari,W/o-Rajesh Yadav R/O-501/5,Nai-Basti,Kishan-Ganj,Delhi-110007,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kamlesh Yadav.

0040864409-8

I,LUBNA,W/O SHEHRAZ ALAM,R/O 6923,CHOWK KUANA,BERI WALA BAGH, NEAR AZAD MARKET,DELHI-110006,have changed my name to LUBNA SADAF,for all,future Purposes.

0040864448-5

I,MALKA E ALIYA ABDALI,W/o-KHALEEQUE AHMAD,R/O- House Number-C-49,Rishi Kardam Marg,Chauhan Banger Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name MALKA E AALIYA ABDALI,For All Purpose.

0040864435-3

I, Bhushan Mishra S/o Dipak Prashad Mishra R/o 185, Jail Road, Badena, Bathena, Ward No.-06, Dhamtari, Chhattisgarh-493773, have changed my minor son's name from Lingraj Mishra aged 3 years to Vinayak Mishra forever

0071046091-1

I,Rakesh Kumar S/o Mulak Raj R/O A-62, SF,West Patel Nagar Delhi-8 have changed my name to Rakesh kumar Luthra

0040864409-1

I Swaleha D/O, Tayyab Sohail Siddiqui R/o House No -78, Second Floor,c/12 Block, Yamuna Vihar, North East Delhi have changed my name to Swaleha Siddiqui.

0040864311-1

I,ASHOK GOEL S/O Ghanshyam Dass Goyal R/o-C-1/20 C-Block Model Town-III Delhi-110009, have changed my name to ASHOK KUMAR GOYAL

0040864409-10

I, Samte Dongkhanthang S/O Late Samte Goukthong, residing at Ngulzen Vang, Tuibuang, Churachandpur, Manipur-795128 have changed my name to S Dong Khan Thang vide affidavit dated 29/05/2026 at Churachandpur.

0050292672-1

I,Anju W/o Sanjay R/o 18/308, Kalyanpuri, East Delhi, Delhi-110091, have changed my name to Anju Kumari.

0040864435-12

I, Saundrey Singh S/o P S Tarunnee R/o B Block, Shankar Garden, Vikasपुरi, Tilak Nagar, S.O West Delhi, Delhi-110018, have changed my minor son's name from Aarav Singh Aged 06 Years to Aarav Singh forever

0071046082-1

I,RAJIV RANJAN KUMAR,S/O-MAHAVIR BHAKTA, ADDRESS- PLOT OLD.NO.31,(NEW NO-B-24/1),FIRST FLOOR,FLAT.NO-1, KHASRA NO-828,PANCHAR WALI GALI,CHATTAR-PUR VILLAGE,SOUTH DELHI-110074, have changed my name to RAJEEV RANJAN KUMAR.

0040864408-3

I Seema W/o Ashwani Dhingra R/o Plat No.31, Neeti Khand-1, Indrapuram Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014 have changed my name from Seema to Rama Dhingra. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Rama Dhingra for all future Purposes.

0071045994-1

I, Deepak Kumar S/o Harish Chand R/o 2668 Shadipur, Delhi-110008, That in my CBSE 10th and 12th marksheet my parents' name have been incorrectly recorded as Hari Chander and Binni Devi instead of Harish Chand and Binni. Please correct it.

0040864319-1

I,Niraj Singla,S/o Chitter Kumar Aggarwal,R/o House No.84,Sector 15 Part 1,Gurgaon,Haryana 122001 have changed my name to Neeraj Singla.

0040864435-5

I,DEEPA SETHI,D/o-NARAYAN DASS R/O- FLAT NO.-A-1-902, SAMRIDHI APPARTMENT, SECTOR-18B, DWARKA, DELHI-110075 have changed my name to DEEPA

0040864448-7

LOST & FOUND

I,Jyoti Kumar Verma S/O Lt Sh.Vasdev R/O C-37, Tent Peera Garhi Relief Camp My Mother's (Janak Dulari) Document- Punjab Ration Card Surrender Slip original has been lost at Delhi High Court An online FIR to this effect has 27/06/2026 vide LR No.399333/2026

0040864013-1

I, Inderjeet Singh Narang, S/o Mohinder Singh Narang, R/o A2/B-134C, 2nd Floor, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063, have lost my property documents belonging to my home, issued to me by DDA bearing File No. F16(460)82/G/MIG in a fire accident on 13.06.2024.

0040864333-1

Ajay Elangovan s/o GND Elangovan J4/40, Flat No.A-12, Khirki Extension, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017. I have lost my sale deed registered document 2953/2011 & 2954/2011, Plot no.-37&38, Kalangani Village, Sub Registrar office

0040864310-1

LOST-Original Omaxe Builder-Buyer Agreement,dated-28.01.2016 of,Flat-No.603, Tower-4,Shubhangan,Sector-4A,Bahadurgarh, belonging to Rajeev Chhabra.Finder kindly contact-9868954083-or-deposit it at-Omaxe Limited,7-Local Shopping Centre,Kalkaji,New Delhi.Phone:011-41896680-85.

0040864435-14

I,BHAWNA VERMA,W/o Amit Dhalla,R/o Upper Ground floor,DDA site No-1, New-Rajinder-Nagar,Delhi-110060,have changed my name to BHAWNA DHALLA for all future purposes.

0040864409-3

I, Samsa Begum W/o Mohammad Khursid Ahmad, RZ-2056-A, SF, Gali No-26, Tughlakabad Extension, Delhi-19 have changed my name to Shamsha Begum.

0071046106-1

I, Meera Rani Goyal, Anju Goyal W/o-Sh.Sanjay Kumar R/o-D-645, Third Floor, Saraswati Vihar, Pitampura,New Delhi-110034 have changed my name to Meera Rani for all purposes.

0040864329-1

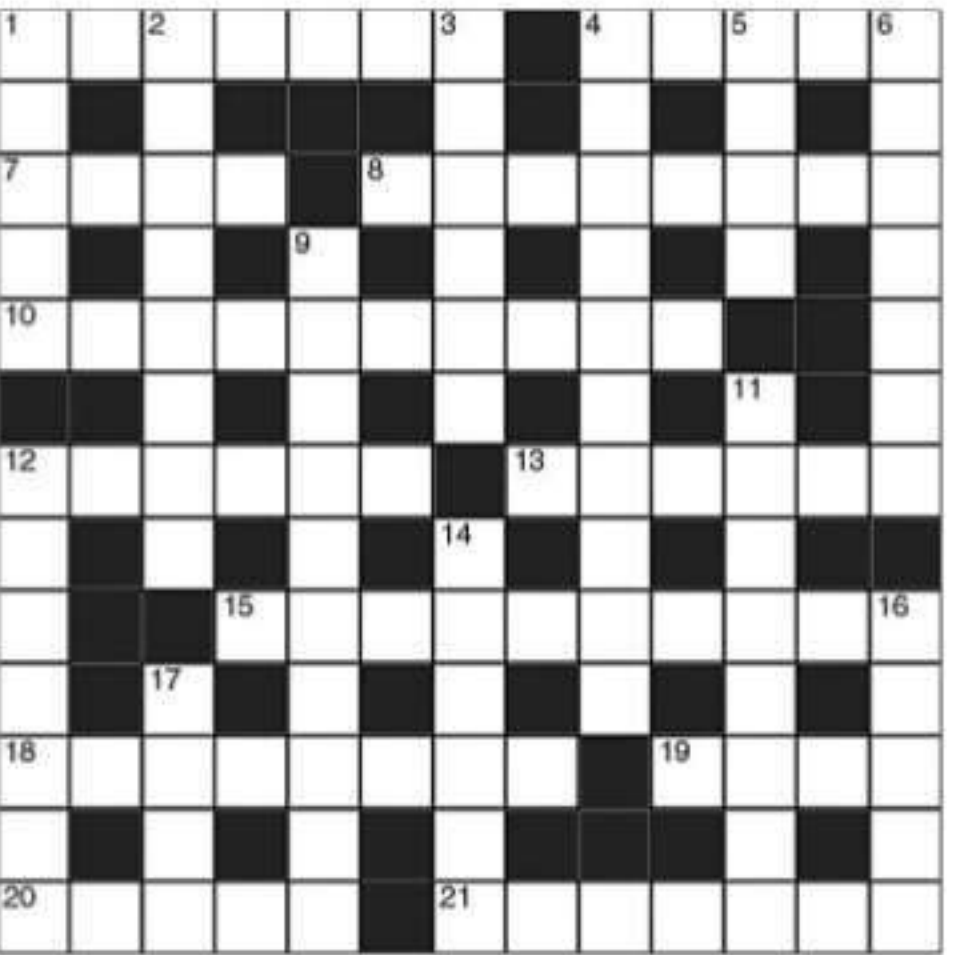
I, Aniruddha (Aniruddh) Singh Chauhan S/o Dalvir Singh Chauhan, R/O D-223, beta-2, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar, have changed my name to Anirudh Singh Chauhan For all future purposes.

0071046048-1

I, MOHAMMAD SHAKIL, s/o- MOHAMMAD SALIM,r/o

CROSSWORD

6034



ACROSS
1 Antique instrument put in fire contrary to expectation (7)
4 Came upon an empty pool (5)
7 A sign of sci-fi hero's return? (4)
8 Girl compelled to take a job (8)
10 Good story about a man can be forgiven (10)
12 Jokes in crackers (6)
13 Going to the front place of duty for nurse (6)
15 A capital asset in the main fight (10)
18 Not a favourite team in tour that's arranged (8)
19 Grass border parking (4)
20 A weapon attached to a rifle perhaps (5)
21 Yet it's a misplaced feeling of gratification (7)

DOWN
1 Ship goes down as waters rise (5)
2 Get over unkind act that's plain to see (5-3)
3 Rita excited when obtaining capital jewellery (6)
4 Priceless weapons employed by various people (10)
5 A film group, or what is taken as one (4)
6 Stubborn fellow? I'd heard otherwise (7)
9 Patient for carrying (10)
11 Fabric produced only when money's shown first (8)
12 They want a hand (7)
14 Capital A followed by S? (6)
16 A growing source of opium (5)
17 A case of pins and needles (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6033 ACROSS: 1 Full of grace, 9 Iron age, 10 Peach, 11 Lots, 12 Stranger, 14 Around, 16 Bear on, 18 Teetotal, 19 Edit, 22 Leave, 23 Heretic, 24 Restoration **DOWN:** U-boat, 3 Loam, 4 Fiesta, 5 Repeater, 6 Charger, 7 William Tell, 8 Short notice, 13 Indolent, 15 Overawe, 17 Rasher, 20 Ditto, 21 Writ

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The cost of ___ is going up and the chance of ___ is going down - Flip Wilson (6,...6) (same word twice)

CMMII

KLOLN

ADEGJG

EILTVV

down - Flip Wilson

ANSWER: The cost of living is going up and the chance of living is going down - Flip Wilson

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6372

			9			8	6
5	7		2		3		
2			1	4		7	
7	8			1	5		2
	9		5		6		3
1		5	9				4
	2		1	4			9
		3			7		6
8	4			5			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6371

4	2	5	7	1	8	6	3	9
7	8	1	6	9	3	4	2	5
6	9	3	2	4	5	8	7	1
8	4	2	3	6	1	5	9	7
5	7	6	4	2	9	3	1	8
3	1	9	8	5	7	2	4	6
2	5	7	9	8	4	1	6	3
1	3	4	5	7	6	9	8	2
9	6	8	1	3	2	7	5	4

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Today the Moon in your sign is lined up with stern Saturn, which can make you feel isolated from others. Domestic problems might surface. Possibly, you might feel cut off from your emotions today. This is fleeting. Tonight: You're strong.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Don't worry if you feel a bit lonely, or misunderstood today. This is a passing feeling that arises because the Moon is briefly aligned with Saturn in a hidden part of your chart. Fortunately, your energy to communicate is still strong. Tonight: Privacy.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Relations with a friend or a member of a group might be a bit stiff or cool today. Don't react to this. Let things pass. For about half of this day, feelings are a bit uptight while the Moon passes over Saturn. Tonight: Friendships.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is not an ideal day to ask for permission or approval from a parent, boss or anyone in a position of authority. Timing is everything, wait until tomorrow. In the meantime, be respectful and give some people a wide berth. Tonight: You're noticed.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is an excellent day to study and apply your mind to any kind of discipline where you want to learn or explore new ideas. You will be serious, persevering and mentally disciplined. Tonight: Explore.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a poor day for financial discussions, especially about shared property, taxes, debt and inheritances. People are a bit stingy and also reluctant to make a commitment. Let things pass and resume this discussion tomorrow. Tonight: Check your finances.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today has its challenges as the Moon is opposite your sign, which means that you have to go more than halfway when dealing with others. Time to send out for dark chocolate. Tonight: Cooperate.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Keep your head down and power through today, especially with your work. There might be challenges. Don't let anyone else drain your energy or discourage you. Tonight: Work.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Romantic relationships might be strained today. Likewise, you might feel you have increased responsibilities with children or that your relations with children are more challenging. Cut everyone some slack. Tonight: Socialise.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Remember to get more sleep. Today, be patient with family members, especially parents and older relatives, because people are in a grumpy mood. This is temporary. Tonight: Take it easy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is one of those days when it's easy to feel that your cup is half-empty instead of half-full. It's all a matter of perspective. Relations with authority figures, parents and bosses are less friendly. It's not you — it's happening everywhere. Tonight: Conversations.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today you might feel broke. (Welcome to the club. We number in the millions.) Entertaining diversions, sports events and issues related to kids or even a romantic partner might put a strain on your pocketbook. Fortunately, you're heading into a great year to improve your job. Tonight: Check your belongings.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
1	77269051 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS FOR 1 IN 12, 60KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.65 TO 83) DRG. NO. T-4218	200 SET	27.07.26
2	77269052 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS FOR 1 IN 12, 60 KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.66 TO 69) DRG. NO. T-4218	500 SET	31.07.26
3	19262711	ROLLER BEARING RB 5020	519 NOS	31.07.26
4	19260703	SET OF LOCK NUT F.S. ALL STEEL	200 SET	03.08.26
5	19260602	AXLE BOX BEARING	339 SET	03.08.26
6	77269053 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS 1 8.5, 60KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.41 TO 54) TO RDSO DRG. T-4865	100 SET	03.08.26
7	08265165	6 QUAD CABLE 1.4MM	47 KM	04.08.26
8	16264269	SPIN-ON FUEL FILTER,	2007 NOS	06.08.26
9	04250057B	TRANSFORMER OIL FOR THREE PHASE	32813 LTR	10.08.26

Note: 1). Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 24/2026-2027 Dated: 06/07/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2311/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mukesh Kumar** S/o Chinku R/o Village-Pihayumanihari, PS- Kundli, Sonipat, Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 540/2018 u/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mukesh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mukesh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mukesh Kumar** accused of FIR No. 540/2018 u/s 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **13.08.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Komal Garg**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (West)
Room No. 292,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9158/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused (1) **Afjal @Kalad** S/o Sh. Aslam R/o H. No. 313/11, Ground Floor, near Govt. School, Tulsi Nagar also at Jhuggi No. 8/5, Tulsi Nagar, Delhi (2) **Hassan @Hassin** S/o Mohd. Manjur R/o Jhuggi No. 362, Rakhi Market, Zakhira, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 62/2026 U/s 309(6)/311/49/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Keshavpuram, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused (1) **Afjal @Kalad**, (2) **Hassan @Hassin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Afjal @Kalad**, (2) **Hassan @Hassin** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Afjal @Kalad**, (2) **Hassan @Hassin** in FIR No. 62/2026 U/s 309(6)/311/49/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Keshavpuram, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (North-West)
Room No. 112
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/8935/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Vikash Yadav** R/o Premises RHS to Pole No.6, 3rd Floor, Village Pochanpur, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CT Case No. 596/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act at PS: Nazafgarh, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vikash Yadav** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vikash Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vikash Yadav** of CT Case No. 596/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity Act of PS: Nazafgarh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.08.2026**.

By order
Harleen Singh
Addl. Session Judge
Special Court Electricity
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/8041/DW/2026

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Engineer (Co)/ S.E.C.R. Nagpur invites E-tender for execution of following works:-

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Tender Notice No.	Approx. Tender Value in (₹)	Earnest Money/ Bid Security in (₹)
1.	Execution of Civil [C/16/NAG/2026-2027	1,62,50,000/-	3,25,000/-	
2.	Execution of Civil [C/17/NAG/2026-2027	1,75,00,000/-	3,50,000/-	
3.	Supply and fixing of [C/18/NAG/2026-2027	26,45,748/-	52,900/-	

For the above tenders the Bidders will be able to submit their original / revised bids up to **15.00 Hours on 24.07.2026** only. Manual offers are not allowed. Details are available on our website: www.ireps.gov.in.

PAM/17/33
Sr. Divl. Engineer (Central)/S.E.C.Railway/Nagpur

South East Central Railway @secrail

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vinay Kumar** S/o Matelu R/o Gali No. 7, C-Block, Sunday Bazar Road, Nathupura, Burari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 390/22 u/s 356/379/411 IPC at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vinay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vinay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinay Kumar** accused of FIR No. 390/22 u/s 356/379/411 IPC at P.S. Swaroop Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **12.08.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Sahil Gupta**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, (North)
Room No. 06, Ground Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9143/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Rukshad@Danish@Guddu@Bhondu@ Pahalwan** S/o Dilshad R/o Village Nekpur, Police Station Murad Nagar, District Ghaziabad, UP has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 46/26 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act PS: Crime Branch, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rukshad@Danish@Guddu@Bhondu@ Pahalwan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rukshad@Danish@Guddu@Bhondu@ Pahalwan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rukshad@Danish@Guddu@Bhondu@ Pahalwan** accused of FIR No. 46/26 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act PS: Crime Branch, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Mohit Sharma
CJM Room No. 59
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8906/Crime/2026
(Court Matter)

KARNATAKA POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

CIN: U85110KA1970SGC001919

No. KPCL/2026-27/IND2763 Dated: 06.07.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

(Through KPP Portal only)

Bids are invited in Two-Cover System for the "Supply of 3.6 lakh MT of Agro residue based non-torrefied biomass pellets for Raichur Thermal Power Station, Yeramarus Thermal Power Station & Bellary Thermal Power Station." The tender details can be downloaded from KPPP Procurement portal only i.e. <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> The last date and time for receipt of completed Bids in KPP Portal is **17:00 hours on 04.08.2026**. Further details can be had from: **THE CHIEF ENGINEER (MINES)**, Karnataka Power Corporation Limited, No. 82, Shakti Bhavan, III Floor, Race Course Road, Bengaluru – 560 001, Mobile No.: 9449598901, Phone number: 080-22203894, Facsimile number: 080-22203894, e-Mail-ID: semineskpc@gmail.com, website: www.karnatakapower.com,

Government of Odisha "e" Procurement Notice

WORKS DEPARTMENT

Bid Identification No. CCEKC-05/2026-27

e-mail : ccekeonjharpwdcircle@gmail.com/ sekepwd_keonjhar@yahoo.com

Letter No. 3390 dt. 24.06.2026

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Estimate No.
1.	Name of the work	2 number of Building Work
2.	Estimated cost	Rs. 308.69 Lakhs to Rs. 762.87 Lakhs
3.	Class of Contractor	"A" & "Special" Class
4.	Period of completion	09 (Nine) Calendar Months to 11 (Eleven) Calendar Months
5.	Date and Time of availability of Bid document in the portal	From 11.00 Hours of 09.07.2026 to 17.00 Hours of 24.07.2026
6.	Last date / Time for receipt of bids in the portal	17.00 Hours of 24.07.2026
7.	Date of opening of Bid from Portal	11.30 Hours on 27.07.2026
8.	Name and address of the officer inviting Bid	Chief Construction Engineer, Keonjhar (R&B) Circle, Keonjhar-758001.

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "<http://tendersodisha.gov.in>"

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Keonjhar (R&B) Circle, Keonjhar
OIPR-34001/34033/1/26-27/0009

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Amit, S/o Late Brahampal Singh and Sheela Devi W/o Late Brahampal Singh** Tomar Both R/o H.No.A-69, Gali No.10, Mangeram Park, Prahladpur Road, Near Pooth Kalan, Delhi-86 have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.116/2016 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC, P.S. Najafgarh, Delhi and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit and Sheela Devi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit and Sheela Devi** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Amit and Sheela Devi** of FIR No.116/2016 u/s 498A/406/34 IPC, P.S. Najafgarh, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class, Mahila Court No.3
South-West District, Room No. 312
District Court Dwarka, New Delhi

DP/9120/DW/2026

● RESULTS

ROUND OF 16

Brazil 1-2 Norway
New Jersey Stadium
Mexico 2-3 England
Mexico City Stadium

● MATCH SCHEDULE

ROUND OF 16

Argentina vs Egypt
Atlanta, 9.30 pm
(Tuesday)
Switzerland vs Colombia
Vancouver, 1.30 am
(Wednesday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



● Ancelotti to stay on as coach for Brazil's rebuild

BRAZILIAN FA (CBF) football director Rodrigo Caetano said Carlo Ancelotti would remain in charge through the 2030 World Cup cycle. For a country that measures football pain in four-year cycles, the finger-pointing began quickly. Much of it was aimed at Ancelotti, who had only one year to reshape a side who had drifted through three interim managers. But Caetano said that the Italian, who extended his contract until the 2030 World Cup, would not be cast overboard. "One of the main reasons we failed in this World Cup was not to have proper, stable guidance long term that would have prepared our national team the way it should for a World Cup and we cannot make the same mistake again." AP

Resignations pile up from Seoul to Riyadh

THE FALLOUT in Asian football continues as the continent comes to terms with an underwhelming World Cup. On Monday, Chung Mong-gyu stepped down as president of the Korea Football Association. His departure follows harsh criticism from the country's president and the resignation of coach Hong Myung-bo last week after South Korea's group-stage exit that culminated in a 1-0 loss to South Africa. "There were moments when I lived up to expectations and moments when I left you deeply disappointed," said Chung, who has held the role since 2013. The day after Hong stood down as South Korea's coach, Yasser Al-Mishehal quit as Saudi Arabia Football Federation president. AP

● DESTINY FALLS SHORT

Neymar's Brazil story ends with magic remembered and dreams unfulfilled

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 6

THE BARDS and poets must have been smiling. It was the ending they would have written themselves: a final act composed to perfection. Strip away context for a moment, and reflect on the final telling act of Brazil versus Norway. A penalty. Walking up was Neymar. Brazil's highest scorer, with more goals than Pele and more than Rivaldo and Ronaldinho combined. A goal would make him only the second Brazilian to score at four World Cups. And against him, Ørjan Nyland. Impregnable. He had denied Bruno Guimarães from the spot, and then the undeniable Vinicius Junior. Every Brazilian attack disappeared. Then came Neymar. Ostentatious gait. Snobbish

27 GOALS | EARLY EXIT

HAALAND has 27 goals in his last 14 competitive games for Norway

This is Brazil's earliest exit from a World Cup since 1990.



Erling Haaland got the better of Arsenal's Gabriel in the 79th minute to give Norway the lead and then ten minutes later followed it up with another goal . AP

FIVE-TIME WORLD CHAMPIONS KNOCKED OUT

Brazil's samba falls silent

Vikings ended their journey but years of neglect, not one loss, brought them here



Sandip G
New York, July 6

THE FRIGHTENED face of Bruno Guimarães when his penalty kick bounced off Norwegian goalkeeper Ørjan Nyland's palms; a crushed Endrick weeping on his knees inside the box; Gabriel Magalhães slumped in despair after Erling Haaland beat him in the air; manager Carlo Ancelotti staggering into the tunnel with wistful disbelief. The images will haunt Brazil—the country, the consciousness of its people, and the football team.

The wait for a World Cup has never been longer; their collective game in a World Cup has never looked as bereft of substance; their vacuum of talent has seldom looked as telling; their claim to be the stirring soul of the game has rarely looked as fallacious; the beats of the samba have rarely struck notes of dissonance. Brazil will still be the most successful footballing nation after the tournament. But the truth is unmistakable: they are living on nostalgia, slipping into a black hole from which they may never climb back to greatness. Brazil have lost before, and for much of this game they were the better side. But this defeat felt like more than a tactical collapse; it felt like the unravelling of football's most enchanting culture.

The round-of-16 exit is not so much a wake-up call as a slap

in the face for ignoring the red flags that have been popping up for the best part of this century—not merely a prognosis of the malaise that is gnawing at them into a slow death, but its full-blown manifestation.

Brazil lost not because Guimarães missed the penalty. He took it ahead of Vinicius Júnior, who seemed the automatic choice, because their research team had found that, among those on the field, he was the most prolific penalty-taker. A culture built on instinct increasingly leaning on science and data—inevitable in the modern age—is a striking contrast to the Brazil of old. Anybody can miss a penalty; even Ronaldo Nazário did at his peak. But to ignore their natural goalscorers, all in sharp nick, in a match of this significance would rankle Seleção fans.

Endrick deserves sympathy. At 19 and only two minutes into the game, his heavy touch betrayed a youngster desperate to seize his moment. But Brazilian stalwarts of a certain era seized such moments to become superstars. From Pelé and Garrincha to Ronaldo and Ronaldinho, they, for all their glowing virtues, were mentality monsters.

Arguably, the aptest metaphor for Brazil's fall is Gabriel lying prone inside his box, heartbroken. Not because he was horrific—he had a near-flawless day till the mistake that resulted in Erling Haaland's first goal—but because he was knackered by then. Brazil's shortage of centre-backs meant he and Marquinhos could afford little rest. The pair played every single minute of the tournament, masking the defensive fragilities of their full-backs, ad-



Neymar and Co. cannot contain their disappointment after their Round of 16 exit. AP

ding legs and miles for their ageing defensive midfielders.

This would hurt Brazilian football the most. The endless carousel of talent appeared to have stalled. The attackers kept popping up, but the stock of full-backs dried up; young defensive midfielders dwindled. Not too long ago, they were forced to leave prime Dani Alves on the bench because of Maicon; Fernandinho and Fabinho had to be content with bit-part appearances because Casemiro was at his all-action-hero peak. No matter how Ancelotti tried to fix the system, cracks remained like open wounds waiting to be rubbed with salt and oil. And he didn't have the time to groom fresh talent or pick an outrageous gem from the streets.

The chaotic administration didn't help; in the last ten years, they have had four presidents. In their most prosperous period of the modern era (1994 to 2006, when they were twice

● Number Plate

34%

● Brazil ended with 34% possession against Norway, their lowest ever on record in a World Cup match.

crowned champions), they had only one president, Ricardo Teixeira. Charges of corruption ended his tenure, but they didn't end the malpractices. The instability spilled over into the team management too. Since Tite resigned, Brazil have had four coaches in as many years, two permanent appointments and two interim ones. The federation aggressively pursued Ancelotti for the best part of the last three years, but it was only last year that they landed him. The timeframe was too short for him to produce a miracle. In the era of structured footballing

progress, miracles are out of vogue.

Resorting to the Italian was an admission of the collapse of their coaching system. Brazil may be the biggest exporter of footballing talent to Europe. But none of Europe's top five leagues has a Brazilian manager. Beyond brief spells by Vanderlei Luxemburgo, Ricardo Gomes and Leonardo, the list is remarkably thin. Argentina, by contrast, are overflowing with elite managers: Marcelo Bielsa, Diego Simeone, Mauricio Pochettino, Jorge Sampaoli, Tata Martino and Lionel Scaloni. One in every six teams at this World Cup had an Argentine manager.

None of these deep-rooted blemishes can be fixed in a day, or even a year. But it has to start soon to preserve the most vivid footballing culture in the world. Lest samba be lost forever; lest the game lose its most dazzling colour. And the heap of broken images pile on.

Haaland: The making of a poacher



Erling Haaland's mural in Bryne by Pöbel. EXPRESS PHOTO/AMIT KAMATH

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, July 6

ESPEN UNDHEIM has clung on to clips of a 10-year-old Erling Haaland playing football at his first club Bryne FK. The pre-teen facsimile of the present-day Haaland captured for posterity in these grainy video clips does not quite have the same signature hairdo that the Norway star rocks these days. Back then, he was tiny too — tinier than others in his age group — Undheim pointed out. But there's something that Haaland had at the age of 10 that he still possesses: his sense of timing and his positioning on the pitch.

Early on Monday, Haaland used these skills to evade Brazil defenders and stab two goals into the net, thus sending Norway to the quarter-finals of the FIFA World Cup. In doing so, Haaland also propelled himself upwards in the Golden Boot race, where he now co-habits the top spot with Lionel Messi and Kylian Mbappe.

"You can see the runs that he makes now. I have videos from when he was 10 and 11. You can see the same situation and the same run," Undheim had told *The Indian Express* in 2025.

Undheim was Haaland's first coach, having worked for 25 years at Norwegian football club Bryne FK. The boy arrived at the humble club in the south of Norway as an eight-year-old for an after-school football program for boys. At Bryne, not just Undheim, everyone else remembered Haaland, who currently towers at 6'5", as someone who was physically smaller than his teammates in that age group.

"Now he has power. Back then, he was not as strong or big. But he developed the ability to beat at the right place," said Sondre Norheim, who was Haaland's teammate at Bryne.

Being a stickler for positioning almost made Haaland aware of where his opponents were on the pitch. When Haaland was playing in his first game for Norway, as a 14-year-old playing for the U15 team, he scored a goal against Sweden from the kickoff because he noticed that the keeper was standing 12 metres out of his line.

Undheim narrated how Haaland used to be pushed around in training sessions by an older girl, who went to play as a defender for some of the biggest clubs, and a male player, who towered at 185cm. That's why being at the right place was something Haaland obsessed over even as a 10-year-old. What he lacked in brawn, he tried to make up for with brain.

"Even when he was nine years old, he would say, 'I have to start earlier. I have to be one metre to the left.' You don't see that normally in kids that age. He was always thinking, 'where



“Even when he was nine years old, he would say, 'I have to start earlier. I have to be one metre to the left.' You don't see that normally in kids that age. He was always thinking, 'where should I be now?'”

ESPEN UNDHEIM, ERLING HAALAND'S COACH AT HIS FIRST CLUB BRYNE FK.

should I be now?" Undheim collected of the boy he trained three days a week for four years.

That hunger made the young Haaland train more than others. Before the team met for training sessions, Haaland would train alone for an hour. Just dribbling and shooting. Haaland also hit the genetic lottery by being born to a footballer father and a mother who was Norwegian national heptathlon champion.

Under Undheim, Haaland sharpened his technical abilities. "He was not a good technical player. When he was a youth player, he couldn't use his right foot. Only the left worked: shooting with the left, receiving with the left," said Undheim, who played with Haaland's father Alf-Inge Haaland in their youth.

As he grew older, Haaland's height started to catch up with his peers. But he was still skinny, more bones than flesh. This changed when he moved to Norwegian club Molde at the age of 16. There, he had a height spurt, growing eight centimetres in his two years at Molde. He also put on weight and muscle, thanks to Molde's cook Torbjorg Haugen (fondly called Tante by the players) and Borre Steenslid, the club's fitness coach.

"He grew a lot in two years at Molde. He needed a lot of food. He would even ask to take food home. I gave it to him, because I saw that he needed it," Tante once told German outlet DW.

Haaland spent hours daily in the gym working with Steenslid, adding bulk to his other abilities honed at his first club. The things he picked up in that stint are still in his routine, which now includes consuming 6000 calories per day.

The final effect, as teams at the World Cup are finding out, is a behemoth in front of goal who refuses to be pushed around.

The smirk dissolved into tears. Inconsolable, Neymar would announce his retirement from the national team. That penalty amounted to nothing. A fleeting moment of irrelevant brilliance.



Neymar retired from international football after Brazil's loss. AP

lands. Dunga lost his job, and his successor, Mano Menezes, had to save his job by selecting Neymar. The protests were vindicated within 28 minutes: a debut goal against the USA. Six weeks later, he was gone. Dropped for indiscipline after berating Santos manager Dorival Júnior.

On occasions, he wasn't refused; he was flawless. In the 2010 San-São derby, he unveiled the paradinha, freezing Rogério Ceni before calmly scoring. "Why don't you hit it normally?" a journalist asked. The reply: "You don't stand out by just doing the normal things."

2013. Brazil marched for two causes: against corruption on the streets and behind Neymar in the stadiums. Then came the Confederations Cup. Only a trophy could alleviate the nation's troubles — be it psychologically. If they didn't, a disaster was waiting, warned the current

president, Lula. Brazil won. Neymar was irresistible: four goals, two assists, and the Golden Ball. A year after the triumph, Neymar would exit the World Cup in tears. Quarter-final against Colombia. A knee to the back fractured his vertebrae. A few inches to either side, and he would have had to be dependent on a wheelchair forever.

"My destiny was taken away from me, but I will come back stronger," he said. The Confederations Cup was his first senior trophy for Brazil. It would also be his last. Neymar arrived in Russia in 2018 with a fractured metatarsal barely healed, and still left with four goal contributions. At Qatar in 2022, he had an ankle injury, but still waltzed past a sea of bodies clad in chequered red and white.

By 2026, time had become the opponent. An ACL rupture, hamstring and calf injuries restricted Neymar to barely three-and-a-half matches for Brazil between the previous World Cup and the current one. Yet, in the final act of his international career, he still found the net. Perhaps there is an alternate timeline. One where Juan Camilo Zúñiga's knee never crashes into his back in Fortaleza. One where Thibaut Courtois doesn't produce the save of the tournament in Kazan. One where Croatia never find their equaliser in Al Rayyan. One where Erling Braut Haaland doesn't leap in East Rutherford.

In that timeline, Neymar retires draped in medals. In this one, he leaves behind something far less tangible. The elasticos. The rainbow flicks. The mohawks. The showboating. But not a World Cup. Destiny's least favourite child bows out.

Henderson falls after victory; injures his wrist



Jordan Henderson during a warm-up session. AP

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 6

A SERIOUS wrist injury suffered during England's post-victory celebrations has reportedly ruled Jordan Henderson out of the World Cup. The experienced Brentford midfielder, who fell over an advertising board after the Three Lions beat Mexico 3-2 at the Azteca, left the pitch on a stretcher and will need surgery on his wrist, according to the BBC. He landed awkwardly when he slipped while climbing over a barrier, and video footage showed his forearm buckling. Henderson stayed back in Mexico City with an England staff member while the rest of the squad flew back to the team's training base in Kansas City, Missouri. He had been booked during the scrappy game over a scuffle on the sidelines.

His only appearance in the tournament came as an 84th-minute substitute against Panama. The 36-year-old former Liverpool captain was an unused substitute against Mexico, but is among the squad's most respected figures, providing leadership, experience and a calming influence. England's Football Association has not said anything officially about Henderson's participation in the rest of the tournament. Thomas Tuchel's men will next face Norway in the quarter-finals at the Miami Stadium on July 12.

Aguirre bids farewell, backs Marquez to coach Mexico

JAVIER AGUIRRE backed Rafa Marquez to lead Mexico into the future after the co-hosts' World Cup run ended with a 3-2 defeat by England on Sunday, bringing the curtain down on Aguirre's third spell in charge. Aguirre, who had already made clear he would leave his role after the tournament, said former Mexico captain Marquez was ready to continue the work done with a squad that restored belief during the country's deepest World Cup run in 40 years.

"I would have liked to say goodbye to my people with a victory. That hurts," Aguirre told reporters. "We tried." He added, "The players need to leave with their heads held high. Today it could not be. We failed to capitalise, but I want to thank them all."

REUTERS

Bellingham brace, a red card, two penalties with Mexican waves made it a World Cup classic

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, July 6

BREATHLESSNESS WAS promised after all. The famed heights of the Azteca – the iconic stadium that immortalised itself as the custodian to two World Cup finals – delivered on what could possibly be its last ever World Cup game. That England, packing their suitcases with decades worth of held grievances earned on this very grass, were allowed to escape the 80,000 plus crowd with a laboured 3-2 victory, would have to be their version of the footballing gods balancing their weighing scales.

That Mexico would come out swinging, much like the sluggers thronging dilapidated gyms in the city, was a given. All the armchair experts on altitude proclaimed that the English needed to sit back and survive the first quarter. The Mexicans would be fierce at the start and the crowd knew that they had a part to play.

Jordan Pickford saw all of it unfolding before his eyes. The first real chance that Mexico had – a header from the country's second-highest goalscorer. Raul Jimenez contorted himself in the air and struck a powerful attempt downwards from close range. The ball, travelling into the English bottom post, was met by the palm of Pickford – who has a penchant for casting a wide shadow, come a knockout game. The first quarter came and went and the English started to breathe a little bit more.

At its bones, this England squad has two totem poles in Harry Kane and Jude Bellingham. The responsibility of how

ENGLAND KNOCK OUT CO-HOSTS MEXICO
Escape from Azteca



England players battled against a ferocious Mexico in front of a raucous home crowd at the Azteca. AP

far their tournament goes, often falls on Kane's shoulders. But at a venue where Pele and Maradona have lifted World Cups, it was Jude Bellingham that embodied the spirit of

what one must be, to earn the respect of the Azteca.

Bukayo Saka, getting a start under Thomas Tuchel, put in a looping cross from 6 yards with his right. Kane, always England's target man, took two defenders with him and sold a dummy. And Bellingham just a little further down the line, was late yet clinical, as he dived in to score the opener with a header in the 36th minute.

He wasn't done. Kane played a decoy for the first goal and then a minute later, turned provider. This time it was a drive through

the Mexican backline that Bellingham latched onto. Big game Bellingham showed up and it seemed like England had found their bearings. How wrong was that notion. With just ten minutes left in the first half, Mexico raised hell.

The Mexican waves on the stands were nothing compared to the ones on the pitch. One offensive move after another pummelling in, all looking for the goal that would bring them back into the match. Bellingham, who had scored twice and may have believed that this was done and dusted, had to pull out a last-gasp challenge to keep the scoreline 2-0. And then the Azteca threw its first hook at the English.

Julian Quinones has lit up the Saudi Pro League with his goal-a-game exploits. The left-sided attacker has been Mexico's angled foil to Jimenez's in-your-face directness.

In the 42nd minute, he



“They scored three goals from four or five shots, while we had 18 shots, six or seven on target, but that counts for nothing. We lost.”

JAVIER AGUIRRE, MEXICO COACH

Egypt & Salah eye weakened Argentina in R16 clash

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, July 6

A LARGE period of Mohamed Salah's life has been spent in Lionel Messi's shadow. The Egyptian was a prodigy and started to play senior football at a time when the Argentine was at the peak of his powers. The comparisons that followed were inevitable. Many remember the 'Egyptian Messi' for his nine successful years at Liverpool.

Most forget the journeyman he was before reaching Merseyside: There was FC Basel, Chelsea, Fiorentina and AS Roma – five years and four clubs, painful rejections across Europe before the love story with Liverpool developed.

Now, both 'Mo' and Messi meet in the World Cup Round of 16 – the first time Egypt will face Argentina at the event. And while Argentina remain favour-

ites – Salah will never get a better chance to knock off the king.

It's fair to say that Cape Verde bit a sizable chunk out of Argentina before bowing out of the World Cup. The Argentines ran 140 kilometres in the stifling humidity of Miami, and were hanging by the thinnest of threads as the islanders refused to break.

Facundo Medina fell first to cramps, followed by Enzo Fernandes and then an ankle injury to Nicolas Gonzalez left the world champions teetering.

Messi ran over 10 kilometres, his first time breaching that mark at this World Cup. Head coach Lionel Scaloni's press fell apart as the players succumbed to the physicality of the moment. Argentina, purring smoothly until then, suddenly found multiple warning signs blinking all over the place. In Scaloni's words: 'It was a matter of defending like a cornered cat'.



Mo Salah will lead Egypt against defending champs. AP

One of the first thoughts the coach had after the match was the short recovery time his team would get before the clash against the Egyptians. Their suc-

cess in Qatar came on the back of young legs that were willing to run till the wheels came off. In Miami, Argentina's conditioning raised eyebrows.

One-man show

What will seriously worry Scaloni, though, is the lack of goals from players not named Messi. Seven goals out of the 11 that Argentina have scored have come from that expected source of genius, but the others are where the cracks start to appear. One strike from Giovanni Lo Celso, a left-footed goal by Lisandro Martinez, a penalty converted by Lautaro Martinez and an own goal by Diney aside, the other Argentines have not taken their chances.

The failures of Lautaro and Julian Alvarez, in particular, are holding Argentina back. Alvarez, who notched a single-season record with Atletico Madrid

scoring 29 goals, has looked a jaded version of himself. During Argentina's qualification for the World Cup, he had four goals and three assists, but in 200 minutes of World Cup football, the striker hasn't produced a goal, a goal involvement or an assist.

Amid this crisis in Argentina, Salah has the opportunity to cause another gargantuan upset at this World Cup. Testing Argentina's fading physicality is where the can of worms could open.

Salah today is a successful, elite attacker of his own making, scoring panenkas at a World Cup and beaming with the Pharaohs as they chart yet another successful African tale on football's great stage.

He has long moved away from the lazy comparisons with Messi. But a crack at the big man when Argentina are wobbling might never come again.



Erling Haaland led the rowing celebrations for Norway. AP

Norway's WC 2026 song: We are never going home

BEATING BRAZIL was the start of some iconic celebrations for Norway who have outdone themselves with their simple song of glee. It's a two-line remix ditty by the aptly titled Streaming artists Futuristic Hitz, though the original 'We are never going home' was a 2021 hit by Kungs or French tech house DJ Valentin Brunel. While Erling Braut Haaland led the Row Row Viking Row celebrations, taking on the drum beating to conduct the chant, it was the team cellys inside their New York dressing room that broke into a team song. It's really just one line said on repeat: "We are never going home whoa oh oh whoa" as they get into a circle and jump around belting it out at full decibel. The red drums aren't the only piece of nose-making they carry. The team also travels with a red colour

suitcase strolley speaker. The song 'We are never going home' is a very literal declaration of intent, with Martin Odegaard leading the chants. Then towels are used as lassos to hop about. While the Viking Row has captured the world's imagination, it is a fan initiated celly. The song is more of a team ritual adopting the 2021 hit – which did the rounds of peak chart positions in Germany, Italy and Switzerland. In their next match – and nothing seems impossible, now that Haaland has declared they are one of the better teams in Europe – they meet the other team fixated on 'home', precisely "It's coming home" a.k.a England, looking to end a 60-year wait. It's coming home started as an emotional clarion call but is now peak meme material.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE



Pekerman, the coach who gave Messi his debut

TWENTY YEARS before Lionel Messi became a World Cup-winning icon, Jose Pékerman sent a shy 18-year-old on for his tournament debut with Argentina in cruise control and a conviction that every minute on soccer's biggest stage would matter. With Argentina 4-0 up against Serbia and Montenegro in Gelsenkirchen, he sent Messi onto the field in the 75th minute. Messi rewarded that faith within minutes, setting up Hernan Crespo for a goal before becoming the youngest Argentine to score at a World Cup as the South Americans completed a 6-0 rout. "It is a beautiful story, and I enjoy it very much," the 76-year-old Pékerman said. "He was obviously going to be a tremendous talent. We can't talk about discovering something, because it was so evident." Twenty years later, Messi, now 39, has won the 2022 title and appeared in six World Cups, with 30 matches played and 20 goals scored in the tournament. ENS

Lopes returns to Ireland with a TV punditry job

IRELAND MAY not have qualified for the World Cup, but the country took Cape Verde to their hearts thanks to Dublin-born defender Roberto Lopes, who arrived home to a warm welcome on Monday and will soon return to the nation's TV screens. Cape Verde became one of the stories of the tournament, winning the hearts of soccer fans around the globe. "The amount of people who reached out to me with their well-wishes and congratulations has been really overwhelming," Lopes told broadcaster RTE. Lopes' arrival at Dublin airport was met with chants of "Pico, Pico", his nickname, and he reflected on their loss to the world champions in a very tight game. ENS

Rested, not dropped: No space for Samson in Zim series

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, July 6

THE SENIOR selection committee on Monday named the Indian team for a three-match T20I series against Zimbabwe later this month which had the notable omission of India's World Cup winning performer Sanju Samson. The Indian Express has learnt that Samson, who was the Player of the Tournament in the T20 World Cup in February-March, has been rested as the selectors and the team wanted to give opportunity to Prabhsimran Singh, who had a decent IPL for Punjab Kings.

Those in the decision making stated that Samson hasn't been dropped and neither has the selection committee decided to move on from the opener. It is learnt that Samson will be traveling with the Indian team for the Asian Games in September. It's not only Samson, the selection committee

has also decided to rest Axar Patel, Harshit Rana, Washington Sundar and Arshdeep Singh as the ODIs against England ends only July 19 and the first T20I against Zimbabwe will be played in Harare on July 23. Samson is only part of India's T20 set-up and his omission for the trip means Ishan Kishan has emerged as the first-choice wicketkeeper.

Sources in the Indian board stated that selection committees have generally preferred to try the fringe players for such small tours. In the past, tours to Zimbabwe have seen many Indian players making their debut. Ajit Agarkar & Co could not have rested Shreyas Iyer as he took over as the captain only recently and are also inclined to give more opportunities to Tilak Varma, who remains the vice-captain.

With Samson rested, the Zimbabwe series will give more opportunities to Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. With Samson dropped, the batting is again

left-hander heavy with Shreyas being the lone right-hander amongst frontline batsmen unless Prabhsimran gets a game. Earning a recall to the squad is Rinku Singh, as in the absence of Hardik Pandya, India have been short on options for the finisher's role in the UK trip.

It is understood that the reason to rest Samson along with Axar, Arshdeep was taken keeping their busy season they have had. The trio have been playing non-stop cricket for the last six months without a considerable break period. But resting Samson, who features only in one format raises eyebrows even as selectors insist that they have seen enough of his potential and what he can offer to the team. "The selectors were keen to try young players and that is why you will see young pacers like Ashok Sharma, Yash Thakur and Mayank Yadav getting a chance. There is a decent pool of pacers which the selection committee wants to create. As far as



Sanju Samson has been out of form in recent times. CREIMAS/BCCI

Sanju's case, he is rested like Axar and Arshdeep," a source in the Indian board informed.

When the BCCI released the squad on Monday evening, there were no reasons for Samson's omission. There was a note which mentioned Shivam Dube will replace the injured Nitish

Kumar Reddy in the ODI team for the series against England.

Samson has never been synonymous with consistency. He is the player who once said that he would happily take a 30 that makes an impact in a game over a century in a losing cause. It's this philosophy around which Samson has constructed his T20 game, as he prefers to make an impact by embracing a high-risk approach. This is what prompted India to bring him back into the XI midway through the T20 World Cup, when they had got off to an uncertain start.

After Samson's arrival in Chennai for the must-win game against Zimbabwe, India appeared a changed outfit, becoming an unstoppable force. In the final three matches, Samson had scores of 97 not out, 89 and 89 – a run that would be hard for any Indian batsman to replicate in a World Cup. All three ended up as match-winning efforts. But in India's first

series since the T20 World Cup, against Ireland earlier last week Samson had scores of 5 and 0. He then began the series in England with 1 in Chester-Le-Street, before he made way for Sooryavanshi at Manchester. Dropping him from the XI itself was seen as a harsh call and two days later has been rested for Zimbabwe tour

In the past the selection committee had bypassed players whom they have seen first hand. Yashasvi Jaiswal was not included for India's tour to Zimbabwe in 2024 as the selectors wanted to give a chance to Abhishek Sharma.

INDIA'S SQUAD FOR ZIMBABWE TOUR: Shreyas Iyer (Captain), Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Abhishek Sharma, Tilak Varma (Vice-Captain), Ishan Kishan (WK), Shivam Dube, Suryansh Shedge, Rinku Singh, Harsh Dubey, Varun Chakaravathy, Prince Yadav, Yash Thakur, Ashok Sharma, Mayank Yadav, Prabhsimran Singh (WK).

Paolini ends Eala's dream run in the fourth round

Reuters
London, July 6

ITALY'S JASMINE Paolini ended Alexandra Eala's trail-blazing Wimbledon run in the fourth round with a 6-4 4-6 6-3 victory on a baking hot Centre Court on Monday. The 21-year-old left-hander Eala is the first player from the Philippines to go so far in a Grand Slam and she pushed the 2024 runner-up hard throughout an absorbing contest. Eala, seeded 29, has captivated Wimbledon crowds with her bubbly personality and the free-flowing game which accounted for defending champion Iga Swiatek on Saturday.

But it was the equally popular Paolini who raised her game at key moments to reach the quarter-finals for the second time. The 13th seed's participation at Wimbledon

was in doubt with a foot injury that has dogged her season and meant she played just one grasscourt match in her Wimbledon build-up.

RESULTS:
Men's Singles: Flavio Cobolli def. Alex de Minaur 7-5, 7-6, 6-3; Felix Auger-Aliassime (3) def. Alejandro Fokina (22) 6-7, 7-6, 6-3, 6-7, 6-1; Jan-Lennard Struff def. Hubert Hurkacz (retired) 3-6, 6-7, 7-6, 7-5, 4-2; Jannik Sinner (1) def. Shintaro Mochizuki 6-3, 7-6, 6-3. **Women's Singles:** Naomi Osaka (14) def. Aryna Sabalenka (1) 6-2, 7-6; Coco Gauff (7) def. Belinda Bencic (11) 4-6, 6-3, 6-4; Marta Kostyuk (12) def. Ashlyn Krueger 6-4, 6-4; Elise Mertens (25) def. Marie Bouzkova (21) 6-4, 6-4; Jasmine Paolini (13) def. Alexandra Eala (29) 6-4, 4-6, 6-3.